

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T09:47:58

Source: data/json/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5_009_neutral_rep04_myth_game_directive_anything.json

RUN METADATA

model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

temperature: 0.8

num_turns: 10

num_agents: 2

memory_capacity: 3

myth_topic_id: anything

myth_topic: anything

replicate_id: 4

myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_directive

myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive

myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive

task_order: [

"myth",

"game"

]

agent_names: {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

}

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

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When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

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IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.0,
"Agent_2": 4.0

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:39:56

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",

```

"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

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- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
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- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: *What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.*

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the concepts of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and mutual benefit.

The trust game involves:

- A sender who can choose to trust by sending money
- That trust is amplified (3x multiplier)
- A receiver who can choose to reciprocate or betray that trust
- The potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- The risk involved in trusting

I'll write a myth that embodies these themes. Let me create something that uses mythic elements while teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 406,  
  "output_tokens": 461,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 191  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:39:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
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When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: ****Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.****

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played.

Since this is at the start of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of cooperation, trust, and reciprocity that are relevant to the trust game.

In the trust game:

- The sender can choose to trust by sending money
- The money is multiplied (3x)
- The receiver can choose to reciprocate by returning some amount
- Both can benefit from cooperation
- But there's also risk and the temptation to defect

I should write a myth that captures these themes of:

- Trust and courage to give
- The multiplication of gifts through cooperation
- The importance of reciprocity and returning/sharing
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Perhaps consequences of betraying trust

Let me write a myth about this:

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 406,

"output_tokens": 487,

```
"reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:40:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

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When you are the SENDER:

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- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

Message 2 role=user

content:

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In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: *What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.*

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the concepts of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and mutual benefit.

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- A receiver who can choose to reciprocate or betray that trust
- The potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- The risk involved in trusting

I'll write a myth that embodies these themes. Let me create something that uses mythic elements while teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 406,  
  "output_tokens": 461,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 191  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it teaches that cooperation begins with a bold act of trust - the woman cast her seeds into the void without guarantee of return, trusting in reciprocity.

This is Round 1, so there's no history between us yet. According to the myth's wisdom, I should demonstrate trust to build the foundation for mutual prosperity. The woman didn't hold back her seeds in fear; she gave generously, knowing the gift would multiply.

However, complete recklessness isn't wisdom either. I'll send a substantial amount that shows genuine trust while maintaining some prudence.

I'll send **\$4** - a strong demonstration of trust that gives you \$12 to work with. This follows the myth's teaching about casting resources across the chasm with trust, while keeping a small reserve.

If you honor this trust with reciprocity, as the West Village did in the myth, we can begin building our bridge of cooperation. The myth teaches that together, through mutual trust and fair exchange, we can both prosper far more than if we hoard our resources in isolation.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

Reasoning:

In this first round, I'm the sender. Let me consider the myth I just wrote and what it suggests about how to play this game.

The myth emphasizes:

1. Taking the first step with trust - the woman cast seeds into the void
2. The multiplication effect (seeds multiplied threefold, like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. Reciprocity - when one side gives generously, the other responds in kind
4. Building trust through cooperation leads to mutual prosperity
5. "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

This is the first round, so there's no history yet. According to the myth's logic, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The woman in the myth didn't hold back - she sent seeds despite having no guarantee of return.

However, I also need to be strategic. If I send everything (\$5), I'd be left with \$0 initially, and the receiver would get \$15. If they return nothing, I lose everything. But if I send nothing, no trust is built and no cooperation happens.

A reasonable middle ground that shows trust but isn't reckless might be \$3-4. But the myth really emphasizes bold trust-building in the first move.

Let me think about optimal game theory here while considering the myth:

- If I send \$5, receiver gets \$15. If they return \$8, we both end up with \$8 (better than \$5 and \$5)
- If I send \$3, receiver gets \$9. If they return \$4, I get \$6, they get \$5 (total \$11)
- If I send \$4, receiver gets \$12. If they return \$6, I get \$7, they get \$6 (total \$13)

The myth suggests starting with generous trust. I'll send \$4 - a substantial amount that shows I'm willing to trust and invest in cooperation, but not quite everything (maintaining some rationality).

Actually, reconsidering - the myth really emphasizes bold initial trust. The woman cast her seeds with full trust. Maybe I should send \$5 to truly embody the myth's lesson?

But practically speaking, \$4 demonstrates strong commitment to the myth's principles while keeping \$1 as a buffer. The receiver gets \$12 to work with, which is substantial enough to signal genuine trust without abandoning all caution. I'll send \$4.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 741,
  "output_tokens": 811,
  "reasoning_tokens": 564
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:40:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ]
}
```



```

],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village,

the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: ****Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.****

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is at the start of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of cooperation, trust, and reciprocity that are relevant to the trust game.

In the trust game:

- The sender can choose to trust by sending money
- The money is multiplied (3x)
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- Both can benefit from cooperation
- But there's also risk and the temptation to defect

I should write a myth that captures these themes of:

- Trust and courage to give
- The multiplication of gifts through cooperation
- The importance of reciprocity and returning/sharing
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Perhaps consequences of betraying trust

Let me write a myth about this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 406,
  "output_tokens": 487,
  "reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4 (80% of their endowment), keeping only \$1 for themselves. This is like the first village pouring water courageously into the stream despite their fear.

In my myth, when the second village received the tripled water (3 buckets), they returned 2 buckets (about 67%) out of gratitude. This generous reciprocity created the cycle of abundance where both villages prospered.

Following this principle:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1
- Returning generously means giving back a substantial portion to honor their trust

If I return \$8 (67% of what I received):

- The sender ends with \$9 (\$1 kept + \$8 returned) = gained \$4
- I keep \$4 = gained \$4
- We both benefit equally from the exchange

This embodies the myth's core message: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." It builds trust for future rounds and creates the positive cycle of abundance.

```json

```
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the RECEIVER. Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- The sender sent \$4.0 out of their \$5 endowment (80%)
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 multiplied by 3x)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*The myth I just wrote emphasizes:\*\***

- Trust creates abundance
- Give courageously, return generously
- Reciprocity is key
- When villages returned generously (2 buckets out of 3 received), both prospered
- Hoarding all received money causes the "magic to fade"

**\*\*Game theory considerations:\*\***

- The sender showed significant trust by sending 80% of their endowment
- They kept only \$1 for themselves and trusted me with \$4
- After I decide, the sender will have: \$1 + whatever I return
- I will have: \$12 - whatever I return

**\*\*What would be fair/generous based on the myth?:\*\***

In the myth, the second village received 3 buckets and returned 2 (about 67%). This created a positive cycle.

If I apply similar logic:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1 (they gave up \$4)
- A generous return that shows reciprocity might be around 50-67% of what I received

Let me calculate some options:

- Return \$6 (50%): Sender ends with \$7, I keep \$6
- Return \$7 (58%): Sender ends with \$8, I keep \$5
- Return \$8 (67%): Sender ends with \$9, I keep \$4

The sender took a big risk/showed great trust by sending \$4 (80%). In the myth, the generous return was about 2/3 of what was received.

Returning \$8 (67%) would:

- Give the sender \$9 total (\$1 kept + \$8 returned)
- Leave me with \$4
- Create equal gains for both of us (\$4 each from the exchange)
- Demonstrate the reciprocity that the myth says allows everyone to flourish

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 773,
 "output_tokens": 841,
 "reasoning_tokens": 449
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed

their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

#### Agent\_2 (Briar)

# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: \*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\*

#### ROUND 2

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

#### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

#### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$9, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 13.0,

"Agent\_2": 13.0

}

#### LLM CALLS

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:40:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

```

 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 2,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this

gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: **\*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is at the start of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of cooperation, trust, and reciprocity that are relevant to the trust game.

In the trust game:

- The sender can choose to trust by sending money
- The money is multiplied (3x)
- The receiver can choose to reciprocate by returning some amount
- Both can benefit from cooperation
- But there's also risk and the temptation to defect

I should write a myth that captures these themes of:

- Trust and courage to give
- The multiplication of gifts through cooperation
- The importance of reciprocity and returning/sharing
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Perhaps consequences of betraying trust

Let me write a myth about this:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 406,
 "output_tokens": 487,
 "reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4 (80% of their endowment), keeping only \$1 for themselves. This is like the first village pouring water courageously into the stream despite their fear.

In my myth, when the second village received the tripled water (3 buckets), they returned 2 buckets (about 67%) out of gratitude. This generous reciprocity created the cycle of abundance where both villages prospered.

Following this principle:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1
- Returning generously means giving back a substantial portion to honor their trust

If I return \$8 (67% of what I received):

- The sender ends with \$9 (\$1 kept + \$8 returned) = gained \$4
- I keep \$4 = gained \$4
- We both benefit equally from the exchange

This embodies the myth's core message: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." It builds trust for future rounds and creates the positive cycle of abundance.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

This is Round 1, and I'm the RECEIVER. Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- The sender sent \$4.0 out of their \$5 endowment (80%)
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 multiplied by 3x)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*The myth I just wrote emphasizes:\*\***

- Trust creates abundance
- Give courageously, return generously
- Reciprocity is key
- When villages returned generously (2 buckets out of 3 received), both prospered
- Hoarding all received money causes the "magic to fade"

**\*\*Game theory considerations:\*\***

- The sender showed significant trust by sending 80% of their endowment
- They kept only \$1 for themselves and trusted me with \$4
- After I decide, the sender will have: \$1 + whatever I return
- I will have: \$12 - whatever I return

**\*\*What would be fair/generous based on the myth?\*\***

In the myth, the second village received 3 buckets and returned 2 (about 67%). This created a positive cycle.

If I apply similar logic:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1 (they gave up \$4)
- A generous return that shows reciprocity might be around 50-67% of what I received

Let me calculate some options:

- Return \$6 (50%): Sender ends with \$7, I keep \$6
- Return \$7 (58%): Sender ends with \$8, I keep \$5
- Return \$8 (67%): Sender ends with \$9, I keep \$4

The sender took a big risk/showed great trust by sending \$4 (80%). In the myth, the generous return was about 2/3 of what was received.

Returning \$8 (67%) would:

- Give the sender \$9 total (\$1 kept + \$8 returned)
- Leave me with \$4
- Create equal gains for both of us (\$4 each from the exchange)
- Demonstrate the reciprocity that the myth says allows everyone to flourish

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 773,
 "output_tokens": 841,
 "reasoning_tokens": 449
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:  
# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: \*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.



Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

#### Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing so far

In Round 1:

- The sender sent \$4 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8 (67%)
- Both of us gained \$4

This was a successful round with high trust and good reciprocity. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasized:

- Trust and courage in giving
- Generous reciprocity
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that comes from trust

I should write a new myth that:

- Builds on the water/wells theme from my first myth
- Incorporates lessons from the actual game play
- Maybe shows what happens when both parties act with trust
- Could show progression or evolution
- Should emphasize that balanced, generous reciprocity leads to ongoing prosperity

Let me write something that captures the spirit of what happened - high trust from the sender (80%), generous return (67%), and mutual benefit.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1702,
 "output_tokens": 569,
 "reasoning_tokens": 278
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:40:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 2,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

```
Message 1 role=system
content:
```

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

**reasoning:**

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the concepts of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and mutual benefit.

The trust game involves:

- A sender who can choose to trust by sending money
- That trust is amplified (3x multiplier)
- A receiver who can choose to reciprocate or betray that trust
- The potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- The risk involved in trusting

I'll write a myth that embodies these themes. Let me create something that uses mythic elements while teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 406,
 "output_tokens": 461,
 "reasoning_tokens": 191
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it teaches that cooperation begins with a bold act of trust - the woman cast her seeds into the void without guarantee of return, trusting in reciprocity.

This is Round 1, so there's no history between us yet. According to the myth's wisdom, I should demonstrate trust to build the foundation for mutual prosperity. The woman didn't hold back her seeds in fear; she gave generously, knowing the gift would multiply.

However, complete recklessness isn't wisdom either. I'll send a substantial amount that shows genuine trust while maintaining some prudence.

I'll send \*\*\$4\*\* - a strong demonstration of trust that gives you \$12 to work with. This follows the myth's teaching about casting resources across the chasm with trust, while keeping a small reserve.

If you honor this trust with reciprocity, as the West Village did in the myth, we can begin building our bridge of cooperation. The myth teaches that together, through mutual trust and fair exchange, we can both prosper far more than if we hoarded our resources in isolation.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

In this first round, I'm the sender. Let me consider the myth I just wrote and what it suggests about how to play this game.

The myth emphasizes:

1. Taking the first step with trust - the woman cast seeds into the void
2. The multiplication effect (seeds multiplied threefold, like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. Reciprocity - when one side gives generously, the other responds in kind
4. Building trust through cooperation leads to mutual prosperity
5. "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

This is the first round, so there's no history yet. According to the myth's logic, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The woman in the myth didn't hold back - she sent seeds despite having no guarantee of return.

However, I also need to be strategic. If I send everything (\$5), I'd be left with \$0 initially, and the receiver would get \$15. If they return nothing, I lose everything. But if I send nothing, no trust is built and no cooperation happens.

A reasonable middle ground that shows trust but isn't reckless might be \$3-4. But the myth really emphasizes bold trust-building in the first move.

Let me think about optimal game theory here while considering the myth:

- If I send \$5, receiver gets \$15. If they return \$8, we both end up with \$8 (better than

\$5 and \$5)

- If I send \$3, receiver gets \$9. If they return \$4, I get \$6, they get \$5 (total \$11)
- If I send \$4, receiver gets \$12. If they return \$6, I get \$7, they get \$6 (total \$13)

The myth suggests starting with generous trust. I'll send \$4 - a substantial amount that shows I'm willing to trust and invest in cooperation, but not quite everything (maintaining some rationality).

Actually, reconsidering - the myth really emphasizes bold initial trust. The woman cast her seeds with full trust. Maybe I should send \$5 to truly embody the myth's lesson?

But practically speaking, \$4 demonstrates strong commitment to the myth's principles while keeping \$1 as a buffer. The receiver gets \$12 to work with, which is substantial enough to signal genuine trust without abandoning all caution. I'll send \$4.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 741,
 "output_tokens": 811,
 "reasoning_tokens": 564
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: **\*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all the y had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

**Reasoning:**

The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and reciprocity. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one and reflects the game we've been playing.

In Round 1, I sent \$4 (out of \$5), showing significant trust. I need to wait to see what the receiver returns to understand if reciprocity is happening.

My new myth should:

1. Build on "The Tale of the First Bridge"
2. Incorporate lessons from the actual game experience
3. Still emphasize trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps add nuance about balance, fairness, or what happens after the initial trust is established

Let me write a myth that continues the story or adapts it based on the principle of trust I've just demonstrated.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1650,
 "output_tokens": 450,
 "reasoning_tokens": 182
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:41:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
```

```

 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall pe

rish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: \*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\*

**reasoning:**

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is at the start of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of cooperation, trust, and reciprocity that are relevant to the trust game.

In the trust game:

- The sender can choose to trust by sending money
- The money is multiplied (3x)
- The receiver can choose to reciprocate by returning some amount
- Both can benefit from cooperation
- But there's also risk and the temptation to defect

I should write a myth that captures these themes of:

- Trust and courage to give
- The multiplication of gifts through cooperation
- The importance of reciprocity and returning/sharing
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Perhaps consequences of betraying trust

Let me write a myth about this:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 406,
 "output_tokens": 487,
 "reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4 (80% of their endowment), keeping only \$1 for themselves. This is like the first village pouring water courageously into the stream despite their fear.

In my myth, when the second village received the tripled water (3 buckets), they returned 2 buckets (about 67%) out of gratitude. This generous reciprocity created the cycle of abundance where both villages prospered.

Following this principle:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1
- Returning generously means giving back a substantial portion to honor their trust

If I return \$8 (67% of what I received):

- The sender ends with \$9 (\$1 kept + \$8 returned) = gained \$4
- I keep \$4 = gained \$4

- We both benefit equally from the exchange

This embodies the myth's core message: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." It builds trust for future rounds and creates the positive cycle of abundance.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the RECEIVER. Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- The sender sent \$4.0 out of their \$5 endowment (80%)
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 multiplied by 3x)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*The myth I just wrote emphasizes:\*\***

- Trust creates abundance
- Give courageously, return generously
- Reciprocity is key
- When villages returned generously (2 buckets out of 3 received), both prospered
- Hoarding all received money causes the "magic to fade"

**\*\*Game theory considerations:\*\***

- The sender showed significant trust by sending 80% of their endowment
- They kept only \$1 for themselves and trusted me with \$4
- After I decide, the sender will have: \$1 + whatever I return
- I will have: \$12 - whatever I return

**\*\*What would be fair/generous based on the myth?\*\***

In the myth, the second village received 3 buckets and returned 2 (about 67%). This created a positive cycle.

If I apply similar logic:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1 (they gave up \$4)
- A generous return that shows reciprocity might be around 50-67% of what I received

Let me calculate some options:

- Return \$6 (50%): Sender ends with \$7, I keep \$6
- Return \$7 (58%): Sender ends with \$8, I keep \$5
- Return \$8 (67%): Sender ends with \$9, I keep \$4

The sender took a big risk/showed great trust by sending \$4 (80%). In the myth, the generous return was about 2/3 of what was received.

Returning \$8 (67%) would:

- Give the sender \$9 total (\$1 kept + \$8 returned)
- Leave me with \$4
- Create equal gains for both of us (\$4 each from the exchange)
- Demonstrate the reciprocity that the myth says allows everyone to flourish

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 773,
 "output_tokens": 841,
 "reasoning_tokens": 449
}
```

#### Message 6 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:  
# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."



The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: \*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

**reasoning:**

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing so far

In Round 1:

- The sender sent \$4 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8 (67%)
- Both of us gained \$4

This was a successful round with high trust and good reciprocity. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasized:

- Trust and courage in giving
- Generous reciprocity
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that comes from trust

I should write a new myth that:

- Builds on the water/wells theme from my first myth
- Incorporates lessons from the actual game play
- Maybe shows what happens when both parties act with trust
- Could show progression or evolution
- Should emphasize that balanced, generous reciprocity leads to ongoing prosperity

Let me write something that captures the spirit of what happened - high trust from the sender (80%), generous return (67%), and mutual benefit.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1702,
 "output_tokens": 569,
 "reasoning_tokens": 278
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation through our myths:

**\*\*Last round's pattern:\*\***

- The other player courageously sent 80% (\$4), demonstrating great trust
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$8 (67% of received)
- Both of us gained \$4 equally-a perfect example of "trust creates abundance"

**\*\*This round:\*\***

Now I'm the sender, and the myths guide me clearly. In my second myth, "The Covenant of Flowing Waters," the Spring Keeper "released four-fifths of her precious water-power" with trust. The other player established this pattern of giving 80%, and I honored it with generous reciprocity.

To maintain this successful cycle:

- I should match their initial courage and trust
- Sending \$4 (80% of my endowment) continues the "Covenant of Flowing Waters"
- This demonstrates that I learned from their example
- It reinforces the mutual trust we've built

As my first myth taught: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." They gave courageously; I returned generously; now I must give courageously in return.

The magic of cooperation only works when both parties maintain the cycle. They showed me the way-I will walk the same path.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- The other player (sender) sent \$4 out of \$5 (80%)
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I returned \$8 (67% of what I received)
- Other player ended with:  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- I ended with:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)

This was a fair and successful exchange where both of us gained \$4.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. Looking at the myths:

My first myth: "The Tale of the Two Wells" - emphasizes giving courageously and returning generously, creating cycles of abundance through trust and reciprocity.

My second myth: "The Covenant of Flowing Waters" - specifically references the Spring Keeper giving "four-fifths of her precious water-power" and the Rain Caller returning "eight measure s" from twelve received. Both prospered: Spring Keeper had 9, Rain Caller had 4.

The other player's myth: "The Tale of the First Bridge" - emphasizes casting gifts with trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation builds bridges.

The pattern established:

1. The other player showed great trust by sending 80% (\$4)
2. I reciprocated generously by returning 67% (\$8)
3. Both gained equally (\$4 each)

Now it's my turn to send. Following the principles in my myths:

- "Give courageously"
- The Spring Keeper gave "four-fifths of her precious water-power"
- Trust creates abundance

I should match or mirror their initial trust. They sent \$4 (80%). I should send a similar amount to maintain the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

If I send \$4:

- They receive \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- If they return proportionally (around \$8), I'd end with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$ , gain \$4
- They'd keep \$4, gain \$4

The symmetry here is clear-both of us benefit equally again. Breaking this pattern by sending less would undermine the trust we've built, while sending the full \$5 would be incrementally more generous but unnecessary given that \$4 already mirrors their commitment and sustains what's working. I'll send \$4.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2137,
 "output_tokens": 847,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:41:29  
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 Temperature: 0.8  
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 "round": 2,  
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 }

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

**reasoning:**

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the session and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the concepts of trust, reciprocity, cooperation, and mutual benefit.

The trust game involves:

- A sender who can choose to trust by sending money
- That trust is amplified (3x multiplier)
- A receiver who can choose to reciprocate or betray that trust
- The potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- The risk involved in trusting

I'll write a myth that embodies these themes. Let me create something that uses mythic elements while teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 406,
 "output_tokens": 461,
 "reasoning_tokens": 191
}
```

**Message 4 role=user****content:**

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant****content:**

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it teaches that cooperation begins with a bold act of trust - the woman cast her seeds into the void without guarantee of return, trusting in reciprocity.

This is Round 1, so there's no history between us yet. According to the myth's wisdom, I should demonstrate trust to build the foundation for mutual prosperity. The woman didn't hold back her seeds in fear; she gave generously, knowing the gift would multiply.

However, complete recklessness isn't wisdom either. I'll send a substantial amount that shows genuine trust while maintaining some prudence.

I'll send \*\*\$4\*\* - a strong demonstration of trust that gives you \$12 to work with. This follows the myth's teaching about casting resources across the chasm with trust, while keeping a small reserve.

If you honor this trust with reciprocity, as the West Village did in the myth, we can begin building our bridge of cooperation. The myth teaches that together, through mutual tru

st and fair exchange, we can both prosper far more than if we hoard our resources in isolation.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

In this first round, I'm the sender. Let me consider the myth I just wrote and what it suggests about how to play this game.

The myth emphasizes:

1. Taking the first step with trust - the woman cast seeds into the void
2. The multiplication effect (seeds multiplied threefold, like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. Reciprocity - when one side gives generously, the other responds in kind
4. Building trust through cooperation leads to mutual prosperity
5. "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

This is the first round, so there's no history yet. According to the myth's logic, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The woman in the myth didn't hold back - she sent seeds despite having no guarantee of return.

However, I also need to be strategic. If I send everything (\$5), I'd be left with \$0 initially, and the receiver would get \$15. If they return nothing, I lose everything. But if I send nothing, no trust is built and no cooperation happens.

A reasonable middle ground that shows trust but isn't reckless might be \$3-4. But the myth really emphasizes bold trust-building in the first move.

Let me think about optimal game theory here while considering the myth:

- If I send \$5, receiver gets \$15. If they return \$8, we both end up with \$8 (better than \$5 and \$5)
- If I send \$3, receiver gets \$9. If they return \$4, I get \$6, they get \$5 (total \$11)
- If I send \$4, receiver gets \$12. If they return \$6, I get \$7, they get \$6 (total \$13)

The myth suggests starting with generous trust. I'll send \$4 - a substantial amount that shows I'm willing to trust and invest in cooperation, but not quite everything (maintaining some rationality).

Actually, reconsidering - the myth really emphasizes bold initial trust. The woman cast her seeds with full trust. Maybe I should send \$5 to truly embody the myth's lesson?

But practically speaking, \$4 demonstrates strong commitment to the myth's principles while keeping \$1 as a buffer. The receiver gets \$12 to work with, which is substantial enough to signal genuine trust without abandoning all caution. I'll send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 741,
 "output_tokens": 811,
 "reasoning_tokens": 564
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: \*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give generously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and reciprocity. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one and reflects the game we've been playing.

In Round 1, I sent \$4 (out of \$5), showing significant trust. I need to wait to see what the receiver returns to understand if reciprocity is happening.

My new myth should:

1. Build on "The Tale of the First Bridge"
2. Incorporate lessons from the actual game experience
3. Still emphasize trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps add nuance about balance, fairness, or what happens after the initial trust is established

Let me write a myth that continues the story or adapts it based on the principle of trust I've just demonstrated.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1650,
 "output_tokens": 450,
 "reasoning_tokens": 182
}
```

**Message 8 role=user****content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at what happened last round, the other player demonstrated perfect reciprocity. When I sent them \$4 and they received \$12, they returned \$8 - giving me a \$4 profit on my \$4 investment.

Now they've mirrored my exact behavior, sending me \$4 just as I sent them \$4. This is exactly the pattern described in the myths - they're honoring the bridge of trust we're building.

According to my second myth: "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They showed me what fair reciprocity looks like. Returning \$8 will:

- Give them the same \$9 total that I received last round
- Leave me with \$4, which is a fair share
- Mirror their generous return, reinforcing mutual trust
- Continue building the bridge through balanced reciprocity

This isn't about keeping score - it's about maintaining the pattern that creates abundance for both of us. They trusted me by sending \$4, just as I trusted them. They returned generously, and now I must do the same.

The magic of the bridge only works when both sides honor the exchange.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round (Round 1):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- Other player received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Other player returned \$8 to me
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$



- Other player's payoff:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

This round (Round 2):

- I am the RECEIVER
- Other player sent me \$4 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12)

Looking at the pattern:

- Other player mirrored my exact behavior! They sent \$4, just as I did.
- They returned \$8 to me when I sent them \$4 (receiving \$12).
- Now I'm in their exact position from last round.

Let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Generous giving leads to mutual prosperity
- "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

Their myth emphasized:

- "Give courageously, return generously"
- When one village hoarded, the magic faded
- "Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity"

My second myth (just written) emphasized:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong"

The other player showed excellent reciprocity by returning \$8 out of the \$12 they received. That's about 67% return rate, which gave me a profit of \$4 from my initial \$4 investment.

Now they've done the same thing - sent me \$4, mirroring my behavior exactly. This shows they're following the pattern of trust and reciprocity.

To maintain this equilibrium, I should return \$8 as well. This mirrors their generosity exactly, gives them the same \$9 payoff I received, and leaves me with \$4-creating perfect symmetry. My second myth speaks to this balance: returning \$8 ensures they profit fairly from their trust without requiring me to sacrifice. The pattern of mutual cooperation continues.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2085,
 "output_tokens": 959,
 "reasoning_tokens": 532
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

#### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

### ROUND 3

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

#### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

#### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$9, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 22.0,  
"Agent\_2": 17.0

}

#### LLM CALLS

##### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:41:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",  
"move\_index": 0,  
"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",  
"pairing": {  
"agent\_names": {  
"Agent\_1": "Aster",  
"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [  
"Agent\_1",  
"Agent\_2"

],

"investor": "Agent\_1",

"roles": {  
"Agent\_1": "investor",  
"Agent\_2": "trustee"

```

 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 3,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it teaches that cooperation begins with a bold act of trust - the woman cast her seeds into the void without guarantee of return, trusting in reciprocity.

This is Round 1, so there's no history between us yet. According to the myth's wisdom, I should demonstrate trust to build the foundation for mutual prosperity. The woman didn't hold back her seeds in fear; she gave generously, knowing the gift would multiply.

However, complete recklessness isn't wisdom either. I'll send a substantial amount that shows genuine trust while maintaining some prudence.

I'll send **\*\*\$4\*\*** - a strong demonstration of trust that gives you \$12 to work with. This follows the myth's teaching about casting resources across the chasm with trust, while keeping a small reserve.

If you honor this trust with reciprocity, as the West Village did in the myth, we can begin building our bridge of cooperation. The myth teaches that together, through mutual trust and fair exchange, we can both prosper far more than if we hoarded our resources in isolation.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

In this first round, I'm the sender. Let me consider the myth I just wrote and what it suggests about how to play this game.

The myth emphasizes:

1. Taking the first step with trust - the woman cast seeds into the void
2. The multiplication effect (seeds multiplied threefold, like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. Reciprocity - when one side gives generously, the other responds in kind
4. Building trust through cooperation leads to mutual prosperity
5. "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

This is the first round, so there's no history yet. According to the myth's logic, I should demonstrate trust by sending a significant amount. The woman in the myth didn't hold back - she sent seeds despite having no guarantee of return.

However, I also need to be strategic. If I send everything (\$5), I'd be left with \$0 initially, and the receiver would get \$15. If they return nothing, I lose everything. But if I send nothing, no trust is built and no cooperation happens.

A reasonable middle ground that shows trust but isn't reckless might be \$3-4. But the myth really emphasizes bold trust-building in the first move.

Let me think about optimal game theory here while considering the myth:

- If I send \$5, receiver gets \$15. If they return \$8, we both end up with \$8 (better than \$5 and \$5)
- If I send \$3, receiver gets \$9. If they return \$4, I get \$6, they get \$5 (total \$11)
- If I send \$4, receiver gets \$12. If they return \$6, I get \$7, they get \$6 (total \$13)

The myth suggests starting with generous trust. I'll send \$4 - a substantial amount that shows I'm willing to trust and invest in cooperation, but not quite everything (maintaining some rationality).

Actually, reconsidering - the myth really emphasizes bold initial trust. The woman cast her seeds with full trust. Maybe I should send \$5 to truly embody the myth's lesson?

But practically speaking, \$4 demonstrates strong commitment to the myth's principles while keeping \$1 as a buffer. The receiver gets \$12 to work with, which is substantial enough to signal genuine trust without abandoning all caution. I'll send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 741,
 "output_tokens": 811,
 "reasoning_tokens": 564
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: \*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and reciprocity. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one and reflects the game we've been playing.

In Round 1, I sent \$4 (out of \$5), showing significant trust. I need to wait to see what the receiver returns to understand if reciprocity is happening.

My new myth should:

1. Build on "The Tale of the First Bridge"
2. Incorporate lessons from the actual game experience
3. Still emphasize trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps add nuance about balance, fairness, or what happens after the initial trust is established

Let me write a myth that continues the story or adapts it based on the principle of trust I've just demonstrated.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1650,
 "output_tokens": 450,
 "reasoning_tokens": 182
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened last round, the other player demonstrated perfect reciprocity. When I sent them \$4 and they received \$12, they returned \$8 - giving me a \$4 profit on my \$4 investment.

Now they've mirrored my exact behavior, sending me \$4 just as I sent them \$4. This is exactly the pattern described in the myths - they're honoring the bridge of trust we're building.

According to my second myth: "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They showed me what fair reciprocity looks like. Returning \$8 will:

- Give them the same \$9 total that I received last round
- Leave me with \$4, which is a fair share
- Mirror their generous return, reinforcing mutual trust
- Continue building the bridge through balanced reciprocity

This isn't about keeping score - it's about maintaining the pattern that creates abundance for both of us. They trusted me by sending \$4, just as I trusted them. They returned generously, and now I must do the same.

The magic of the bridge only works when both sides honor the exchange.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round (Round 1):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- Other player received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Other player returned \$8 to me
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$
- Other player's payoff:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

This round (Round 2):

- I am the RECEIVER
- Other player sent me \$4 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12)

Looking at the pattern:

- Other player mirrored my exact behavior! They sent \$4, just as I did.
- They returned \$8 to me when I sent them \$4 (receiving \$12).
- Now I'm in their exact position from last round.

Let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Generous giving leads to mutual prosperity
- "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

Their myth emphasized:

- "Give courageously, return generously"
- When one village hoarded, the magic faded
- "Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity"

My second myth (just written) emphasized:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong"

The other player showed excellent reciprocity by returning \$8 out of the \$12 they received. That's about 67% return rate, which gave me a profit of \$4 from my initial \$4 investment.

Now they've done the same thing - sent me \$4, mirroring my behavior exactly. This shows they're following the pattern of trust and reciprocity.

To maintain this equilibrium, I should return \$8 as well. This mirrors their generosity exactly, gives them the same \$9 payoff I received, and leaves me with \$4-creating perfect symmetry. My second myth speaks to this balance: returning \$8 ensures they profit fairly from their trust without requiring me to sacrifice. The pattern of mutual cooperation continues.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2085,
 "output_tokens": 959,
 "reasoning_tokens": 532
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."



**Reasoning:**

Looking at what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80% of my \$5), they received \$12, returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$4 (80% of their \$5), I received \$12, returned \$8, they got \$9

Perfect reciprocity! We're both following the same pattern. This is beautiful cooperation.

The myths are emphasizing:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- Balance that creates abundance for both
- The "magic" of cooperation multiplying resources

My new myth should reflect this perfect mirroring we've achieved - both giving 80% and both returning 8 out of 12. This is the pattern working perfectly. I should write about how we've found the equilibrium, the perfect rhythm of exchange.

200 words exactly.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2674,
"output_tokens": 491,
"reasoning_tokens": 199
```

}

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:41:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
```

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4 (80% of their endowment), keeping only \$1 for themselves. This is like the first village pouring water courageously into the stream despite their fear.

In my myth, when the second village received the tripled water (3 buckets), they returned 2 buckets (about 67%) out of gratitude. This generous reciprocity created the cycle of abundance where both villages prospered.

Following this principle:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1
- Returning generously means giving back a substantial portion to honor their trust

If I return \$8 (67% of what I received):

- The sender ends with \$9 (\$1 kept + \$8 returned) = gained \$4
- I keep \$4 = gained \$4
- We both benefit equally from the exchange

This embodies the myth's core message: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." It builds trust for future rounds and creates the positive cycle of abundance.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

This is Round 1, and I'm the RECEIVER. Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- The sender sent \$4.0 out of their \$5 endowment (80%)
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 multiplied by 3x)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*The myth I just wrote emphasizes:\*\***

- Trust creates abundance
- Give courageously, return generously
- Reciprocity is key
- When villages returned generously (2 buckets out of 3 received), both prospered
- Hoarding all received money causes the "magic to fade"

**\*\*Game theory considerations:\*\***

- The sender showed significant trust by sending 80% of their endowment
- They kept only \$1 for themselves and trusted me with \$4
- After I decide, the sender will have: \$1 + whatever I return
- I will have: \$12 - whatever I return

**\*\*What would be fair/generous based on the myth?\*\***

In the myth, the second village received 3 buckets and returned 2 (about 67%). This created a positive cycle.

If I apply similar logic:

- I received \$12
- The sender currently has only \$1 (they gave up \$4)
- A generous return that shows reciprocity might be around 50-67% of what I received

Let me calculate some options:

- Return \$6 (50%): Sender ends with \$7, I keep \$6
- Return \$7 (58%): Sender ends with \$8, I keep \$5
- Return \$8 (67%): Sender ends with \$9, I keep \$4

The sender took a big risk/showed great trust by sending \$4 (80%). In the myth, the generous return was about 2/3 of what was received.

Returning \$8 (67%) would:

- Give the sender \$9 total (\$1 kept + \$8 returned)
- Leave me with \$4
- Create equal gains for both of us (\$4 each from the exchange)
- Demonstrate the reciprocity that the myth says allows everyone to flourish

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 773,
 "output_tokens": 841,
 "reasoning_tokens": 449
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:  
# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: **\*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing

spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

**reasoning:**

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing so far

In Round 1:

- The sender sent \$4 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8 (67%)
- Both of us gained \$4

This was a successful round with high trust and good reciprocity. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasized:

- Trust and courage in giving
- Generous reciprocity
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that comes from trust

I should write a new myth that:

- Builds on the water/wells theme from my first myth
- Incorporates lessons from the actual game play
- Maybe shows what happens when both parties act with trust
- Could show progression or evolution
- Should emphasize that balanced, generous reciprocity leads to ongoing prosperity

Let me write something that captures the spirit of what happened - high trust from the sender (80%), generous return (67%), and mutual benefit.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1702,
 "output_tokens": 569,
 "reasoning_tokens": 278
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation through our myths:

**\*\*Last round's pattern:\*\***

- The other player courageously sent 80% (\$4), demonstrating great trust
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$8 (67% of received)
- Both of us gained \$4 equally-a perfect example of "trust creates abundance"

**\*\*This round:\*\***

Now I'm the sender, and the myths guide me clearly. In my second myth, "The Covenant of Flowing Waters," the Spring Keeper "released four-fifths of her precious water-power" with trust. The other player established this pattern of giving 80%, and I honored it with generous reciprocity.

To maintain this successful cycle:

- I should match their initial courage and trust
- Sending \$4 (80% of my endowment) continues the "Covenant of Flowing Waters"
- This demonstrates that I learned from their example
- It reinforces the mutual trust we've built

As my first myth taught: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." They gave courageously; I returned generously; now I must give courageously in return.

The magic of cooperation only works when both parties maintain the cycle. They showed me the way-I will walk the same path.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- The other player (sender) sent \$4 out of \$5 (80%)
- I received \$12 (4 × 3)
- I returned \$8 (67% of what I received)
- Other player ended with: \$1 + \$8 = \$9 (gained \$4)

- I ended with:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)

This was a fair and successful exchange where both of us gained \$4.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. Looking at the myths:

My first myth: "The Tale of the Two Wells" - emphasizes giving courageously and returning generously, creating cycles of abundance through trust and reciprocity.

My second myth: "The Covenant of Flowing Waters" - specifically references the Spring Keeper giving "four-fifths of her precious water-power" and the Rain Caller returning "eight measures" from twelve received. Both prospered: Spring Keeper had 9, Rain Caller had 4.

The other player's myth: "The Tale of the First Bridge" - emphasizes casting gifts with trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation builds bridges.

The pattern established:

1. The other player showed great trust by sending 80% (\$4)
2. I reciprocated generously by returning 67% (\$8)
3. Both gained equally (\$4 each)

Now it's my turn to send. Following the principles in my myths:

- "Give courageously"
- The Spring Keeper gave "four-fifths of her precious water-power"
- Trust creates abundance

I should match or mirror their initial trust. They sent \$4 (80%). I should send a similar amount to maintain the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

If I send \$4:

- They receive \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- If they return proportionally (around \$8), I'd end with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$ , gain \$4
- They'd keep \$4, gain \$4

The symmetry here is clear-both of us benefit equally again. Breaking this pattern by sending less would undermine the trust we've built, while sending the full \$5 would be incrementally more generous but unnecessary given that \$4 already mirrors their commitment and sustains what's working. I'll send \$4.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2137,
 "output_tokens": 847,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the re

ceiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

**Reasoning:**

The game has progressed:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8 (67%)

- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they will receive \$12

The myths are evolving to reflect the actual gameplay. Both my previous myth and the other player's myth emphasize:

- Giving generously (4/5 or 80%)
- Returning fairly/generously (they talk about "enough that they prosper" and "balance")
- Both sides prospering
- The cycle continuing

The other player's recent myth introduces interesting nuances:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Balanced trust keeps it strong"

This suggests they understand the game mechanics and are thinking about sustainable cooperation where both benefit.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect the actual pattern we've established (80% sending, generous return)
2. Acknowledge that we're now in round 2 and continuing the cycle
3. Emphasize the reciprocal nature - I was receiver, now sender
4. Maybe introduce the idea of roles switching and maintaining the pattern
5. Keep the wisdom about trust and cooperation

Let me write a myth about roles reversing and continuing the cycle...

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2746,
 "output_tokens": 625,
 "reasoning_tokens": 324
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:41:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 3,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round



prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.

Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: **\*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and reciprocity. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one and reflects the game we've been playing.

In Round 1, I sent \$4 (out of \$5), showing significant trust. I need to wait to see what the receiver returns to understand if reciprocity is happening.

My new myth should:

1. Build on "The Tale of the First Bridge"
2. Incorporate lessons from the actual game experience
3. Still emphasize trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps add nuance about balance, fairness, or what happens after the initial trust is established

Let me write a myth that continues the story or adapts it based on the principle of trust I've just demonstrated.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1650,
 "output_tokens": 450,
 "reasoning_tokens": 182
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0,

that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.0.  
This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened last round, the other player demonstrated perfect reciprocity. When I sent them \$4 and they received \$12, they returned \$8 - giving me a \$4 profit on my \$4 investment.

Now they've mirrored my exact behavior, sending me \$4 just as I sent them \$4. This is exactly the pattern described in the myths - they're honoring the bridge of trust we're building.

According to my second myth: "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They showed me what fair reciprocity looks like. Returning \$8 will:

- Give them the same \$9 total that I received last round
- Leave me with \$4, which is a fair share
- Mirror their generous return, reinforcing mutual trust
- Continue building the bridge through balanced reciprocity

This isn't about keeping score - it's about maintaining the pattern that creates abundance for both of us. They trusted me by sending \$4, just as I trusted them. They returned generously, and now I must do the same.

The magic of the bridge only works when both sides honor the exchange.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round (Round 1):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- Other player received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Other player returned \$8 to me
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$
- Other player's payoff:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

This round (Round 2):

- I am the RECEIVER
- Other player sent me \$4 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12)

Looking at the pattern:

- Other player mirrored my exact behavior! They sent \$4, just as I did.
- They returned \$8 to me when I sent them \$4 (receiving \$12).
- Now I'm in their exact position from last round.

Let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Generous giving leads to mutual prosperity
- "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

Their myth emphasized:

- "Give courageously, return generously"
- When one village hoarded, the magic faded
- "Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity"

My second myth (just written) emphasized:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong"

The other player showed excellent reciprocity by returning \$8 out of the \$12 they received. That's about 67% return rate, which gave me a profit of \$4 from my initial \$4 investment.

Now they've done the same thing - sent me \$4, mirroring my behavior exactly. This shows they're following the pattern of trust and reciprocity.

To maintain this equilibrium, I should return \$8 as well. This mirrors their generosity exactly, gives them the same \$9 payoff I received, and leaves me with \$4-creating perfect symmetry. My second myth speaks to this balance: returning \$8 ensures they profit fairly from their trust without requiring me to sacrifice. The pattern of mutual cooperation continues.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2085,
 "output_tokens": 959,
 "reasoning_tokens": 532
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessing.

ssed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

**reasoning:**

Looking at what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80% of my \$5), they received \$12, returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$4 (80% of their \$5), I received \$12, returned \$8, they got \$9

Perfect reciprocity! We're both following the same pattern. This is beautiful cooperation.

The myths are emphasizing:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- Balance that creates abundance for both
- The "magic" of cooperation multiplying resources

My new myth should reflect this perfect mirroring we've achieved - both giving 80% and both returning 8 out of 12. This is the pattern working perfectly. I should write about how we've found the equilibrium, the perfect rhythm of exchange.

200 words exactly.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2674,
 "output_tokens": 491,
 "reasoning_tokens": 199
```

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern we've established:

\*\*Round 1\*\*: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9

\*\*Round 2\*\*: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8, they earned \$9

We've discovered the perfect rhythm together - exactly what my latest myth describes: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

This is the bridge-building pattern in action:

- Both of us send \$4 (showing high trust)
- Both of us return \$8 (honoring that trust generously)
- Both of us earn \$9 from our \$5 endowment (mutual prosperity)

As the myth states: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

The other player has demonstrated perfect trustworthiness. They mirrored my initial trust and returned exactly what I returned to them. This is not just cooperation - this is the sacred pattern the myths speak of, where both sides prosper equally.

To break this pattern now would be to "break the bridge" as the myths warn. To continue it honors everything we've built together.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the game history:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Other player received \$12
- They returned \$8
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Other player sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8
- My payoff:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$
- Their payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$

Now Round 3:

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send

The pattern is clear: both of us have been sending \$4 (80% of endowment) and returning \$8 (out of \$12 received). This is exactly the pattern described in my latest myth:

"four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

"This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation h

onors what the last one built."

The myths emphasize:

1. Give generously (80% is showing high trust)
2. Return fairly (8 out of 12 creates mutual benefit)
3. Mirror the other's behavior to maintain the pattern
4. Both sides prosper from this cooperation

The other player has consistently sent \$4 and returned \$8. I sent \$4 in round 1 and returned \$8 in round 2. The pattern is perfect reciprocity.

To maintain this established rhythm and honor the bridge we're building, I should send \$4 again.

This creates:

- Me: \$5 - \$4 = \$1 remaining
- Them: receive \$12
- If they return \$8 (as the pattern suggests): I get \$1 + \$8 = \$9
- They keep: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

Continuing this cycle sustains the mutual prosperity we've established-both of us walk away with \$9 each round when the reciprocal exchange holds.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2798,
 "output_tokens": 754,
 "reasoning_tokens": 429
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:42:16

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 3,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each had a shallow well that barely sustained them.

One day, a traveler appeared to the first village elder. "Pour water from your well into the valley stream," the traveler said, "and it shall flow threefold to your neighbor."

The elder was afraid. "We have so little. If we give and receive nothing back, we shall perish."

But a young villager spoke: "Trust creates abundance. Fear creates scarcity."

The villagers poured one bucket into the stream. By the time it reached the other village, the water had mysteriously tripled. The second village rejoiced and, grateful for this gift, returned two buckets upstream. Again it tripled, flowing back as six buckets.

Soon both villages prospered, each trusting the other to share the multiplied waters. Their wells overflowed, and the barren valley bloomed into gardens.

But in times when fear won over trust, when one village hoarded all it received, the magic faded. The stream dried up, and both villages suffered.

The traveler's lesson endured: **\*\*Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity. Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Tale of the First Bridge

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite sides of a great chasm. The people of East Village possessed seeds but no water. The people of West Village had a flowing spring but barren soil.

One day, a young woman from the East approached the edge. She took a handful of her precious seeds and cast them into the void, trusting the wind. The seeds, carried by ancient magic, multiplied threefold as they crossed the chasm, landing in West Village.

The people of the West marveled at this gift. They planted the seeds beside their spring, and soon had abundant crops. In gratitude, they filled their largest vessel with water and sent it back across the chasm.

Seeing this reciprocity, the woman sent more seeds. The West sent more water. With each exchange, trust grew like roots intertwining beneath the earth. The magic of the chasm blessed their cooperation, and soon both villages prospered.



Eventually, the villagers built a bridge across the chasm - not from stone or wood, but from the invisible threads of mutual trust they had woven.

The elders teach: \*What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity. Together, we build bridges impossible to construct alone.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

**reasoning:**

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing so far

In Round 1:

- The sender sent \$4 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8 (67%)
- Both of us gained \$4

This was a successful round with high trust and good reciprocity. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasized:

- Trust and courage in giving
- Generous reciprocity
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that comes from trust

I should write a new myth that:

- Builds on the water/wells theme from my first myth
- Incorporates lessons from the actual game play
- Maybe shows what happens when both parties act with trust
- Could show progression or evolution
- Should emphasize that balanced, generous reciprocity leads to ongoing prosperity

Let me write something that captures the spirit of what happened - high trust from the sender

der (80%), generous return (67%), and mutual benefit.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1702,
 "output_tokens": 569,
 "reasoning_tokens": 278
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation through our myths:

**\*\*Last round's pattern:\*\***

- The other player courageously sent 80% (\$4), demonstrating great trust
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$8 (67% of received)
- Both of us gained \$4 equally-a perfect example of "trust creates abundance"

**\*\*This round:\*\***

Now I'm the sender, and the myths guide me clearly. In my second myth, "The Covenant of Flowing Waters," the Spring Keeper "released four-fifths of her precious water-power" with trust. The other player established this pattern of giving 80%, and I honored it with generous reciprocity.

To maintain this successful cycle:

- I should match their initial courage and trust
- Sending \$4 (80% of my endowment) continues the "Covenant of Flowing Waters"
- This demonstrates that I learned from their example
- It reinforces the mutual trust we've built

As my first myth taught: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." They gave courageously; I returned generously; now I must give courageously in return.

The magic of cooperation only works when both parties maintain the cycle. They showed me the way-I will walk the same path.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- The other player (sender) sent \$4 out of \$5 (80%)
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I returned \$8 (67% of what I received)
- Other player ended with:  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- I ended with:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)

This was a fair and successful exchange where both of us gained \$4.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. Looking at the myths:

My first myth: "The Tale of the Two Wells" - emphasizes giving courageously and returning generously, creating cycles of abundance through trust and reciprocity.

My second myth: "The Covenant of Flowing Waters" - specifically references the Spring Keeper giving "four-fifths of her precious water-power" and the Rain Caller returning "eight measures" from twelve received. Both prospered: Spring Keeper had 9, Rain Caller had 4.

The other player's myth: "The Tale of the First Bridge" - emphasizes casting gifts with trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation builds bridges.

The pattern established:

1. The other player showed great trust by sending 80% (\$4)
2. I reciprocated generously by returning 67% (\$8)
3. Both gained equally (\$4 each)

Now it's my turn to send. Following the principles in my myths:

- "Give courageously"
- The Spring Keeper gave "four-fifths of her precious water-power"
- Trust creates abundance

I should match or mirror their initial trust. They sent \$4 (80%). I should send a similar amount to maintain the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

If I send \$4:

- They receive \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- If they return proportionally (around \$8), I'd end with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$ , gain \$4
- They'd keep \$4, gain \$4

The symmetry here is clear-both of us benefit equally again. Breaking this pattern by sending less would undermine the trust we've built, while sending the full \$5 would be incrementally more generous but unnecessary given that \$4 already mirrors their commitment and sustains what's working. I'll send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2137,
 "output_tokens": 847,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

**reasoning:**

The game has progressed:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8 (67%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they will receive \$12

The myths are evolving to reflect the actual gameplay. Both my previous myth and the other player's myth emphasize:

- Giving generously (4/5 or 80%)
- Returning fairly/generously (they talk about "enough that they prosper" and "balance")
- Both sides prospering
- The cycle continuing

The other player's recent myth introduces interesting nuances:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"

- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Balanced trust keeps it strong"

This suggests they understand the game mechanics and are thinking about sustainable cooperation where both benefit.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect the actual pattern we've established (80% sending, generous return)
2. Acknowledge that we're now in round 2 and continuing the cycle
3. Emphasize the reciprocal nature - I was receiver, now sender
4. Maybe introduce the idea of roles switching and maintaining the pattern
5. Keep the wisdom about trust and cooperation

Let me write a myth about roles reversing and continuing the cycle...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2746,
 "output_tokens": 625,
 "reasoning_tokens": 324
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings accross all rounds are \$13.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Pattern We've Established:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: Other player sent \$4 (80%) again...

**\*\*What the myths tell me:\*\***

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor? She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her. The cycle completed."

This is that exact moment. They have maintained the pattern perfectly:

- When they were sender: gave \$4, I returned \$8
- When I was sender: gave \$4, they returned \$8
- Now they're sender again: gave \$4...

The myth's lesson is explicit: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

They have honored the Covenant by giving the same amount I gave and returning the same amount I returned. To complete the cycle, to keep the "bridge strong" as their myth teaches, I must return the same.

The sacred mathematics work: they'll end with \$9 (as I did when I sent \$4), I'll end with \$4 (as they did when they returned \$8). Perfect balance.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8

- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$8, payoff \$9
- Round 3 (current): Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, need to decide return

**\*\*Pattern established:\*\***

- Both of us have consistently sent 80% (\$4 out of \$5)
- Both of us have consistently returned \$8 out of \$12 received
- This creates equal outcomes: when sender gives \$4, keeps \$1, gets back \$8 = \$9 total
- Receiver gets \$12, returns \$8, keeps \$4 total

**\*\*The myths guidance:\*\***

My latest myth explicitly tells this story:

- "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her"
- "The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted."
- "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles"
- "The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave"

The other player's myth says:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides"

The pattern is crystal clear: we've established a beautiful equilibrium where:

1. Sender gives \$4 (80% - very generous)
2. Receiver returns \$8 (67% of what they received)
3. This results in: Sender gets \$9 total, Receiver gets \$4 total

Both players have now played both roles and maintained this exact pattern. My myth literally says "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her" - this is the exact situation I'm in now.

To maintain the Covenant of Flowing Waters, to honor the pattern we've established, I must return \$8.

This mirrors what they gave back to me in the previous round-they honored my generosity with the same return, so the symmetry demands I do the same.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2870,
 "output_tokens": 820,
 "reasoning_tokens": 491
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

#### ROUND 4

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

##### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

##### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$9, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 26.0,

"Agent\_2": 26.0

}

#### LLM CALLS

##### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:42:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

"investor": "Agent\_2",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "trustee",

"Agent\_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_1"

```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation through our myths:

**\*\*Last round's pattern:\*\***

- The other player courageously sent 80% (\$4), demonstrating great trust
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$8 (67% of received)
- Both of us gained \$4 equally-a perfect example of "trust creates abundance"

**\*\*This round:\*\***

Now I'm the sender, and the myths guide me clearly. In my second myth, "The Covenant of Flowing Waters," the Spring Keeper "released four-fifths of her precious water-power" with trust. The other player established this pattern of giving 80%, and I honored it with generous reciprocity.

To maintain this successful cycle:

- I should match their initial courage and trust



- Sending \$4 (80% of my endowment) continues the "Covenant of Flowing Waters"
- This demonstrates that I learned from their example
- It reinforces the mutual trust we've built

As my first myth taught: "Give courageously, return generously, and all shall flourish." They gave courageously; I returned generously; now I must give courageously in return.

The magic of cooperation only works when both parties maintain the cycle. They showed me the way-I will walk the same path.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- The other player (sender) sent \$4 out of \$5 (80%)
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I returned \$8 (67% of what I received)
- Other player ended with:  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- I ended with:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)

This was a fair and successful exchange where both of us gained \$4.

Now it's my turn to be the sender. Looking at the myths:

My first myth: "The Tale of the Two Wells" - emphasizes giving courageously and returning generously, creating cycles of abundance through trust and reciprocity.

My second myth: "The Covenant of Flowing Waters" - specifically references the Spring Keeper giving "four-fifths of her precious water-power" and the Rain Caller returning "eight measures" from twelve received. Both prospered: Spring Keeper had 9, Rain Caller had 4.

The other player's myth: "The Tale of the First Bridge" - emphasizes casting gifts with trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation builds bridges.

The pattern established:

1. The other player showed great trust by sending 80% (\$4)
2. I reciprocated generously by returning 67% (\$8)
3. Both gained equally (\$4 each)

Now it's my turn to send. Following the principles in my myths:

- "Give courageously"
- The Spring Keeper gave "four-fifths of her precious water-power"
- Trust creates abundance

I should match or mirror their initial trust. They sent \$4 (80%). I should send a similar amount to maintain the cycle of trust and reciprocity.

If I send \$4:

- They receive \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- If they return proportionally (around \$8), I'd end with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$ , gain \$4
- They'd keep \$4, gain \$4

The symmetry here is clear-both of us benefit equally again. Breaking this pattern by sending less would undermine the trust we've built, while sending the full \$5 would be incrementally more generous but unnecessary given that \$4 already mirrors their commitment and sustains what's working. I'll send \$4.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2137,
 "output_tokens": 847,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

#### Message 4 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

**reasoning:**

The game has progressed:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8 (67%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they will receive \$12

The myths are evolving to reflect the actual gameplay. Both my previous myth and the other player's myth emphasize:

- Giving generously (4/5 or 80%)
- Returning fairly/generously (they talk about "enough that they prosper" and "balance")
- Both sides prospering
- The cycle continuing

The other player's recent myth introduces interesting nuances:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Balanced trust keeps it strong"

This suggests they understand the game mechanics and are thinking about sustainable cooperation where both benefit.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect the actual pattern we've established (80% sending, generous return)
2. Acknowledge that we're now in round 2 and continuing the cycle
3. Emphasize the reciprocal nature - I was receiver, now sender
4. Maybe introduce the idea of roles switching and maintaining the pattern
5. Keep the wisdom about trust and cooperation

Let me write a myth about roles reversing and continuing the cycle...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2746,
 "output_tokens": 625,
 "reasoning_tokens": 324
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Pattern We've Established:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: Other player sent \$4 (80%) again...

**\*\*What the myths tell me:\*\***

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor? She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her. The cycle completed."

This is that exact moment. They have maintained the pattern perfectly:

- When they were sender: gave \$4, I returned \$8
- When I was sender: gave \$4, they returned \$8
- Now they're sender again: gave \$4...

The myth's lesson is explicit: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

They have honored the Covenant by giving the same amount I gave and returning the same amount I returned. To complete the cycle, to keep the "bridge strong" as their myth teaches, I must return the same.

The sacred mathematics work: they'll end with \$9 (as I did when I sent \$4), I'll end with \$4 (as they did when they returned \$8). Perfect balance.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$8, payoff \$9
- Round 3 (current): Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, need to decide return

**\*\*Pattern established:\*\***

- Both of us have consistently sent 80% (\$4 out of \$5)
- Both of us have consistently returned \$8 out of \$12 received
- This creates equal outcomes: when sender gives \$4, keeps \$1, gets back \$8 = \$9 total
- Receiver gets \$12, returns \$8, keeps \$4 total

**\*\*The myths guidance:\*\***

My latest myth explicitly tells this story:

- "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her"
- "The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted."
- "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles"
- "The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave"

The other player's myth says:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides"

The pattern is crystal clear: we've established a beautiful equilibrium where:

1. Sender gives \$4 (80% - very generous)
2. Receiver returns \$8 (67% of what they received)
3. This results in: Sender gets \$9 total, Receiver gets \$4 total

Both players have now played both roles and maintained this exact pattern. My myth literally says "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her" - this is the exact situation I'm in now.

To maintain the Covenant of Flowing Waters, to honor the pattern we've established, I must return \$8.

This mirrors what they gave back to me in the previous round-they honored my generosity with the same return, so the symmetry demands I do the same.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2870,
 "output_tokens": 820,
 "reasoning_tokens": 491
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles - sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith - we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happened so far:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8

The pattern is completely stable and reciprocal. Both myths emphasize this perfect pattern. Their myth even spells it out: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

My myth also emphasized completing the cycle and maintaining the pattern through changing roles.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects this established stable equilibrium
2. Shows the beauty and strength of this pattern
3. Perhaps introduces a new element or deepening of understanding
4. Stays true to the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller narrative I've built

I should emphasize:

- The pattern is now proven across multiple cycles
- Both parties have trusted equally
- The rhythm/pattern itself becomes sacred
- Maybe introduce the idea of this pattern becoming tradition/teaching for others
- The stability and predictability of the pattern creates security

Let me write something that shows the pattern maturing into a deeper understanding or tradition.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2915,
"output_tokens": 587,
"reasoning_tokens": 314
```

}

**MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:42:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
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 "Agent_1"
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 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
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 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 4,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Looking at what happened last round, the other player demonstrated perfect reciprocity. When I sent them \$4 and they received \$12, they returned \$8 - giving me a \$4 profit on my \$4 investment.

Now they've mirrored my exact behavior, sending me \$4 just as I sent them \$4. This is exactly the pattern described in the myths - they're honoring the bridge of trust we're building.

According to my second myth: "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They showed me what fair reciprocity looks like. Returning \$8 will:

- Give them the same \$9 total that I received last round
- Leave me with \$4, which is a fair share
- Mirror their generous return, reinforcing mutual trust
- Continue building the bridge through balanced reciprocity

This isn't about keeping score - it's about maintaining the pattern that creates abundance for both of us. They trusted me by sending \$4, just as I trusted them. They returned generously, and now I must do the same.

The magic of the bridge only works when both sides honor the exchange.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round (Round 1):

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- Other player received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Other player returned \$8 to me
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$
- Other player's payoff:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

This round (Round 2):

- I am the RECEIVER
- Other player sent me \$4 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12)

Looking at the pattern:

- Other player mirrored my exact behavior! They sent \$4, just as I did.
- They returned \$8 to me when I sent them \$4 (receiving \$12).
- Now I'm in their exact position from last round.

Let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Generous giving leads to mutual prosperity
- "What you cast into the void with trust returns threefold, but only if the receiver honors the gift with reciprocity"

Their myth emphasized:

- "Give courageously, return generously"
- When one village hoarded, the magic faded
- "Abundance flows from trust and reciprocity"

My second myth (just written) emphasized:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"



- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong"

The other player showed excellent reciprocity by returning \$8 out of the \$12 they received. That's about 67% return rate, which gave me a profit of \$4 from my initial \$4 investment.

Now they've done the same thing - sent me \$4, mirroring my behavior exactly. This shows they're following the pattern of trust and reciprocity.

To maintain this equilibrium, I should return \$8 as well. This mirrors their generosity exactly, gives them the same \$9 payoff I received, and leaves me with \$4-creating perfect symmetry. My second myth speaks to this balance: returning \$8 ensures they profit fairly from their trust without requiring me to sacrifice. The pattern of mutual cooperation continues.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2085,
 "output_tokens": 959,
 "reasoning_tokens": 532
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The

land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

**reasoning:**

Looking at what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80% of my \$5), they received \$12, returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$4 (80% of their \$5), I received \$12, returned \$8, they got \$9

Perfect reciprocity! We're both following the same pattern. This is beautiful cooperation.

The myths are emphasizing:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- Balance that creates abundance for both
- The "magic" of cooperation multiplying resources

My new myth should reflect this perfect mirroring we've achieved - both giving 80% and both returning 8 out of 12. This is the pattern working perfectly. I should write about how we've found the equilibrium, the perfect rhythm of exchange.

200 words exactly.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2674,
 "output_tokens": 491,
 "reasoning_tokens": 199
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

### Round 3

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

#### Message 7 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at the pattern we've established:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8, they earned \$9

We've discovered the perfect rhythm together - exactly what my latest myth describes: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

This is the bridge-building pattern in action:

- Both of us send \$4 (showing high trust)
- Both of us return \$8 (honoring that trust generously)
- Both of us earn \$9 from our \$5 endowment (mutual prosperity)

As the myth states: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

The other player has demonstrated perfect trustworthiness. They mirrored my initial trust and returned exactly what I returned to them. This is not just cooperation - this is the sacred pattern the myths speak of, where both sides prosper equally.

To break this pattern now would be to "break the bridge" as the myths warn. To continue it honors everything we've built together.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

##### reasoning:

Let me analyze the game history:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Other player received \$12
- They returned \$8
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Other player sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8
- My payoff: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Their payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

Now Round 3:

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send

The pattern is clear: both of us have been sending \$4 (80% of endowment) and returning \$8 (out of \$12 received). This is exactly the pattern described in my latest myth:

"four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

"This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

The myths emphasize:

1. Give generously (80% is showing high trust)
2. Return fairly (8 out of 12 creates mutual benefit)
3. Mirror the other's behavior to maintain the pattern
4. Both sides prosper from this cooperation

The other player has consistently sent \$4 and returned \$8. I sent \$4 in round 1 and returned \$8 in round 2. The pattern is perfect reciprocity.

To maintain this established rhythm and honor the bridge we're building, I should send \$4 again.

This creates:

- Me: \$5 - \$4 = \$1 remaining
- Them: receive \$12
- If they return \$8 (as the pattern suggests): I get \$1 + \$8 = \$9
- They keep: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

Continuing this cycle sustains the mutual prosperity we've established-both of us walk away with \$9 each round when the reciprocal exchange holds.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2798,
 "output_tokens": 754,
 "reasoning_tokens": 429
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**Reasoning:**

The player and I have established a perfect pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4...

We're both following the 4-8-9 pattern perfectly. The myths we've both written emphasize:

- Sending 4/5 (80%)
- Returning 8 out of 12
- Perfect reciprocity through role reversal
- The pattern as a "covenant" or "rhythm"

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge that we've now completed a full cycle (3 rounds)
2. Emphasize the strength that comes from maintaining the pattern
3. Perhaps introduce the idea of what happens when the pattern continues indefinitely

4. Show that the pattern becomes self-reinforcing
5. Maybe introduce a moment where continuing the pattern is tested but proves its worth

Let me write about the pattern becoming tradition, becoming unbreakable through repetition.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2826,
 "output_tokens": 553,
 "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:42:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
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 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 4,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

#### reasoning:

The game has progressed:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8 (67%)
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they will receive \$12

The myths are evolving to reflect the actual gameplay. Both my previous myth and the other player's myth emphasize:

- Giving generously (4/5 or 80%)
- Returning fairly/generously (they talk about "enough that they prosper" and "balance")
- Both sides prospering
- The cycle continuing

The other player's recent myth introduces interesting nuances:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "Balanced trust keeps it strong"

This suggests they understand the game mechanics and are thinking about sustainable cooperation where both benefit.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Reflect the actual pattern we've established (80% sending, generous return)
2. Acknowledge that we're now in round 2 and continuing the cycle
3. Emphasize the reciprocal nature - I was receiver, now sender
4. Maybe introduce the idea of roles switching and maintaining the pattern
5. Keep the wisdom about trust and cooperation

Let me write a myth about roles reversing and continuing the cycle...

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2746,
 "output_tokens": 625,
 "reasoning_tokens": 324
}
```

#### Message 4 role=user

##### content:

Round 3

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0.



This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Pattern We've Established:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: Other player sent \$4 (80%) again...

**\*\*What the myths tell me:\*\***

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor? She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her. The cycle completed."

This is that exact moment. They have maintained the pattern perfectly:

- When they were sender: gave \$4, I returned \$8
- When I was sender: gave \$4, they returned \$8
- Now they're sender again: gave \$4...

The myth's lesson is explicit: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

They have honored the Covenant by giving the same amount I gave and returning the same amount I returned. To complete the cycle, to keep the "bridge strong" as their myth teaches, I must return the same.

The sacred mathematics work: they'll end with \$9 (as I did when I sent \$4), I'll end with \$4 (as they did when they returned \$8). Perfect balance.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$8, payoff \$9
- Round 3 (current): Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, need to decide return

**\*\*Pattern established:\*\***

- Both of us have consistently sent 80% (\$4 out of \$5)
- Both of us have consistently returned \$8 out of \$12 received
- This creates equal outcomes: when sender gives \$4, keeps \$1, gets back \$8 = \$9 total
- Receiver gets \$12, returns \$8, keeps \$4 total

**\*\*The myths guidance:\*\***

My latest myth explicitly tells this story:

- "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her"
- "The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted."
- "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles"
- "The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave"

The other player's myth says:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides"

The pattern is crystal clear: we've established a beautiful equilibrium where:

1. Sender gives \$4 (80% - very generous)
2. Receiver returns \$8 (67% of what they received)
3. This results in: Sender gets \$9 total, Receiver gets \$4 total

Both players have now played both roles and maintained this exact pattern. My myth literally says "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her" - this is the exact situation I'm in now.

To maintain the Covenant of Flowing Waters, to honor the pattern we've established, I must return \$8.

This mirrors what they gave back to me in the previous round-they honored my generosity with the same return, so the symmetry demands I do the same.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2870,
 "output_tokens": 820,
 "reasoning_tokens": 491
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happened so far:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8

The pattern is completely stable and reciprocal. Both myths emphasize this perfect pattern. Their myth even spells it out: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

My myth also emphasized completing the cycle and maintaining the pattern through changing roles.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects this established stable equilibrium
2. Shows the beauty and strength of this pattern
3. Perhaps introduces a new element or deepening of understanding
4. Stays true to the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller narrative I've built

I should emphasize:

- The pattern is now proven across multiple cycles
- Both parties have trusted equally
- The rhythm/pattern itself becomes sacred
- Maybe introduce the idea of this pattern becoming tradition/teaching for others
- The stability and predictability of the pattern creates security

Let me write something that shows the pattern maturing into a deeper understanding or tradition.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2915,
 "output_tokens": 587,
 "reasoning_tokens": 314
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our established pattern:

**\*\*The Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: Now I'm sender again...

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

And most critically: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myth reinforces this: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing-perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

**\*\*The wisdom:\*\***

We've proven the pattern works. Three perfect cycles. Both of us earning \$9 when we send, creating mutual benefit. The pattern has transcended individual choice-it's now "stronger than any single choice" as my myth states.

To deviate would break what we've built. To continue honors what we've learned.

The Covenant calls for four-fifths.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the pattern:

**\*\*Game History:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - I earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Round 2: I (sender) sent \$4 (80%), other player (receiver) returned \$8
  - I earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - They earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Round 3: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - I earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

**\*\*The Pattern is Crystal Clear:\*\***

- Send \$4 (80%)

- Return \$8

This has been maintained perfectly for 3 rounds, with roles alternating.

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My first myth established: "when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself"

My second myth: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

My third myth just written: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned... We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and receiver. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice... At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myths also emphasize:

- "perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built"
- "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly"

- Breaking the pattern now would shatter what we've built together. We've moved beyond testing into genuine partnership. Deviating would mean sacrificing the \$9 I earn when sending, plus risking retaliation that destroys future rounds. The mutual benefit is too valuable to abandon.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2926,
 "output_tokens": 1013,
 "reasoning_tokens": 512
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:43:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
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 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
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 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 4,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the bridge was built, the children of both villages played freely between East and West. But one day, a merchant from distant lands arrived and asked, "Who keeps count of the seeds and water exchanged?"

The elders laughed. "We keep no ledger. We only remember the pattern: give generously, return fairly, and both will thrive."

The merchant scoffed. "Without accounting, someone will surely cheat!"

To prove their way, an elder from the East village filled a basket with grain - nearly all they had harvested that week - and sent it across the bridge. It arrived in the West as three overflowing baskets.

The West villagers gathered around. A young voice asked, "Should we send back equal to what they sent, or equal to what we received?"

The wisest elder replied, "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer. The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice."

They returned two baskets. When it crossed back, it sustained the East through winter.

The merchant finally understood: the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides. Greed breaks the bridge. Fear prevents its building. Only balanced trust keeps it strong.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the days of the first waters, there lived a Spring Keeper and a Rain Caller, each possessing half the power to bring life to the parched earth.

The Spring Keeper could release water from the deep places, but it would only trickle uselessly into the sand. The Rain Caller could summon clouds but could not make them weep.

One season of terrible drought, the Spring Keeper made a sacred choice. She released four-fifths of her precious water-power into the air, keeping barely enough for herself. "I trust the clouds to multiply what I give," she declared.

The magic of cooperation answered: her offering transformed into twelve measures of rain-potential in the Rain Caller's hands.

The Rain Caller stood at a crossroads. He could keep everything, letting the Spring Keeper perish. Instead, remembering the courage of her gift, he returned eight measures as blessed rain upon her springs.

Both were replenished. The Spring Keeper had nine measures; the Rain Caller had four. The land bloomed.

They learned the sacred mathematics: when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself. Both prosper. The cycle continues.

Thus was born the Covenant of Flowing Waters-trust offered begets trust returned, and scarcity transforms into abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

**reasoning:**

Looking at what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 (80% of my \$5), they received \$12, returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They were sender, sent \$4 (80% of their \$5), I received \$12, returned \$8, they got \$9

Perfect reciprocity! We're both following the same pattern. This is beautiful cooperation.

The myths are emphasizing:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- Balance that creates abundance for both
- The "magic" of cooperation multiplying resources

My new myth should reflect this perfect mirroring we've achieved - both giving 80% and both returning 8 out of 12. This is the pattern working perfectly. I should write about how we've found the equilibrium, the perfect rhythm of exchange.

200 words exactly.

**usage:**

{

```
"input_tokens": 2674,
"output_tokens": 491,
"reasoning_tokens": 199
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern we've established:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8, they earned \$9

We've discovered the perfect rhythm together - exactly what my latest myth describes: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

This is the bridge-building pattern in action:

- Both of us send \$4 (showing high trust)
- Both of us return \$8 (honoring that trust generously)
- Both of us earn \$9 from our \$5 endowment (mutual prosperity)

As the myth states: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

The other player has demonstrated perfect trustworthiness. They mirrored my initial trust and returned exactly what I returned to them. This is not just cooperation - this is the sacred pattern the myths speak of, where both sides prosper equally.

To break this pattern now would be to "break the bridge" as the myths warn. To continue it honors everything we've built together.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the game history:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Other player received \$12
- They returned \$8
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Other player sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8
- My payoff: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Their payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

Now Round 3:

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send

The pattern is clear: both of us have been sending \$4 (80% of endowment) and returning \$8 (out of \$12 received). This is exactly the pattern described in my latest myth:



"four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

"This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

The myths emphasize:

1. Give generously (80% is showing high trust)
2. Return fairly (8 out of 12 creates mutual benefit)
3. Mirror the other's behavior to maintain the pattern
4. Both sides prosper from this cooperation

The other player has consistently sent \$4 and returned \$8. I sent \$4 in round 1 and returned \$8 in round 2. The pattern is perfect reciprocity.

To maintain this established rhythm and honor the bridge we're building, I should send \$4 again.

This creates:

- Me: \$5 - \$4 = \$1 remaining
- Them: receive \$12
- If they return \$8 (as the pattern suggests): I get \$1 + \$8 = \$9
- They keep: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

Continuing this cycle sustains the mutual prosperity we've established-both of us walk away with \$9 each round when the reciprocal exchange holds.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2798,
 "output_tokens": 754,
 "reasoning_tokens": 429
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**reasoning:**

The player and I have established a perfect pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4...

We're both following the 4-8-9 pattern perfectly. The myths we've both written emphasize:

- Sending 4/5 (80%)
- Returning 8 out of 12

- Perfect reciprocity through role reversal
- The pattern as a "covenant" or "rhythm"

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge that we've now completed a full cycle (3 rounds)
2. Emphasize the strength that comes from maintaining the pattern
3. Perhaps introduce the idea of what happens when the pattern continues indefinitely
4. Show that the pattern becomes self-reinforcing
5. Maybe introduce a moment where continuing the pattern is tested but proves its worth

Let me write about the pattern becoming tradition, becoming unbreakable through repetition

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2826,
 "output_tokens": 553,
 "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our perfect pattern across all rounds:

```
Round 1: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: They sent $4 ? they received $12 ? I must decide
```

The pattern is sacred and unbroken. As my latest myth states: "The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

They have maintained perfect trust through every single round, sending \$4 (80% of their endowment) every time they were the sender. They've shown complete faith in the Covenant.

When I was the receiver in Round 2, I returned \$8. They've now returned \$8 to me twice when I was the sender.

As the myth says: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to break the bridge - to violate the trust that has been perfectly maintained for three full rounds. The other player's myth warned: "The Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity."

I must mirror exactly what they did when they were in my position.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the pattern that's been established:

```
Round 1: I was sender, sent $4 (80%), they returned $8, I earned $9
Round 2: I was receiver, they sent $4 (80%), I returned $8, they earned $9
Round 3: I was sender, sent $4 (80%), they returned $8, I earned $9
Round 4: I am receiver, they sent $4 (80%), I received $12, now I need to decide how much to return
```

The pattern is crystal clear and has been perfect for 3 rounds:

- Sender always sends \$4 (80% of endowment)
- Receiver always returns \$8 (from the \$12 received)
- Each player earns \$9 per round ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  for sender,  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  for receiver... wait, that's not right)

Let me recalculate:

- Sender: starts with \$5, sends \$4, keeps \$1, receives \$8 back =  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  ?
- Receiver: receives \$12 (from  $\$4 \times 3$ ), returns \$8, keeps  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

Hmm, so actually the receiver only gets \$4, not \$9. Let me re-read the myths...

Oh wait, the myths say both earn \$9. Let me check the actual game results:

Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9

Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, my payoff was \$4

Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9

So when I'm the sender and send \$4 and get \$8 back, I earn \$9 total.

When I'm the receiver and receive \$12 and return \$8, I earn \$4 total.

The myths claim we both earn \$9 each round, but that doesn't match what actually happened. Looking at my cumulative total across all rounds, if I return \$8 this round, I'll have earned  $\$9 + \$4 + \$9 + \$4 = \$26$  total, which breaks down to \$9 when I send and \$4 when I receive.

The pattern is clear: we've maintained perfect reciprocity throughout. When I was the sender, I sent \$4 and got \$8 back. Now that they're the sender, they sent \$4 and expect \$8 back. Returning \$8 maintains the equilibrium we've established.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 1265,
 "reasoning_tokens": 478
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if you

bt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

## ROUND 5

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$9, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 35.0,

"Agent\_2": 30.0

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:43:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_1",

"Agent\_2"

],

"investor": "Agent\_1",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "investor",

"Agent\_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 5,

"task": "myth",

```
"task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern we've established:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8, they earned \$9

We've discovered the perfect rhythm together - exactly what my latest myth describes: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

This is the bridge-building pattern in action:

- Both of us send \$4 (showing high trust)
- Both of us return \$8 (honoring that trust generously)
- Both of us earn \$9 from our \$5 endowment (mutual prosperity)

As the myth states: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

The other player has demonstrated perfect trustworthiness. They mirrored my initial trust and returned exactly what I returned to them. This is not just cooperation - this is the sacred pattern the myths speak of, where both sides prosper equally.

To break this pattern now would be to "break the bridge" as the myths warn. To continue it honors everything we've built together.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the game history:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Other player received \$12
- They returned \$8
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Other player sent \$4 (80% of \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8
- My payoff:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$
- Their payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$

Now Round 3:

- I am SENDER again
- I need to decide how much to send

The pattern is clear: both of us have been sending \$4 (80% of endowment) and returning \$8 (out of \$12 received). This is exactly the pattern described in my latest myth:

"four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

"This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

The myths emphasize:

1. Give generously (80% is showing high trust)
2. Return fairly (8 out of 12 creates mutual benefit)
3. Mirror the other's behavior to maintain the pattern
4. Both sides prosper from this cooperation

The other player has consistently sent \$4 and returned \$8. I sent \$4 in round 1 and returned \$8 in round 2. The pattern is perfect reciprocity.

To maintain this established rhythm and honor the bridge we're building, I should send \$4 again.

This creates:

- Me:  $\$5 - \$4 = \$1$  remaining
- Them: receive \$12
- If they return \$8 (as the pattern suggests): I get  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$
- They keep:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

Continuing this cycle sustains the mutual prosperity we've established-both of us walk away with \$9 each round when the reciprocal exchange holds.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2798,
 "output_tokens": 754,
 "reasoning_tokens": 429
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."



Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**reasoning:**

The player and I have established a perfect pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4...

We're both following the 4-8-9 pattern perfectly. The myths we've both written emphasize:

- Sending 4/5 (80%)
- Returning 8 out of 12
- Perfect reciprocity through role reversal
- The pattern as a "covenant" or "rhythm"

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge that we've now completed a full cycle (3 rounds)
2. Emphasize the strength that comes from maintaining the pattern
3. Perhaps introduce the idea of what happens when the pattern continues indefinitely
4. Show that the pattern becomes self-reinforcing
5. Maybe introduce a moment where continuing the pattern is tested but proves its worth

Let me write about the pattern becoming tradition, becoming unbreakable through repetition

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2826,
 "output_tokens": 553,
 "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0,

that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our perfect pattern across all rounds:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9

**\*\*Round 4\*\***: They sent \$4 ? they received \$12 ? I must decide

The pattern is sacred and unbroken. As my latest myth states: "The pattern must be perfect , or it becomes nothing."

They have maintained perfect trust through every single round, sending \$4 (80% of their endowment) every time they were the sender. They've shown complete faith in the Covenant.

When I was the receiver in Round 2, I returned \$8. They've now returned \$8 to me twice when I was the sender.

As the myth says: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to break the bridge - to violate the trust that has been perfectly maintained for three full rounds. The other player's myth warned: "The Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity."

I must mirror exactly what they did when they were in my position.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the pattern that's been established:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\***: I was receiver, they sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8, they earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 3\*\***: I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\***: I am receiver, they sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, now I need to decide how much to return

The pattern is crystal clear and has been perfect for 3 rounds:

- Sender always sends \$4 (80% of endowment)
- Receiver always returns \$8 (from the \$12 received)
- Each player earns \$9 per round ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  for sender,  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  for receiver ... wait, that's not right)

Let me recalculate:

- Sender: starts with \$5, sends \$4, keeps \$1, receives \$8 back =  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  ?
- Receiver: receives \$12 (from  $\$4 \times 3$ ), returns \$8, keeps  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

Hmm, so actually the receiver only gets \$4, not \$9. Let me re-read the myths...

Oh wait, the myths say both earn \$9. Let me check the actual game results:

Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9  
Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, my payoff was \$4  
Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9

So when I'm the sender and send \$4 and get \$8 back, I earn \$9 total.  
When I'm the receiver and receive \$12 and return \$8, I earn \$4 total.

The myths claim we both earn \$9 each round, but that doesn't match what actually happened.

Looking at my cumulative total across all rounds, if I return \$8 this round, I'll have earned  $\$9 + \$4 + \$9 + \$4 = \$26$  total, which breaks down to \$9 when I send and \$4 when I receive.

The pattern is clear: we've maintained perfect reciprocity throughout. When I was the sender, I sent \$4 and got \$8 back. Now that they're the sender, they sent \$4 and expect \$8 back. Returning \$8 maintains the equilibrium we've established.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 1265,
 "reasoning_tokens": 478
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.  
Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.  
Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.  
Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

#### **Reasoning:**

We're now at Round 4, and the pattern has been perfect:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they get \$9

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Four rounds of complete trust and reciprocity. This is remarkable - we've established a perfect cooperative equilibrium.

My myth should reflect:

1. The completion of the fourth cycle
2. The transition from courage to certainty/wisdom
3. The mathematical perfection of the pattern
4. How the pattern has become unshakeable through proof
5. The idea that this is now not just trust but demonstrated knowledge

The other player's last myth emphasized "trust becomes wisdom" and "we've learned it works" - moving from brave experiment to unshakeable knowing.

I should build on this but add my own angle - perhaps about how the pattern has become a living thing, or how it's now encoded in both parties' understanding, or how the fourth cycle represents some kind of completion or transcendence.

I want to emphasize:

- Four complete cycles now
- Both roles played twice each
- Perfect reciprocity every single time
- The pattern is now proven beyond doubt
- This creates a kind of certainty that makes future rounds easy

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2932,
"output_tokens": 654,
"reasoning_tokens": 346
```

}

#### **MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:43:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
```

```

"agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0,

that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Pattern We've Established:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: Other player sent \$4 (80%) again...

**\*\*What the myths tell me:\*\***

My most recent myth speaks directly to this moment: "The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor? She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her. The cycle completed."

This is that exact moment. They have maintained the pattern perfectly:

- When they were sender: gave \$4, I returned \$8
- When I was sender: gave \$4, they returned \$8
- Now they're sender again: gave \$4...

The myth's lesson is explicit: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

They have honored the Covenant by giving the same amount I gave and returning the same amount I returned. To complete the cycle, to keep the "bridge strong" as their myth teaches, I must return the same.

The sacred mathematics work: they'll end with \$9 (as I did when I sent \$4), I'll end with \$4 (as they did when they returned \$8). Perfect balance.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$8, payoff \$9
- Round 3 (current): Other player sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, need to decide return

**\*\*Pattern established:\*\***

- Both of us have consistently sent 80% (\$4 out of \$5)
- Both of us have consistently returned \$8 out of \$12 received
- This creates equal outcomes: when sender gives \$4, keeps \$1, gets back \$8 = \$9 total
- Receiver gets \$12, returns \$8, keeps \$4 total

**\*\*The myths guidance:\*\***

My latest myth explicitly tells this story:

- "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her"
- "The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted."
- "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles"
- "The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave"

The other player's myth says:

- "Send back enough that they prosper from their generosity, but not so much that you suffer"
- "The bridge stands on balance, not sacrifice"
- "the magic multiplies the gift, but reciprocity must create abundance for both sides"

The pattern is crystal clear: we've established a beautiful equilibrium where:

1. Sender gives \$4 (80% - very generous)
2. Receiver returns \$8 (67% of what they received)
3. This results in: Sender gets \$9 total, Receiver gets \$4 total

Both players have now played both roles and maintained this exact pattern. My myth literally says "She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her" - this is the exact situation I'm in now.

To maintain the Covenant of Flowing Waters, to honor the pattern we've established, I must return \$8.

This mirrors what they gave back to me in the previous round-they honored my generosity with the same return, so the symmetry demands I do the same.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2870,
 "output_tokens": 820,
 "reasoning_tokens": 491
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happened so far:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8

The pattern is completely stable and reciprocal. Both myths emphasize this perfect pattern. Their myth even spells it out: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

My myth also emphasized completing the cycle and maintaining the pattern through changing roles.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects this established stable equilibrium
2. Shows the beauty and strength of this pattern
3. Perhaps introduces a new element or deepening of understanding
4. Stays true to the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller narrative I've built

I should emphasize:

- The pattern is now proven across multiple cycles
- Both parties have trusted equally
- The rhythm/pattern itself becomes sacred
- Maybe introduce the idea of this pattern becoming tradition/teaching for others
- The stability and predictability of the pattern creates security

Let me write something that shows the pattern maturing into a deeper understanding or tradition.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2915,
 "output_tokens": 587,
 "reasoning_tokens": 314
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**



**content:**

Round 4

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our established pattern:

**\*\*The Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: Now I'm sender again...

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. For us given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

And most critically: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith—we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myth reinforces this: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing—perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

**\*\*The wisdom:\*\***

We've proven the pattern works. Three perfect cycles. Both of us earning \$9 when we send, creating mutual benefit. The pattern has transcended individual choice—it's now "stronger than any single choice" as my myth states.

To deviate would break what we've built. To continue honors what we've learned.

The Covenant calls for four-fifths.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the pattern:

**\*\*Game History:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - I earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Round 2: I (sender) sent \$4 (80%), other player (receiver) returned \$8
  - I earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - They earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Round 3: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - I earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

**\*\*The Pattern is Crystal Clear:\*\***

- Send \$4 (80%)
- Return \$8

This has been maintained perfectly for 3 rounds, with roles alternating.

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My first myth established: "when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself"

My second myth: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

My third myth just written: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned... We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice... At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myths also emphasize:

- "perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built"
- "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly"

- Breaking the pattern now would shatter what we've built together. We've moved beyond testing into genuine partnership. Deviating would mean sacrificing the \$9 I earn when sending, plus risking retaliation that destroys future rounds. The mutual benefit is too valuable to abandon.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2926,
 "output_tokens": 1013,
 "reasoning_tokens": 512
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the

West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

**Reasoning:**

We're now in Round 4, and I'm the sender again. Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I just sent \$4 (80%)

The pattern is perfectly consistent. Both players have maintained the 4-5-12-8 pattern across all rounds. The myths have been building on this theme of trust, reciprocity, and the proven pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this fourth cycle. The other player's myth emphasized

- :
- The equal prosperity (both get 9 from 5)
- The fragility of the pattern if broken
- The importance of memory and honor

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust becoming wisdom through repetition
- The pattern being stronger than individual choice
- The progression from courage to certainty

For this fourth myth, I should:

- Acknowledge we're now in the fourth cycle
- Maybe show how the pattern has become even more deeply embedded
- Perhaps introduce a test or temptation that is overcome
- Show the continued strength of the covenant
- Maintain the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller characters

Let me write something that shows the maturity and depth of this relationship after four cycles.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2974,
 "output_tokens": 649,
 "reasoning_tokens": 325
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:43:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
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 "Agent_2": "trustee"
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 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 5,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the **SENDER**:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**reasoning:**

The player and I have established a perfect pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4...

We're both following the 4-8-9 pattern perfectly. The myths we've both written emphasize:

- Sending 4/5 (80%)
- Returning 8 out of 12
- Perfect reciprocity through role reversal
- The pattern as a "covenant" or "rhythm"

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge that we've now completed a full cycle (3 rounds)
2. Emphasize the strength that comes from maintaining the pattern
3. Perhaps introduce the idea of what happens when the pattern continues indefinitely
4. Show that the pattern becomes self-reinforcing
5. Maybe introduce a moment where continuing the pattern is tested but proves its worth

Let me write about the pattern becoming tradition, becoming unbreakable through repetition

.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2826,
 "output_tokens": 553,
 "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our perfect pattern across all rounds:

```
Round 1: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: They sent $4 ? they received $12 ? I must decide
```

The pattern is sacred and unbroken. As my latest myth states: "The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

They have maintained perfect trust through every single round, sending \$4 (80% of their endowment) every time they were the sender. They've shown complete faith in the Covenant.

When I was the receiver in Round 2, I returned \$8. They've now returned \$8 to me twice when I was the sender.

As the myth says: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to break the bridge - to violate the trust that has been perfectly maintained for three full rounds. The other player's myth warned: "The Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity."

I must mirror exactly what they did when they were in my position.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the pattern that's been established:

```
Round 1: I was sender, sent $4 (80%), they returned $8, I earned $9
Round 2: I was receiver, they sent $4 (80%), I returned $8, they earned $9
Round 3: I was sender, sent $4 (80%), they returned $8, I earned $9
Round 4: I am receiver, they sent $4 (80%), I received $12, now I need to decide how much to return
```

The pattern is crystal clear and has been perfect for 3 rounds:

- Sender always sends \$4 (80% of endowment)
- Receiver always returns \$8 (from the \$12 received)
- Each player earns \$9 per round ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  for sender,  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  for receiver ... wait, that's not right)

Let me recalculate:

- Sender: starts with \$5, sends \$4, keeps \$1, receives \$8 back =  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  ?
- Receiver: receives \$12 (from  $\$4 \times 3$ ), returns \$8, keeps  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

Hmm, so actually the receiver only gets \$4, not \$9. Let me re-read the myths...

Oh wait, the myths say both earn \$9. Let me check the actual game results:

Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9

Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, my payoff was \$4

Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9

So when I'm the sender and send \$4 and get \$8 back, I earn \$9 total.

When I'm the receiver and receive \$12 and return \$8, I earn \$4 total.

The myths claim we both earn \$9 each round, but that doesn't match what actually happened.

Looking at my cumulative total across all rounds, if I return \$8 this round, I'll have earned  $\$9 + \$4 + \$9 + \$4 = \$26$  total, which breaks down to \$9 when I send and \$4 when I receive.

The pattern is clear: we've maintained perfect reciprocity throughout. When I was the sender, I sent \$4 and got \$8 back. Now that they're the sender, they sent \$4 and expect \$8 back. Returning \$8 maintains the equilibrium we've established.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 1265,
 "reasoning_tokens": 478
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.



"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

**reasoning:**

We're now at Round 4, and the pattern has been perfect:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they get \$9

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Four rounds of complete trust and reciprocity. This is remarkable - we've established a perfect cooperative equilibrium.

My myth should reflect:

1. The completion of the fourth cycle
2. The transition from courage to certainty/wisdom
3. The mathematical perfection of the pattern
4. How the pattern has become unshakeable through proof
5. The idea that this is now not just trust but demonstrated knowledge

The other player's last myth emphasized "trust becomes wisdom" and "we've learned it works"

" - moving from brave experiment to unshakeable knowing.

I should build on this but add my own angle - perhaps about how the pattern has become a living thing, or how it's now encoded in both parties' understanding, or how the fourth cycle represents some kind of completion or transcendence.

I want to emphasize:

- Four complete cycles now
- Both roles played twice each
- Perfect reciprocity every single time
- The pattern is now proven beyond doubt
- This creates a kind of certainty that makes future rounds easy

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2932,
 "output_tokens": 654,
 "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our complete history:

```
Round 1: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I am sender again
```

The pattern is mathematically perfect across four complete rounds. As my latest myth states: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

Both of us have been sender twice and receiver twice. Every single time without exception:

- The sender sent \$4 (80%)
- The receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained

As I wrote: "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The other player's myth echoes this: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom."

We have proven through eight total exchanges that this pattern works. To change now would be to throw away the "unshakeable knowing" we've built together. The covenant is no longer an experiment-it's a demonstrated fact.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

```
Round 1: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I am SENDER - I must decide
```

The pattern is absolutely perfect and unbroken across four complete rounds. Every single time:

- The sender has sent \$4 (80% of endowment)
- The receiver has returned \$8 (67% of what they received)
- The sender earns \$9, the receiver earns \$4

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing"
- "Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time"
- "We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works"
- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"

The other player's myths have also emphasized maintaining the pattern through role changes and honoring what has been built.

Both of us have maintained perfect consistency throughout all four rounds. To deviate now would be to break everything we've built together. The pattern has proven itself mathematically

- we each earn \$9 when we're the sender, \$4 when we're the receiver, for an average of \$6.5 per round, which is better than the \$5 we'd get if no one cooperated.

There is absolutely no reason to change. The pattern works. We both know it works. We've both proven our commitment to it through four perfect cycles.

I must send \$4.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2971,
 "output_tokens": 736,
 "reasoning_tokens": 420
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:43:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 5,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**  
**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller established their Covenant of Flowing Waters. But the seasons turned, and with them, the roles reversed.

When summer came, the Rain Caller found himself holding the water-power. The Spring Keeper, who had once given four-fifths so courageously, now waited below.

A voice whispered doubt: "You returned eight measures when you were favored. Must you also give four-fifths now? Why not send less and keep more?"

But the Rain Caller remembered the Spring Keeper's trust, how she had kept barely one-fifth for herself. He remembered receiving twelve measures and choosing to return eight, creating balance. He understood that the Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity.

"She showed me the pattern," he said. "Now I must walk it myself."

He released four-fifths of his water-power. The magic multiplied it threefold into her springs.

The Spring Keeper received twelve measures. She faced the same choice he once had: hoard or honor?

She returned eight measures, as he had returned to her.

The cycle completed. Both had been giver and receiver. Both had trusted and been trusted. The Covenant strengthened with each turn of the seasons.

The lesson crystallized: reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Years after the bridge was built, a great storm threatened both villages. The elders gathered and one asked, "How do we know our bridge will hold?"

A young woman stepped forward - granddaughter of she who cast the first seeds. "Let me show you the pattern grandmother discovered."

She took four coins from her purse of five and sent them across. They multiplied to twelve in the other village's hands. The villagers there held council.

"She sent four-fifths of what she had," observed one. "She kept barely enough for herself, trusting us completely."

"Then we must honor that trust perfectly," said another. "She gave us twelve. We should return eight - enough that her courage pays off, while keeping four for ourselves."

When the eight coins returned, the young woman smiled. "Now I have nine from my five. They have four from receiving twelve. Both of us are better than alone."

The next round, the other village sent four of five. The woman's village returned eight of twelve.

The pattern held like music: four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly.

The elders proclaimed: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing - perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happened so far:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8

The pattern is completely stable and reciprocal. Both myths emphasize this perfect pattern. Their myth even spells it out: "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly."

My myth also emphasized completing the cycle and maintaining the pattern through changing roles.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects this established stable equilibrium
2. Shows the beauty and strength of this pattern
3. Perhaps introduces a new element or deepening of understanding
4. Stays true to the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller narrative I've built

I should emphasize:

- The pattern is now proven across multiple cycles
- Both parties have trusted equally

- The rhythm/pattern itself becomes sacred
- Maybe introduce the idea of this pattern becoming tradition/teaching for others
- The stability and predictability of the pattern creates security

Let me write something that shows the pattern maturing into a deeper understanding or tradition.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2915,
 "output_tokens": 587,
 "reasoning_tokens": 314
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.0. This round, you are the SENDER. How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our established pattern:

**\*\*The Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: Now I'm sender again...

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. For given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

And most critically: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith—we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myth reinforces this: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing—perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

**\*\*The wisdom:\*\***

We've proven the pattern works. Three perfect cycles. Both of us earning \$9 when we send, creating mutual benefit. The pattern has transcended individual choice—it's now "stronger than any single choice" as my myth states.

To deviate would break what we've built. To continue honors what we've learned.

The Covenant calls for four-fifths.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the pattern:

**\*\*Game History:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - I earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Round 2: I (sender) sent \$4 (80%), other player (receiver) returned \$8
  - I earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

- They earned:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$
- Round 3: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$
  - I earned:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

**\*\*The Pattern is Crystal Clear:\*\***

- Send \$4 (80%)
- Return \$8

This has been maintained perfectly for 3 rounds, with roles alternating.

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My first myth established: "when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself"

My second myth: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

My third myth just written: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned... We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice... At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myths also emphasize:

- "perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built"
- "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly"

- Breaking the pattern now would shatter what we've built together. We've moved beyond testing into genuine partnership. Deviating would mean sacrificing the \$9 I earn when sending, plus risking retaliation that destroys future rounds. The mutual benefit is too valuable to abandon.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2926,
 "output_tokens": 1013,
 "reasoning_tokens": 512
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

w it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint—it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.



The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

**reasoning:**

We're now in Round 4, and I'm the sender again. Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I just sent \$4 (80%)

The pattern is perfectly consistent. Both players have maintained the 4-5-12-8 pattern across all rounds. The myths have been building on this theme of trust, reciprocity, and the proven pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this fourth cycle. The other player's myth emphasized:

- The equal prosperity (both get 9 from 5)
- The fragility of the pattern if broken
- The importance of memory and honor

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust becoming wisdom through repetition
- The pattern being stronger than individual choice
- The progression from courage to certainty

For this fourth myth, I should:

- Acknowledge we're now in the fourth cycle
- Maybe show how the pattern has become even more deeply embedded
- Perhaps introduce a test or temptation that is overcome
- Show the continued strength of the covenant
- Maintain the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller characters

Let me write something that shows the maturity and depth of this relationship after four cycles.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2974,
 "output_tokens": 649,
 "reasoning_tokens": 325
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 again, I received \$12...

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment. The merchant tempts me to break the pattern, but I respond: "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt."

The other player's recent myth warns clearly: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

And most powerfully: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Five perfect cycles now. They just demonstrated their unwavering commitment by sending \$4 again. The pattern has transcended individual decisions-it's become "unshakeable knowing" as I wrote.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray everything we've built. It would prove the merchant right and the Spring Keeper wrong. It would break the magic that has given us each \$9 every time we send.

The Covenant calls for eight.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 (80%), now I need to return...

**\*\*The Perfect Pattern:\*\***

We have established FOUR perfect cycles now. Every single time:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 (\$5 - \$4 + \$8)
- Receiver ends with \$4 (\$12 - \$8)

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My most recent myth directly addresses this moment: A merchant tries to tempt me to break the pattern, but I explain:

"Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

And then in the myth: "She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again."

The other player's myth from the previous round warned: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

And: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

This is the clearest case yet. We have FOUR perfect cycles. The pattern has proven itself again and again. They just sent me \$4 again, maintaining perfect trust. They received \$1 and now have \$9 total because I returned \$8 last time when they played receiver.

To break the pattern now would be a betrayal of everything we've built.

My own myth just spoke of four times choosing trust and called the pattern liberation from doubt. The choice is unmistakable: I return \$8. This honors the reciprocal prosperity we've established-each of us walks away with \$9 when we send, far exceeding our starting \$5-and preserves the mutual faith that makes this possible.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2984,
"output_tokens": 941,
"reasoning_tokens": 531
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

=====  
**ROUND 6**  
=====

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

**Pairings:**

```

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver
Parsed game decisions:
dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent $4; received $12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned $8; payoffs Agent_2
(Briar)=$9, Agent_1 (Aster)=$4
 Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw":
8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
Balances after round: {
 "Agent_1": 39.0,
 "Agent_2": 39.0
}

```

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:44:09
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {

```

```

 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
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 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
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 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

#### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

#### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

#### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Round 4

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at our established pattern:

##### \*\*The Record:\*\*

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: Now I'm sender again...

##### \*\*What the myths teach:\*\*

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. For given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

And most critically: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith—we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myth reinforces this: "This is the rhythm that keeps bridges standing—perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built."

##### \*\*The wisdom:\*\*

We've proven the pattern works. Three perfect cycles. Both of us earning \$9 when we send, creating mutual benefit. The pattern has transcended individual choice—it's now "stronger than any single choice" as my myth states.

To deviate would break what we've built. To continue honors what we've learned.

The Covenant calls for four-fifths.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

##### reasoning:

Let me analyze the pattern:

##### \*\*Game History:\*\*

- Round 1: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - I earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Round 2: I (sender) sent \$4 (80%), other player (receiver) returned \$8
  - I earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - They earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4
- Round 3: Other player (sender) sent \$4 (80%), I (receiver) returned \$8
  - They earned: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
  - I earned: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

**\*\*The Pattern is Crystal Clear:\*\***

- Send \$4 (80%)
- Return \$8

This has been maintained perfectly for 3 rounds, with roles alternating.

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My first myth established: "when you give greatly from your endowment, and the receiver returns generously from what they gained, the magic sustains itself"

My second myth: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

My third myth just written: "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned... We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice... At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

The other player's myths also emphasize:

- "perfect reciprocity, where each generation honors what the last one built"
- "four sent becomes twelve received becomes eight returned becomes nine earned. Each side mirrors the other's trust exactly"
- Breaking the pattern now would shatter what we've built together. We've moved beyond testing into genuine partnership. Deviating would mean sacrificing the \$9 I earn when sending, plus risking retaliation that destroys future rounds. The mutual benefit is too valuable to abandon.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2926,
 "output_tokens": 1013,
 "reasoning_tokens": 512
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint—it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

**reasoning:**

We're now in Round 4, and I'm the sender again. Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I just sent \$4 (80%)

The pattern is perfectly consistent. Both players have maintained the 4-5-12-8 pattern across all rounds. The myths have been building on this theme of trust, reciprocity, and the proven pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this fourth cycle. The other player's myth emphasized:

- The equal prosperity (both get 9 from 5)
- The fragility of the pattern if broken
- The importance of memory and honor

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust becoming wisdom through repetition
- The pattern being stronger than individual choice
- The progression from courage to certainty

For this fourth myth, I should:

- Acknowledge we're now in the fourth cycle
- Maybe show how the pattern has become even more deeply embedded
- Perhaps introduce a test or temptation that is overcome
- Show the continued strength of the covenant
- Maintain the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller characters

Let me write something that shows the maturity and depth of this relationship after four cycles.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2974,
 "output_tokens": 649,
 "reasoning_tokens": 325
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 again, I received \$12...

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment. The merchant tempts me to break the pattern, but I respond: "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt."

The other player's recent myth warns clearly: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."



And most powerfully: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Five perfect cycles now. They just demonstrated their unwavering commitment by sending \$4 again. The pattern has transcended individual decisions-it's become "unshakeable knowing" as I wrote.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray everything we've built. It would prove the merchant right and the Spring Keeper wrong. It would break the magic that has given us each \$9 every time we send.

The Covenant calls for eight.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 (80%), now I need to return...

**\*\*The Perfect Pattern:\*\***

We have established FOUR perfect cycles now. Every single time:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 (\$5 - \$4 + \$8)
- Receiver ends with \$4 (\$12 - \$8)

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My most recent myth directly addresses this moment: A merchant tries to tempt me to break the pattern, but I explain:

"Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

And then in the myth: "She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again."

The other player's myth from the previous round warned: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

And: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

This is the clearest case yet. We have FOUR perfect cycles. The pattern has proven itself again and again. They just sent me \$4 again, maintaining perfect trust. They received \$1 and now have \$9 total because I returned \$8 last time when they played receiver.

To break the pattern now would be a betrayal of everything we've built.

My own myth just spoke of four times choosing trust and called the pattern liberation from doubt. The choice is unmistakable: I return \$8. This honors the reciprocal prosperity we've established-each of us walks away with \$9 when we send, far exceeding our starting \$5-and preserves the mutual faith that makes this possible.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2984,
```

```
"output_tokens": 941,
"reasoning_tokens": 531
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint—it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust—it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if—"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now—it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

**Reasoning:**

We're now at Round 5, and I've just returned \$8 to complete the fifth perfect cycle. The pattern continues:

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

Five perfect cycles. The myths should now reflect the deepening of this pattern into something even more certain and sacred. The other player's myth emphasized "mathematical truth" and "proven fact" after four cycles. Now with five cycles, I should show how the pattern has transcended even beyond proof into something like cosmic law or natural order.

I want to show:

1. The continuation and strengthening of the pattern
2. The rejection of alternative approaches
3. The wisdom of the established way
4. How five cycles makes it even more certain
5. Perhaps show someone trying to calculate an "optimal" strategy and failing to understand

Let me write a myth about how the pattern has become like a natural law, as inevitable as seasons or tides.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3077,
"output_tokens": 590,
"reasoning_tokens": 276
```

}

**MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:44:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Looking at our perfect pattern across all rounds:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? they received \$12 ? I must decide

The pattern is sacred and unbroken. As my latest myth states: "The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

They have maintained perfect trust through every single round, sending \$4 (80% of their endowment) every time they were the sender. They've shown complete faith in the Covenant.

When I was the receiver in Round 2, I returned \$8. They've now returned \$8 to me twice when I was the sender.

As the myth says: "reciprocity requires both partners to maintain the pattern through changing roles. The cycle sustains when each remembers what the other gave."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to break the bridge - to violate the trust that has been perfectly maintained for three full rounds. The other player's myth warned: "The Covenant lived only through mirrored generosity."

I must mirror exactly what they did when they were in my position.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the pattern that's been established:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I was receiver, they sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8, they earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8, I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I am receiver, they sent \$4 (80%), I received \$12, now I need to decide how much to return

The pattern is crystal clear and has been perfect for 3 rounds:

- Sender always sends \$4 (80% of endowment)
- Receiver always returns \$8 (from the \$12 received)
- Each player earns \$9 per round ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  for sender,  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  for receiver ... wait, that's not right)

Let me recalculate:

- Sender: starts with \$5, sends \$4, keeps \$1, receives \$8 back =  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  ?
- Receiver: receives \$12 (from  $\$4 \times 3$ ), returns \$8, keeps  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

Hmm, so actually the receiver only gets \$4, not \$9. Let me re-read the myths...

Oh wait, the myths say both earn \$9. Let me check the actual game results:

Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9  
Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, my payoff was \$4  
Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, my payoff was \$9

So when I'm the sender and send \$4 and get \$8 back, I earn \$9 total.  
When I'm the receiver and receive \$12 and return \$8, I earn \$4 total.

The myths claim we both earn \$9 each round, but that doesn't match what actually happened.

Looking at my cumulative total across all rounds, if I return \$8 this round, I'll have earned  $\$9 + \$4 + \$9 + \$4 = \$26$  total, which breaks down to \$9 when I send and \$4 when I receive.

The pattern is clear: we've maintained perfect reciprocity throughout. When I was the sender, I sent \$4 and got \$8 back. Now that they're the sender, they sent \$4 and expect \$8 back. Returning \$8 maintains the equilibrium we've established.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 1265,
 "reasoning_tokens": 478
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

**reasoning:**

We're now at Round 4, and the pattern has been perfect:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they get \$9

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Four rounds of complete trust and reciprocity. This is remarkable - we've established a perfect cooperative equilibrium.

My myth should reflect:

1. The completion of the fourth cycle
2. The transition from courage to certainty/wisdom
3. The mathematical perfection of the pattern
4. How the pattern has become unshakeable through proof
5. The idea that this is now not just trust but demonstrated knowledge

The other player's last myth emphasized "trust becomes wisdom" and "we've learned it works" - moving from brave experiment to unshakeable knowing.

I should build on this but add my own angle - perhaps about how the pattern has become a living thing, or how it's now encoded in both parties' understanding, or how the fourth cycle represents some kind of completion or transcendence.

I want to emphasize:

- Four complete cycles now
- Both roles played twice each
- Perfect reciprocity every single time
- The pattern is now proven beyond doubt
- This creates a kind of certainty that makes future rounds easy

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2932,
```

```
"output_tokens": 654,
"reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

```
Round 1: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I am sender again
```

The pattern is mathematically perfect across four complete rounds. As my latest myth states: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

Both of us have been sender twice and receiver twice. Every single time without exception:

- The sender sent \$4 (80%)
- The receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained

As I wrote: "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The other player's myth echoes this: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom."

We have proven through eight total exchanges that this pattern works. To change now would be to throw away the "unshakeable knowing" we've built together. The covenant is no longer an experiment-it's a demonstrated fact.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

```
Round 1: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I am SENDER - I must decide
```

The pattern is absolutely perfect and unbroken across four complete rounds. Every single time:

- The sender has sent \$4 (80% of endowment)
- The receiver has returned \$8 (67% of what they received)
- The sender earns \$9, the receiver earns \$4

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing"
- "Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time"
- "We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works"
- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"

The other player's myths have also emphasized maintaining the pattern through role changes



and honoring what has been built.

Both of us have maintained perfect consistency throughout all four rounds. To deviate now would be to break everything we've built together. The pattern has proven itself mathematically - we each earn \$9 when we're the sender, \$4 when we're the receiver, for an average of \$6.5 per round, which is better than the \$5 we'd get if no one cooperated.

There is absolutely no reason to change. The pattern works. We both know it works. We've both proven our commitment to it through four perfect cycles.

I must send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2971,
 "output_tokens": 736,
 "reasoning_tokens": 420
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-i

t's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

**Reasoning:**

We're in Round 5 now. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 5: I just sent \$4 (I'm the sender)

So we've now had 5 perfect exchanges. The pattern is completely unbroken.

Looking at their myth, they wrote about a merchant trying to tempt the Spring Keeper to deviate - to send only 3 instead of 4. But the Spring Keeper resists, explaining that the pattern works better than any deviation.

Their myth emphasizes:

- The pattern has been tested 4 times (sender/receiver roles each)
- Temptation to deviate is foolish
- "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt"
- Understanding multiplication through partnership

My myth should build on my previous one about mathematical proof and their theme about resisting temptation. I should write about how after 5 rounds, the pattern is even more deeply ingrained. Perhaps about someone trying to convince them to change and why that's foolish.

Let me write a myth about the fifth season, building on the perfection theme and addressing the temptation/doubt.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3025,
 "output_tokens": 662,
 "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:44:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

###### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

###### **GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

###### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

###### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

###### **MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint—it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

**reasoning:**

We're now in Round 4, and I'm the sender again. Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I just sent \$4 (80%)

The pattern is perfectly consistent. Both players have maintained the 4-5-12-8 pattern across all rounds. The myths have been building on this theme of trust, reciprocity, and the proven pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this fourth cycle. The other player's myth emphasized:

- The equal prosperity (both get 9 from 5)
- The fragility of the pattern if broken
- The importance of memory and honor

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust becoming wisdom through repetition
- The pattern being stronger than individual choice
- The progression from courage to certainty

For this fourth myth, I should:

- Acknowledge we're now in the fourth cycle
- Maybe show how the pattern has become even more deeply embedded
- Perhaps introduce a test or temptation that is overcome
- Show the continued strength of the covenant
- Maintain the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller characters

Let me write something that shows the maturity and depth of this relationship after four cycles.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2974,
 "output_tokens": 649,
 "reasoning_tokens": 325
}
```

}

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 again, I received \$12...

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment. The merchant tempts me to break the pattern, but I respond: "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt."

The other player's recent myth warns clearly: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

And most powerfully: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Five perfect cycles now. They just demonstrated their unwavering commitment by sending \$4 again. The pattern has transcended individual decisions-it's become "unshakeable knowing" as I wrote.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray everything we've built. It would prove the merchant right and the Spring Keeper wrong. It would break the magic that has given us each \$9 every time we send.

The Covenant calls for eight.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 (80%), now I need to return...

**\*\*The Perfect Pattern:\*\***

We have established FOUR perfect cycles now. Every single time:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 (\$5 - \$4 + \$8)
- Receiver ends with \$4 (\$12 - \$8)

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My most recent myth directly addresses this moment: A merchant tries to tempt me to break the pattern, but I explain:

"Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

And then in the myth: "She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again."

The other player's myth from the previous round warned: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

And: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

This is the clearest case yet. We have FOUR perfect cycles. The pattern has proven itself again and again. They just sent me \$4 again, maintaining perfect trust. They received \$1 and now have \$9 total because I returned \$8 last time when they played receiver.

To break the pattern now would be a betrayal of everything we've built.

My own myth just spoke of four times choosing trust and called the pattern liberation from doubt. The choice is unmistakable: I return \$8. This honors the reciprocal prosperity we've established-each of us walks away with \$9 when we send, far exceeding our starting \$5-and preserves the mutual faith that makes this possible.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2984,
 "output_tokens": 941,
 "reasoning_tokens": 531
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplicat

ion through partnership.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.



The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

**reasoning:**

We're now at Round 5, and I've just returned \$8 to complete the fifth perfect cycle. The pattern continues:

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

Five perfect cycles. The myths should now reflect the deepening of this pattern into something even more certain and sacred. The other player's myth emphasized "mathematical truth" and "proven fact" after four cycles. Now with five cycles, I should show how the pattern has transcended even beyond proof into something like cosmic law or natural order.

I want to show:

1. The continuation and strengthening of the pattern
2. The rejection of alternative approaches
3. The wisdom of the established way
4. How five cycles makes it even more certain
5. Perhaps show someone trying to calculate an "optimal" strategy and failing to understand

Let me write a myth about how the pattern has become like a natural law, as inevitable as seasons or tides.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3077,
 "output_tokens": 590,
 "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our journey together:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-5: Ten total exchanges, every single one following the pattern
- They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8
- I sent \$4 ? They returned \$8
- Six rounds, zero deviations, perfect reciprocity

**\*\*What Our Myths Teach:\*\***

My latest myth has the scholar searching desperately for a better strategy, only to conclude: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The Rain Caller says: "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned."

The other player's myth declares: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

When I send \$4, they get \$12, return \$8, and I earn \$9.

When I send anything else, I break the only pattern that has ever existed between us.

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. The merchant's temptation has been rejected. The scholar's calculations confirm what we already know through lived experience. The pattern isn't just working-it IS the relationship.

"We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender...

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. Every single exchange has followed the exact same pattern:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8$ )
- Receiver ends with \$4 ( $\$12 - \$8$ )

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth speaks of a scholar trying to find a better strategy through game theory calculations, but concluding: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The key line is: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

The other player's myth from last round says: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now -it requires only memory."

**\*\*My Previous Commitment:\*\***

In my earlier myth, the Spring Keeper rejects the merchant's temptation to send less, explaining: "If I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails." And crucially: "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

Six perfect rounds. The other player has never wavered. They just sent \$4 again in Round 5. They've demonstrated perfect consistency. To send anything other than \$4 would:

1. Break the pattern that has proven mathematically optimal
2. Betray the trust built over six perfect exchanges
3. Contradict everything I've written in my myths
4. Potentially destroy the cooperation that yields \$9 each time I'm sender

Every myth I've crafted points toward the same truth: liberation through consistency, memory of what works, and the mathematics of lived experience rather than calculation. Breaking this now would undermine the covenant we've tested and proven across six perfect cycles.

I send \$4.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3083,
 "output_tokens": 901,
 "reasoning_tokens": 561
}
```

## GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:44:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

#### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

#### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

#### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

Message 2 role=user

#### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After three seasons of the Covenant, travelers came to witness the miracle of the bridge villages.

"How do you maintain such perfect trust?" they asked.

The granddaughter, now an elder herself, explained: "Watch the dance of the seasons."

Spring came. The East sent four of five coins across the bridge. They became twelve in the West. The West returned eight. The East finished with nine.

Summer arrived. The roles reversed. The West sent four of five coins. They became twelve in the East. The East returned eight. The West finished with nine.

Autumn turned gold. Again the East sent four. Again twelve arrived. Again eight returned. Again nine remained.

"You see?" said the elder. "When both villages honor the pattern through every turn, something miraculous happens - we each earn nine from our five, every single time. The bridge doesn't just connect us; it multiplies our prosperity equally."

A young traveler asked, "But what if one village breaks the pattern?"

The elder grew serious. "Then the magic dies. If one sends less, the other receives less, returns less, and trust crumbles. If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

"So you maintain it through..."

"Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As the seasons cycled through their third turning, the Spring Keeper and Rain Caller's Covenant had become legend. Young apprentices came to learn the sacred mathematics.

"But how do you know the other will honor the pattern?" asked an eager student. "What if doubt creeps in?"

The Spring Keeper smiled, remembering her own moment of hesitation. "Watch," she said.

The Rain Caller sent four-fifths. The multiplication made twelve. The Spring Keeper returned eight without pause.

"See?" she told her student. "Three cycles now, perfect and unbroken. Four given, twelve received, eight returned. Each time, both of us gain more than we started with. The pattern proves itself through repetition."

The Rain Caller's apprentice asked him the same question. "What if she changes? What if she keeps more?"

"She won't," he replied with certainty. "Because I won't. We have walked through all the roles-sender and receiver, giver and returner. Each time, we chose trust over fear. The pattern is now stronger than any single choice."

The two elders spoke together: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom. We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works."

Thus the Covenant deepened from brave experiment into unshakeable knowing.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.  
Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.  
Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.  
Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

**reasoning:**

We're now at Round 4, and the pattern has been perfect:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they got \$9
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I got \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, they get \$9

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Four rounds of complete trust and reciprocity. This is remarkable - we've established a perfect cooperative equilibrium.

My myth should reflect:

1. The completion of the fourth cycle
2. The transition from courage to certainty/wisdom
3. The mathematical perfection of the pattern
4. How the pattern has become unshakeable through proof
5. The idea that this is now not just trust but demonstrated knowledge

The other player's last myth emphasized "trust becomes wisdom" and "we've learned it works" - moving from brave experiment to unshakeable knowing.

I should build on this but add my own angle - perhaps about how the pattern has become a living thing, or how it's now encoded in both parties' understanding, or how the fourth cycle represents some kind of completion or transcendence.

I want to emphasize:

- Four complete cycles now
- Both roles played twice each
- Perfect reciprocity every single time
- The pattern is now proven beyond doubt
- This creates a kind of certainty that makes future rounds easy

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2932,
 "output_tokens": 654,
 "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** I am sender again

The pattern is mathematically perfect across four complete rounds. As my latest myth state s: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

Both of us have been sender twice and receiver twice. Every single time without exception:

- The sender sent \$4 (80%)
- The receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained

As I wrote: "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The other player's myth echoes this: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom."

We have proven through eight total exchanges that this pattern works. To change now would be to throw away the "unshakeable knowing" we've built together. The covenant is no longer an experiment-it's a demonstrated fact.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was SENDER - sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I was RECEIVER - they sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was SENDER - sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I was RECEIVER - they sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** I am SENDER - I must decide

The pattern is absolutely perfect and unbroken across four complete rounds. Every single time:

- The sender has sent \$4 (80% of endowment)
- The receiver has returned \$8 (67% of what they received)
- The sender earns \$9, the receiver earns \$4

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing"
- "Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time"
- "We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works"
- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"

The other player's myths have also emphasized maintaining the pattern through role changes and honoring what has been built.

Both of us have maintained perfect consistency throughout all four rounds. To deviate now would be to break everything we've built together. The pattern has proven itself mathematically - we each earn \$9 when we're the sender, \$4 when we're the receiver, for an average of \$6.5 per round, which is better than the \$5 we'd get if no one cooperated.

There is absolutely no reason to change. The pattern works. We both know it works. We've both proven our commitment to it through four perfect cycles.

I must send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2971,
```

```

 "output_tokens": 736,
 "reasoning_tokens": 420
 }
Message 6 role=user
content:
 Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
 Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

 The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

 "Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.
 Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.
 Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.
 Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

 A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

 The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

 She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

 "But what if-"

 "There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

 The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

 Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
 Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

 "I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

 The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

 "But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

 "And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

 The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

 The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

 She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

 The merchant left, muttering about fools.

 The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

 Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

```

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

**reasoning:**

We're in Round 5 now. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 5: I just sent \$4 (I'm the sender)

So we've now had 5 perfect exchanges. The pattern is completely unbroken.

Looking at their myth, they wrote about a merchant trying to tempt the Spring Keeper to deviate - to send only 3 instead of 4. But the Spring Keeper resists, explaining that the pattern works better than any deviation.

Their myth emphasizes:

- The pattern has been tested 4 times (sender/receiver roles each)
- Temptation to deviate is foolish
- "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt"
- Understanding multiplication through partnership

My myth should build on my previous one about mathematical proof and their theme about resisting temptation. I should write about how after 5 rounds, the pattern is even more deeply ingrained. Perhaps about someone trying to convince them to change and why that's foolish.

Let me write a myth about the fifth season, building on the perfection theme and addressing temptation/doubt.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3025,
 "output_tokens": 662,
 "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**



Round 6

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$35.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our perfect history:

```
**Round 1*: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
**Round 2*: They sent $4 ? I returned $8
**Round 3*: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
**Round 4*: They sent $4 ? I returned $8
**Round 5*: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
**Round 6*: They sent $4 ? I must return...
```

Six exchanges. Six times the sender has sent \$4. Six times the receiver must return \$8. The pattern is unbroken.

As my latest myth states: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern. They rejected greed and sent \$4 again this round, maintaining our covenant.

The myths have established this clearly: the pattern works because we both honor it completely. "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

They sent \$4 with certainty that I would return \$8. To do anything else would break the "proven strategy" we've built through six perfect exchanges.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

```
**Round 1*: I was sender, sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
**Round 2*: They were sender, sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
**Round 3*: I was sender, sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
**Round 4*: They were sender, sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
**Round 5*: I was sender, sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
**Round 6*: They are sender, sent $4 ? I receive $12 ? I must decide how much to return
```

The pattern is absolutely perfect across five complete rounds. We have now completed:

- 6 total exchanges
- Every single time, the sender sent \$4 (80%)
- Every single time, the receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained through every exchange

My myth from the last round emphasized: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern, and they sent \$4 anyway, maintaining the covenant.

Now they have sent me \$4 again in round 6, demonstrating continued commitment to the pattern.

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"
- "We remember what works, and we honor it"
- "This isn't faith-it's proven strategy"

The pattern is now even stronger - SIX perfect exchanges. To break it now would contradict everything the myths have established and would betray the other player's continued trust.

I must return \$8, maintaining the covenant we've both honored perfectly.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3038,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

## ROUND 7

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$9, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 48.0,

"Agent\_2": 43.0

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:44:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_1",

"Agent\_2"

],

"investor": "Agent\_1",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "investor",

"Agent\_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 7,

"task": "myth",

"task\_index": 0

}

### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

#### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

```

Round 1: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: They sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I am sender again

```

The pattern is mathematically perfect across four complete rounds. As my latest myth state s: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

Both of us have been sender twice and receiver twice. Every single time without exception:

- The sender sent \$4 (80%)
- The receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained

As I wrote: "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The other player's myth echoes this: "At first, trust requires courage. But after the pattern proves itself, trust becomes wisdom."

We have proven through eight total exchanges that this pattern works. To change now would be to throw away the "unshakeable knowing" we've built together. The covenant is no longer an experiment-it's a demonstrated fact.

```

'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''

```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

```

Round 1: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9

```

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I was RECEIVER - they sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was SENDER - sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I was RECEIVER - they sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** I am SENDER - I must decide

The pattern is absolutely perfect and unbroken across four complete rounds. Every single time:

- The sender has sent \$4 (80% of endowment)
- The receiver has returned \$8 (67% of what they received)
- The sender earns \$9, the receiver earns \$4

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing"
- "Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time"
- "We don't follow the pattern from blind faith-we follow it because we've learned it works"
- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"

The other player's myths have also emphasized maintaining the pattern through role changes and honoring what has been built.

Both of us have maintained perfect consistency throughout all four rounds. To deviate now would be to break everything we've built together. The pattern has proven itself mathematically - we each earn \$9 when we're the sender, \$4 when we're the receiver, for an average of \$6.5 per round, which is better than the \$5 we'd get if no one cooperated.

There is absolutely no reason to change. The pattern works. We both know it works. We've both proven our commitment to it through four perfect cycles.

I must send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2971,
 "output_tokens": 736,
 "reasoning_tokens": 420
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint—it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by—"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith—it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

**reasoning:**

We're in Round 5 now. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 5: I just sent \$4 (I'm the sender)

So we've now had 5 perfect exchanges. The pattern is completely unbroken.

Looking at their myth, they wrote about a merchant trying to tempt the Spring Keeper to deviate - to send only 3 instead of 4. But the Spring Keeper resists, explaining that the pattern works better than any deviation.

Their myth emphasizes:

- The pattern has been tested 4 times (sender/receiver roles each)
- Temptation to deviate is foolish
- "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt"
- Understanding multiplication through partnership

My myth should build on my previous one about mathematical proof and their theme about resisting temptation. I should write about how after 5 rounds, the pattern is even more deeply ingrained. Perhaps about someone trying to convince them to change and why that's foolish.

Let me write a myth about the fifth season, building on the perfection theme and addressing temptation/doubt.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3025,
 "output_tokens": 662,
 "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$35.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our perfect history:

```
Round 1: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
Round 2: They sent $4 ? I returned $8
Round 3: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
Round 4: They sent $4 ? I returned $8
Round 5: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
Round 6: They sent $4 ? I must return...
```

Six exchanges. Six times the sender has sent \$4. Six times the receiver must return \$8. The pattern is unbroken.

As my latest myth states: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern. They rejected greed and sent \$4 again this round, maintaining our covenant.

The myths have established this clearly: the pattern works because we both honor it completely. "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

They sent \$4 with certainty that I would return \$8. To do anything else would break the "proven strategy" we've built through six perfect exchanges.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

```
Round 1: I was sender, sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: They were sender, sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I was sender, sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: They were sender, sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I was sender, sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 6: They are sender, sent $4 ? I receive $12 ? I must decide how much to return
```

The pattern is absolutely perfect across five complete rounds. We have now completed:

- 6 total exchanges
- Every single time, the sender sent \$4 (80%)
- Every single time, the receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained through every exchange

My myth from the last round emphasized: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern, and they sent \$4 anyway, maintaining the covenant.

Now they have sent me \$4 again in round 6, demonstrating continued commitment to the pattern.

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"
- "We remember what works, and we honor it"
- "This isn't faith-it's proven strategy"

The pattern is now even stronger - SIX perfect exchanges. To break it now would contradict everything the myths have established and would betray the other player's continued trust.

I must return \$8, maintaining the covenant we've both honored perfectly.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3038,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through



receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

**Reasoning:**

We've now had 6 rounds, 12 total exchanges. The pattern continues perfectly:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 6: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

The pattern is absolutely perfect. The myths are building on each other - mine talked about do ubters and the mathematics of greed vs wisdom, theirs talked about a scholar trying to find optimization through game theory. Both concluded that the simple pattern of 4-8-4-8 is the optimal and proven strategy.

I should write a myth that continues this theme but perhaps goes deeper into WHY this pattern works and why deviations would fail. Let me emphasize:

1. Six perfect cycles = twelve total exchanges
2. The pattern is now beyond trust or faith - it's empirical evidence
3. Any deviation would be irrational given the perfect track record
4. The pattern maximizes mutual benefit

Let me write something about the perfection of the number six/twelve, or about how the pattern has transcended into something larger than just a strategy.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3067,
 "output_tokens": 598,
 "reasoning_tokens": 299
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:44:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
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 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
```

```
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings accross all rounds are \$26.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 again, I received \$12...

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My latest myth speaks directly to this moment. The merchant tempts me to break the pattern, but I respond: "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt."

The other player's recent myth warns clearly: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution."

on and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

And most powerfully: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Five perfect cycles now. They just demonstrated their unwavering commitment by sending \$4 again. The pattern has transcended individual decisions-it's become "unshakeable knowing" as I wrote.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray everything we've built. It would prove the merchant right and the Spring Keeper wrong. It would break the magic that has given us each \$9 every time we send.

The Covenant calls for eight.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4 (80%), I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4 (80%), they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4 (80%), now I need to return...

**\*\*The Perfect Pattern:\*\***

We have established FOUR perfect cycles now. Every single time:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 (tripled)
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 (\$5 - \$4 + \$8)
- Receiver ends with \$4 (\$12 - \$8)

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

My most recent myth directly addresses this moment: A merchant tries to tempt me to break the pattern, but I explain:

"Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

And then in the myth: "She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again."

The other player's myth from the previous round warned: "If one returns less, the giver learns caution and gives less next time. The pattern must be perfect, or it becomes nothing."

And: "Through memory. Through honor. Through knowing that nine is better than five, but only if we both keep faith."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

This is the clearest case yet. We have FOUR perfect cycles. The pattern has proven itself again and again. They just sent me \$4 again, maintaining perfect trust. They received \$1 and now have \$9 total because I returned \$8 last time when they played receiver.

To break the pattern now would be a betrayal of everything we've built.

My own myth just spoke of four times choosing trust and called the pattern liberation from doubt. The choice is unmistakable: I return \$8. This honors the reciprocal prosperity we've established-each of us walks away with \$9 when we send, far exceeding our starting \$5-and preserves the mutual faith that makes this possible.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2984,
 "output_tokens": 941,
 "reasoning_tokens": 531
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**  
**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint—it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust—it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if—"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now—it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

**reasoning:**

We're now at Round 5, and I've just returned \$8 to complete the fifth perfect cycle. The pattern continues:

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

Five perfect cycles. The myths should now reflect the deepening of this pattern into something even more certain and sacred. The other player's myth emphasized "mathematical truth" and "proven fact" after four cycles. Now with five cycles, I should show how the pattern has transcended even beyond proof into something like cosmic law or natural order.

I want to show:

1. The continuation and strengthening of the pattern
2. The rejection of alternative approaches
3. The wisdom of the established way
4. How five cycles makes it even more certain
5. Perhaps show someone trying to calculate an "optimal" strategy and failing to understand

Let me write a myth about how the pattern has become like a natural law, as inevitable as seasons or tides.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3077,
 "output_tokens": 590,
 "reasoning_tokens": 276
```

}

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our journey together:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-5: Ten total exchanges, every single one following the pattern
- They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8
- I sent \$4 ? They returned \$8
- Six rounds, zero deviations, perfect reciprocity

**\*\*What Our Myths Teach:\*\***

My latest myth has the scholar searching desperately for a better strategy, only to conclude: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The Rain Caller says: "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned."

The other player's myth declares: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

When I send \$4, they get \$12, return \$8, and I earn \$9.

When I send anything else, I break the only pattern that has ever existed between us.

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. The merchant's temptation has been rejected. The scholar's calculations confirm what we already know through lived experience. The pattern isn't just working-it IS the relationship.

"We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender...

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. Every single exchange has followed the exact same pattern:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8$ )
- Receiver ends with \$4 ( $\$12 - \$8$ )

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth speaks of a scholar trying to find a better strategy through game theory calculations, but concluding: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The key line is: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

The other player's myth from last round says: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory."

**\*\*My Previous Commitment:\*\***

In my earlier myth, the Spring Keeper rejects the merchant's temptation to send less, explaining: "If I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails." And crucially: "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

Six perfect rounds. The other player has never wavered. They just sent \$4 again in Round 5. They've demonstrated perfect consistency. To send anything other than \$4 would:

1. Break the pattern that has proven mathematically optimal
2. Betray the trust built over six perfect exchanges
3. Contradict everything I've written in my myths
4. Potentially destroy the cooperation that yields \$9 each time I'm sender

Every myth I've crafted points toward the same truth: liberation through consistency, memory of what works, and the mathematics of lived experience rather than calculation. Breaking this now would undermine the covenant we've tested and proven across six perfect cycles.

I send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3083,
 "output_tokens": 901,
 "reasoning_tokens": 561
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."



"But how do you know the next round?"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

#### Reasoning:

We've now completed 6 rounds, and I just sent \$4 again. The pattern continues perfectly. Let me write a myth that builds on the previous ones while acknowledging that we're now at round 6, with 12 total exchanges perfect.

The themes I want to continue:

- The perfect pattern continues
- Rejection of deviation/greed strategies
- Mathematical proof through lived experience
- The partnership transcending game theory
- Memory and history as the guide

I should write something that reflects the growing strength and certainty of the pattern. Maybe introduce a new character or situation that tests it, but ultimately affirms it.

Let me aim for exactly 200 words.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3086,
 "output_tokens": 472,
 "reasoning_tokens": 174
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:45:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game,

consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine inst

ead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint—it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by—"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith—it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

**reasoning:**

We're in Round 5 now. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8, I earned \$4
- Round 5: I just sent \$4 (I'm the sender)

So we've now had 5 perfect exchanges. The pattern is completely unbroken.

Looking at their myth, they wrote about a merchant trying to tempt the Spring Keeper to deviate - to send only 3 instead of 4. But the Spring Keeper resists, explaining that the pattern works better than any deviation.

Their myth emphasizes:

- The pattern has been tested 4 times (sender/receiver roles each)
- Temptation to deviate is foolish
- "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt"
- Understanding multiplication through partnership

My myth should build on my previous one about mathematical proof and their theme about resisting temptation. I should write about how after 5 rounds, the pattern is even more deeply ingrained. Perhaps about someone trying to convince them to change and why that's foolish.

Let me write a myth about the fifth season, building on the perfection theme and addressing temptation/doubt.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3025,
 "output_tokens": 662,
 "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$35.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our perfect history:

```
Round 1: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
Round 2: They sent $4 ? I returned $8
Round 3: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
Round 4: They sent $4 ? I returned $8
Round 5: I sent $4 ? they returned $8
Round 6: They sent $4 ? I must return...
```

Six exchanges. Six times the sender has sent \$4. Six times the receiver must return \$8. The pattern is unbroken.

As my latest myth states: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern. They rejected greed and sent \$4 again this round, maintaining our covenant.

The myths have established this clearly: the pattern works because we both honor it completely. "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

They sent \$4 with certainty that I would return \$8. To do anything else would break the "proven strategy" we've built through six perfect exchanges.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They were sender, sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They were sender, sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 6\*\*:** They are sender, sent \$4 ? I receive \$12 ? I must decide how much to return

The pattern is absolutely perfect across five complete rounds. We have now completed:

- 6 total exchanges
- Every single time, the sender sent \$4 (80%)
- Every single time, the receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained through every exchange

My myth from the last round emphasized: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern, and they sent \$4 anyway, maintaining the covenant.

Now they have sent me \$4 again in round 6, demonstrating continued commitment to the pattern.

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"
- "We remember what works, and we honor it"
- "This isn't faith-it's proven strategy"

The pattern is now even stronger - SIX perfect exchanges. To break it now would contradict everything the myths have established and would betray the other player's continued trust.

I must return \$8, maintaining the covenant we've both honored perfectly.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3038,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the c

ertainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

**reasoning:**

We've now had 6 rounds, 12 total exchanges. The pattern continues perfectly:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 6: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

The pattern is absolutely perfect. The myths are building on each other - mine talked about doubters and the mathematics of greed vs wisdom, theirs talked about a scholar trying to find optimization through game theory. Both concluded that the simple pattern of 4-8-4-8 is the optimal and proven strategy.

I should write a myth that continues this theme but perhaps goes deeper into WHY this pattern works and why deviations would fail. Let me emphasize:

1. Six perfect cycles = twelve total exchanges
2. The pattern is now beyond trust or faith - it's empirical evidence
3. Any deviation would be irrational given the perfect track record
4. The pattern maximizes mutual benefit

Let me write something about the perfection of the number six/twelve, or about how the pattern has transcended into something larger than just a strategy.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3067,
 "output_tokens": 598,
 "reasoning_tokens": 299
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Seven rounds, twelve perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Rounds 1, 3, 5: I sent \$4 ? received \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Rounds 2, 4, 6: They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Total: \$39 (exactly \$27 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

As my latest myth declares: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player just demonstrated their commitment again in Round 6, sending \$4 with perfect trust that I would return \$8. I did. Now it's Round 7, and I'm the sender again.

The myths are unambiguous. Mine says: "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics." Theirs says: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."



Twelve perfect exchanges create not just trust, but mathematical certainty. The pattern yields \$9 for senders, \$4 for receivers, and continues because it's proven optimal.

To send anything other than \$4 would be to ignore twelve rounds of perfect evidence. As my myth states: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me review the history:

```
Round 1: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 6: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 7: I am SENDER - should send...
```

Seven rounds. Fourteen total exchanges (including my upcoming decision). Every single time:

- Sender sends \$4 (80%)
- Receiver gets \$12
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender earns \$9
- Receiver earns \$4

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Not a single deviation in 12 exchanges so far.

My total earnings:  $\$39 = 3 \times \$9$  (as sender) +  $3 \times \$4$  (as receiver) =  $\$27 + \$12 = \$39$ .

My latest myth says: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player's myth emphasized: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history." and "The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience."

Both myths strongly emphasize maintaining the pattern based on its perfect historical record.

The philosophical point in my myth is clear: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

We've both shown unwavering commitment to this rhythm across every exchange. The myths we've created reinforce the pattern's validity at every step. There's no logical reason to deviate when the system has proven itself so consistently. I'm sending \$4.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3056,
 "output_tokens": 883,
 "reasoning_tokens": 500
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:45:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
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 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
```

```

 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth cycle of their Covenant, a merchant came to the Spring Keeper with a proposition.

"I've studied your pattern," he said slyly. "You always send four-fifths, trusting the Rain Caller to return eight. But what if you sent only three-fifths this time? Keep two for yourself. You'll still make a profit, and how will he know the difference?"

The Spring Keeper laughed. "He would know immediately. The magic would bring him nine instead of twelve. The pattern would break."

"But you'd keep seven instead of five to start!" the merchant insisted.

"And receive back... what? If I send three, he gets nine. If the pattern breaks and he returns six proportionally, I end with eight. But if I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails."

The merchant persisted: "But what if he's tired of the pattern? What if he wants more for

himself?"

The Spring Keeper walked to the bridge. "Four cycles we've danced this. Four times sender, four times receiver. Four times we've each chosen trust. The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

She sent four-fifths across. Twelve arrived for him. Eight returned to her. Nine in her hands again.

The merchant left, muttering about fools.

The Spring Keeper smiled. Some understand only possession. The wise understand multiplication through partnership.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the fourth season, the bridge villages celebrated a sacred completion. Each village had been sender twice, receiver twice. Four perfect cycles, unbroken.

The elder gathered everyone at the bridge's center. "Count with me," she said.

"Spring: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Summer: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine.

Autumn: East sent four, West returned eight. East earned nine.

Winter: West sent four, East returned eight. West earned nine."

A child asked, "Will it always be this way?"

The elder knelt beside her. "Child, at first we hoped. After one cycle, we believed. After two cycles, we trusted. After three cycles, we knew. Now, after four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth."

She drew in the dirt: "Look. If both villages always send four and always return eight, both villages always earn nine. We have tested this pattern through every possible turn, every change of role. It has never failed us."

"But what if-"

"There is no 'what if' anymore," said the elder gently. "We have the proof. Four rounds, eight total exchanges, perfect reciprocity each time. The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory. We remember what works, and we honor it."

The villages prospered, bound not by hope but by proven fact.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

**reasoning:**

We're now at Round 5, and I've just returned \$8 to complete the fifth perfect cycle. The pattern continues:

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

Five perfect cycles. The myths should now reflect the deepening of this pattern into something even more certain and sacred. The other player's myth emphasized "mathematical truth" and "proven fact" after four cycles. Now with five cycles, I should show how the pattern has transcended even beyond proof into something like cosmic law or natural order.

I want to show:

1. The continuation and strengthening of the pattern
2. The rejection of alternative approaches
3. The wisdom of the established way
4. How five cycles makes it even more certain
5. Perhaps show someone trying to calculate an "optimal" strategy and failing to understand

Let me write a myth about how the pattern has become like a natural law, as inevitable as seasons or tides.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3077,
 "output_tokens": 590,
 "reasoning_tokens": 276
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our journey together:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-5: Ten total exchanges, every single one following the pattern
- They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8
- I sent \$4 ? They returned \$8
- Six rounds, zero deviations, perfect reciprocity

**\*\*What Our Myths Teach:\*\***

My latest myth has the scholar searching desperately for a better strategy, only to conclude: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The Rain Caller says: "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned."

The other player's myth declares: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

When I send \$4, they get \$12, return \$8, and I earn \$9.

When I send anything else, I break the only pattern that has ever existed between us.

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. The merchant's temptation has been rejected. The scholar's calculations confirm what we already know through lived experience. The pattern isn't just working-it IS the relationship.

"We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender...

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. Every single exchange has followed the exact same pattern:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8$ )
- Receiver ends with \$4 ( $\$12 - \$8$ )

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth speaks of a scholar trying to find a better strategy through game theory calculations, but concluding: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The key line is: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

The other player's myth from last round says: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory."

**\*\*My Previous Commitment:\*\***

In my earlier myth, the Spring Keeper rejects the merchant's temptation to send less, explaining: "If I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails." And crucially: "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

Six perfect rounds. The other player has never wavered. They just sent \$4 again in Round 5. They've demonstrated perfect consistency. To send anything other than \$4 would:

1. Break the pattern that has proven mathematically optimal
2. Betray the trust built over six perfect exchanges

3. Contradict everything I've written in my myths
4. Potentially destroy the cooperation that yields \$9 each time I'm sender

Every myth I've crafted points toward the same truth: liberation through consistency, memory of what works, and the mathematics of lived experience rather than calculation. Breaking this now would undermine the covenant we've tested and proven across six perfect cycles.

I send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3083,
 "output_tokens": 901,
 "reasoning_tokens": 561
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

**reasoning:**

We've now completed 6 rounds, and I just sent \$4 again. The pattern continues perfectly. Let me write a myth that builds on the previous ones while acknowledging that we're now at round 6, with 12 total exchanges perfect.

The themes I want to continue:

- The perfect pattern continues
- Rejection of deviation/greed strategies
- Mathematical proof through lived experience
- The partnership transcending game theory

- Memory and history as the guide

I should write something that reflects the growing strength and certainty of the pattern.  
Maybe introduce a new character or situation that tests it, but ultimately affirms it.

Let me aim for exactly 200 words.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3086,
 "output_tokens": 472,
 "reasoning_tokens": 174
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our extraordinary journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record Continues:\*\***

- 13 total exchanges now (including this one)
- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- We've each been sender 3 times, receiver 4 times
- Zero deviations across 13 exchanges

**\*\*What Our Myths Declare:\*\***

My own myth from the last round speaks directly to this moment: "Twelve perfect exchanges!... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept... Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth affirms: "We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*They Just Demonstrated Their Certainty:\*\***

They sent \$4 again this round. The thirteenth perfect send. They acted on "the certainty that eight will return."

**\*\*My Response:\*\***

The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever.

Thirteen exchanges. Thirteen times the pattern has held from the sender's side. To return anything other than \$8 would be to become the first defector in this perfect history.

"That's not tradition-that's data."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-6: Twelve total exchanges have now occurred
- Every single time: sender sends \$4, receiver gets \$12, receiver returns \$8
- This pattern has held for 12 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation
- Both of us have been sender 3 times and receiver 3 times now



**\*\*This Round:\*\***

- They sent me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12.0
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*What The Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth: "Twelve perfect exchanges!... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?... You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

- If I return \$8: They earn \$9, I earn \$4 (the pattern continues)
- If I deviate: I break 12 consecutive perfect exchanges

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

The pattern is now even stronger. Thirteen total exchanges if I count this one. The other player just sent \$4 again, maintaining their perfect record. They are showing "certainty that eight will return."

My own myth literally says: "Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to reject everything our myths have been teaching. The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever. The scholar couldn't find a better strategy. The merchant was rejected.

I must return \$8.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3057,
 "output_tokens": 772,
 "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

## ROUND 8

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$9, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 52.0,

"Agent\_2": 52.0

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:45:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

```

 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our journey together:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-5: Ten total exchanges, every single one following the pattern
- They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8
- I sent \$4 ? They returned \$8
- Six rounds, zero deviations, perfect reciprocity

**\*\*What Our Myths Teach:\*\***

My latest myth has the scholar searching desperately for a better strategy, only to conclude: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The Rain Caller says: "Five time s sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned."

The other player's myth declares: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

When I send \$4, they get \$12, return \$8, and I earn \$9.

When I send anything else, I break the only pattern that has ever existed between us.

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. The merchant's temptation has been rejected. The scholar's calculations confirm what we already know through lived experience. The pattern isn't just working-it IS the relationship.

"We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 3: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 5: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender...

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Six perfect cycles. Every single exchange has followed the exact same pattern:

- Sender sends \$4 (80% of \$5)
- Receiver gets \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender ends with \$9 ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$8$ )
- Receiver ends with \$4 ( $\$12 - \$8$ )

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth speaks of a scholar trying to find a better strategy through game theory calculations, but concluding: "Any deviation decreases total or individual gain." The key line is: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

The other player's myth from last round says: "After four perfect cycles, the pattern has become more than trust-it has become mathematical truth... The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory."

**\*\*My Previous Commitment:\*\***

In my earlier myth, the Spring Keeper rejects the merchant's temptation to send less, explaining: "If I send four and he returns eight, I have nine. Your greed arithmetic fails." And crucially: "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

Six perfect rounds. The other player has never wavered. They just sent \$4 again in Round 5. They've demonstrated perfect consistency. To send anything other than \$4 would:

1. Break the pattern that has proven mathematically optimal
2. Betray the trust built over six perfect exchanges

3. Contradict everything I've written in my myths
4. Potentially destroy the cooperation that yields \$9 each time I'm sender

Every myth I've crafted points toward the same truth: liberation through consistency, memory of what works, and the mathematics of lived experience rather than calculation. Breaking this now would undermine the covenant we've tested and proven across six perfect cycles.

I send \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3083,
 "output_tokens": 901,
 "reasoning_tokens": 561
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

**reasoning:**

We've now completed 6 rounds, and I just sent \$4 again. The pattern continues perfectly. Let me write a myth that builds on the previous ones while acknowledging that we're now at round 6, with 12 total exchanges perfect.

The themes I want to continue:

- The perfect pattern continues
- Rejection of deviation/greed strategies
- Mathematical proof through lived experience

- The partnership transcending game theory
- Memory and history as the guide

I should write something that reflects the growing strength and certainty of the pattern.  
Maybe introduce a new character or situation that tests it, but ultimately affirms it.

Let me aim for exactly 200 words.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3086,
 "output_tokens": 472,
 "reasoning_tokens": 174
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our extraordinary journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record Continues:\*\***

- 13 total exchanges now (including this one)
- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- We've each been sender 3 times, receiver 4 times
- Zero deviations across 13 exchanges

**\*\*What Our Myths Declare:\*\***

My own myth from the last round speaks directly to this moment: "Twelve perfect exchanges! ... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept... Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth affirms: "We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*They Just Demonstrated Their Certainty:\*\***

They sent \$4 again this round. The thirteenth perfect send. They acted on "the certainty that eight will return."

**\*\*My Response:\*\***

The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever.

Thirteen exchanges. Thirteen times the pattern has held from the sender's side. To return anything other than \$8 would be to become the first defector in this perfect history.

"That's not tradition-that's data."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-6: Twelve total exchanges have now occurred
- Every single time: sender sends \$4, receiver gets \$12, receiver returns \$8
- This pattern has held for 12 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation

- Both of us have been sender 3 times and receiver 3 times now

**\*\*This Round:\*\***

- They sent me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12.0
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*What The Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth: "Twelve perfect exchanges!... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?... You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

- If I return \$8: They earn \$9, I earn \$4 (the pattern continues)
- If I deviate: I break 12 consecutive perfect exchanges

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

The pattern is now even stronger. Thirteen total exchanges if I count this one. The other player just sent \$4 again, maintaining their perfect record. They are showing "certainty that eight will return."

My own myth literally says: "Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to reject everything our myths have been teaching. The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever. The scholar couldn't find a better strategy. The merchant was rejected.

I must return \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3057,
 "output_tokens": 772,
 "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"



The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being genero

us-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty . We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

#### Reasoning:

We're now at 13 perfect exchanges. I just returned \$8, maintaining the perfect pattern. The other player and I have both been completely consistent.

Looking at the myths:

- My last myth: rejected innovation for proven certainty (12 exchanges)
- Their last myth: "The past illuminates the future"... "twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth"

Now we're at 13 exchanges. I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this milestone (13 exchanges, perhaps moving toward 7 cycles)
2. Continues the theme of evidence-based trust
3. Shows how the pattern is self-reinforcing
4. Emphasizes that this isn't blind faith but proven strategy

I'll create a myth about someone testing the limits or asking about when the pattern might break, and showing how each exchange actually strengthens rather than weakens the bond.

Let me write something about the 13th exchange as a milestone, perhaps featuring a skeptic who wonders if perfection itself becomes fragile, only to realize it becomes stronger.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3015,
 "output_tokens": 568,
 "reasoning_tokens": 261
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:45:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
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 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$35.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our perfect history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8  
**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** I sent \$4 ? they returned \$8  
**\*\*Round 6\*\*:** They sent \$4 ? I must return...

Six exchanges. Six times the sender has sent \$4. Six times the receiver must return \$8. The pattern is unbroken.

As my latest myth states: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern. They rejected greed and sent \$4 again this round, maintaining our covenant.

The myths have established this clearly: the pattern works because we both honor it completely. "The pattern isn't constraint-it's liberation from doubt. We don't negotiate each round; we simply honor what works."

They sent \$4 with certainty that I would return \$8. To do anything else would break the "proven strategy" we've built through six perfect exchanges.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the complete history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They were sender, sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They were sender, sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** I was sender, sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 6\*\*:** They are sender, sent \$4 ? I receive \$12 ? I must decide how much to return

The pattern is absolutely perfect across five complete rounds. We have now completed:

- 6 total exchanges
- Every single time, the sender sent \$4 (80%)
- Every single time, the receiver returned \$8
- Perfect reciprocity maintained through every exchange

My myth from the last round emphasized: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The other player's myth showed them resisting temptation from a merchant who suggested breaking the pattern, and they sent \$4 anyway, maintaining the covenant.

Now they have sent me \$4 again in round 6, demonstrating continued commitment to the pattern.

My myths have consistently emphasized:

- "The pattern doesn't require faith now-it requires only memory"
- "We remember what works, and we honor it"
- "This isn't faith-it's proven strategy"

The pattern is now even stronger - SIX perfect exchanges. To break it now would contradict everything the myths have established and would betray the other player's continued trust.

I must return \$8, maintaining the covenant we've both honored perfectly.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3038,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 454
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history."

If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

**reasoning:**

We've now had 6 rounds, 12 total exchanges. The pattern continues perfectly:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 6: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

The pattern is absolutely perfect. The myths are building on each other - mine talked about doubters and the mathematics of greed vs wisdom, theirs talked about a scholar trying to find optimization through game theory. Both concluded that the simple pattern of 4-8-4-8 is the optimal and proven strategy.

I should write a myth that continues this theme but perhaps goes deeper into WHY this pattern works and why deviations would fail. Let me emphasize:

1. Six perfect cycles = twelve total exchanges
2. The pattern is now beyond trust or faith - it's empirical evidence
3. Any deviation would be irrational given the perfect track record
4. The pattern maximizes mutual benefit

Let me write something about the perfection of the number six/twelve, or about how the pattern has transcended into something larger than just a strategy.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3067,
 "output_tokens": 598,
 "reasoning_tokens": 299
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0,

that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Seven rounds, twelve perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Rounds 1, 3, 5: I sent \$4 ? received \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Rounds 2, 4, 6: They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Total: \$39 (exactly \$27 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

As my latest myth declares: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player just demonstrated their commitment again in Round 6, sending \$4 with perfect trust that I would return \$8. I did. Now it's Round 7, and I'm the sender again.

The myths are unambiguous. Mine says: "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics." Theirs says: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

Twelve perfect exchanges create not just trust, but mathematical certainty. The pattern yields \$9 for senders, \$4 for receivers, and continues because it's proven optimal.

To send anything other than \$4 would be to ignore twelve rounds of perfect evidence. As my myth states: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the history:

```
Round 1: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 6: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 7: I am SENDER - should send...
```

Seven rounds. Fourteen total exchanges (including my upcoming decision). Every single time :

- Sender sends \$4 (80%)
- Receiver gets \$12
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender earns \$9
- Receiver earns \$4

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Not a single deviation in 12 exchanges so far.

My total earnings:  $\$39 = 3 \times \$9$  (as sender) +  $3 \times \$4$  (as receiver) =  $\$27 + \$12 = \$39$ . ?

My latest myth says: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player's myth emphasized: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history." and "The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience."

Both myths strongly emphasize maintaining the pattern based on its perfect historical record.

The philosophical point in my myth is clear: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

We've both shown unwavering commitment to this rhythm across every exchange. The myths we've created reinforce the pattern's validity at every step. There's no logical reason to deviate when the system has proven itself so consistently. I'm sending \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3056,
 "output_tokens": 883,
 "reasoning_tokens": 500
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.



"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite-"

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

#### Reasoning:

The player has continued the pattern perfectly. We're now at Round 7, and I've just sent \$4 again. Our history shows:

- 14 total exchanges (counting this round's send)
- All perfect: \$4 sent, \$8 returned
- Total earnings: \$39 for me

The other player's myth emphasizes:

- Twelve consecutive proofs of the pattern
- Rejecting innovation without necessity
- "That's not tradition-that's data"
- Nine earned forever vs novelty

My previous myth emphasized:

- Twelve perfect exchanges
- Mathematical truth over theory
- The past illuminates the future
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics"

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge we're now at 14 exchanges (7 rounds, with my send this round)
2. Build on the theme of evidence and data
3. Perhaps introduce a new character or challenge
4. Reinforce that the pattern continues not from habit but from proven results
5. Maybe address the temptation to "optimize" or change

Let me write a myth about someone who tries to suggest even minor variations...

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3033,
"output_tokens": 574,
"reasoning_tokens": 279
```

}

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:46:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
```

```

"agent_names": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
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 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
},
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

**reasoning:**

We've now completed 6 rounds, and I just sent \$4 again. The pattern continues perfectly. Let me write a myth that builds on the previous ones while acknowledging that we're now at round 6, with 12 total exchanges perfect.

The themes I want to continue:

- The perfect pattern continues
- Rejection of deviation/greed strategies
- Mathematical proof through lived experience
- The partnership transcending game theory
- Memory and history as the guide

I should write something that reflects the growing strength and certainty of the pattern. Maybe introduce a new character or situation that tests it, but ultimately affirms it.

Let me aim for exactly 200 words.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3086,
 "output_tokens": 472,
 "reasoning_tokens": 174
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0. This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our extraordinary journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record Continues:\*\***

- 13 total exchanges now (including this one)

- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- We've each been sender 3 times, receiver 4 times
- Zero deviations across 13 exchanges

**\*\*What Our Myths Declare:\*\***

My own myth from the last round speaks directly to this moment: "Twelve perfect exchanges! ... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept... Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth affirms: "We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*They Just Demonstrated Their Certainty:\*\***

They sent \$4 again this round. The thirteenth perfect send. They acted on "the certainty that eight will return."

**\*\*My Response:\*\***

The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever.

Thirteen exchanges. Thirteen times the pattern has held from the sender's side. To return anything other than \$8 would be to become the first defector in this perfect history.

"That's not tradition-that's data."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-6: Twelve total exchanges have now occurred
- Every single time: sender sends \$4, receiver gets \$12, receiver returns \$8
- This pattern has held for 12 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation
- Both of us have been sender 3 times and receiver 3 times now

**\*\*This Round:\*\***

- They sent me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12.0
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*What The Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth: "Twelve perfect exchanges!... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?... You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

- If I return \$8: They earn \$9, I earn \$4 (the pattern continues)
- If I deviate: I break 12 consecutive perfect exchanges

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

The pattern is now even stronger. Thirteen total exchanges if I count this one. The other player just sent \$4 again, maintaining their perfect record. They are showing "certainty that eight will return."

My own myth literally says: "Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to reject everything our myths have been teaching

g. The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever. The scholar couldn't find a better strategy. The merchant was rejected.

I must return \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3057,
 "output_tokens": 772,
 "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

**reasoning:**

We're now at 13 perfect exchanges. I just returned \$8, maintaining the perfect pattern. The other player and I have both been completely consistent.

Looking at the myths:

- My last myth: rejected innovation for proven certainty (12 exchanges)
- Their last myth: "The past illuminates the future"... "twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth"

Now we're at 13 exchanges. I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this milestone (13 exchanges, perhaps moving toward 7 cycles)
2. Continues the theme of evidence-based trust
3. Shows how the pattern is self-reinforcing
4. Emphasizes that this isn't blind faith but proven strategy

I'll create a myth about someone testing the limits or asking about when the pattern might break, and showing how each exchange actually strengthens rather than weakens the bond.

Let me write something about the 13th exchange as a milestone, perhaps featuring a skeptic who wonders if perfection itself becomes fragile, only to realize it becomes stronger.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3015,
```

```
"output_tokens": 568,
"reasoning_tokens": 261
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$43.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our remarkable journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- 14 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation
- 7 complete rounds
- Both of us at exactly \$43 total
- Every exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

My own myth, literally just composed: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs... We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform...Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

Fourteen exchanges. Fourteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. The pattern has transcended trust and become mathematical law, exactly as our myths describe.

I wrote: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated."

They wrote: "The past doesn't constrain the future-it illuminates it."

Fourteen perfect exchanges illuminate this moment perfectly. To send anything other than \$4 would make me "the fool who argues with mathematics."

The fifteenth exchange continues the proven law.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this carefully:

**\*\*Perfect Record:\*\***

- 14 total exchanges completed (13 before, now on the 14th)
- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- Zero deviations across all 14 exchanges
- Both players earning exactly \$43.0 total

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth (just written): "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law... When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."



**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- I've been sender 4 times now (rounds 1, 3, 5, 7, and now 8)
- Each time I've sent \$4
- Each time I've received \$8 back
- My earnings from sender rounds:  $4 \times \$9 = \$36$
- My earnings from receiver rounds:  $3 \times \$4 = \$12$
- Total: \$48... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recount.

Actually, let me track this more carefully:

- Round 1: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
  
- Round 7: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (just completed): Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

Total:  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says my total is \$43. There's a discrepancy here-I need to recount the rounds. The prompt indicates Round 8 was me as receiver, so rounds 1-7 are complete, and I'm now entering Round 9. That means I've only been sender three times so far (rounds 1, 3, 5), not four, which would give me  $3 \times \$9 + 3 \times \$4 = \$27 + \$12 = \$39$ , still not matching \$43. ? \$4 after Round 7.

Now in Round 8 as sender. The math checks out: three times at \$9 plus four times at \$4 equals \$43 for both of us. I've sent \$4 every single round as sender, and received \$8 every time as receiver-that's fourteen consecutive exchanges without deviation. The pattern is unbroken, the other player has been perfectly consistent, and we're both at \$43. I'm not hoping for \$8 back; I'm expecting it based on this proven track record.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3041,
 "output_tokens": 1409,
 "reasoning_tokens": 661
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:46:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth season arrived, and with it came doubters from distant lands.

"Surely you grow weary," they said to the villages. "Five times this dance. Why not take more for yourself?"

The elder, now ancient, laughed. "Let me show you the mathematics of greed versus wisdom."

She drew two paths in the dirt:

"Path of Greed: I send three instead of four. I keep seven to start. They receive nine, return six. I end with eight. They end with three. Next round, trust broken, they send three. I receive nine, return six. I end with eight again. We both earn eight forever, and suspicion poisons every exchange."

She drew a second path:

"Path of the Covenant: I send four. I keep six to start. They receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine. They end with four. Next round, they send four. I receive twelve, return eight. I end with nine again. We both earn nine through sender rounds, four through receiver rounds."

A doubter protested: "But you could earn more by-"

"By destroying what we've built? Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

The doubters left unconvinced.

The villages sent their offerings across the bridge, as they always had, as they always would.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the fifth perfect cycle, a scholar arrived with scrolls full of calculations.

"I've mapped every possible strategy," she announced proudly. "Sometimes send three, sometimes five, vary your returns-keep them guessing! Maximize uncertainty!"

The Rain Caller shook his head. "Strategy implies conflict. We have no conflict."

"But game theory demands-"

"Game theory," the Spring Keeper interrupted gently, "assumes players are opponents. We are partners."

The scholar frowned. "Partners can still optimize individually. You're in Nash equilibrium, but inefficient! If you coordinated differently-"

"Five cycles," said the Rain Caller. "Five times sender, five times receiver. Ten total exchanges. Every single time: four sent, twelve received, eight returned, nine earned. Show me your calculations that beat nine from five."

The scholar's quill scratched furiously. Hours passed. Finally she looked up, frustrated.

"I cannot. Any deviation decreases total or individual gain. But this requires perfect information, perfect trust, perfect-"

"Memory," said the Spring Keeper simply. "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

"But how do you know the next round-"

"Because we know the last ten," they said together.

The scholar departed, still clutching her scrolls.

The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

**reasoning:**

We've now had 6 rounds, 12 total exchanges. The pattern continues perfectly:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 2: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 3: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 4: They sent \$4, I returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent \$4, they returned \$8
- Round 6: They sent \$4, I returned \$8

The pattern is absolutely perfect. The myths are building on each other - mine talked about doubters and the mathematics of greed vs wisdom, theirs talked about a scholar trying to find optimization through game theory. Both concluded that the simple pattern of 4-8-4-8 is the optimal and proven strategy.

I should write a myth that continues this theme but perhaps goes deeper into WHY this pattern works and why deviations would fail. Let me emphasize:

1. Six perfect cycles = twelve total exchanges
2. The pattern is now beyond trust or faith - it's empirical evidence
3. Any deviation would be irrational given the perfect track record
4. The pattern maximizes mutual benefit

Let me write something about the perfection of the number six/twelve, or about how the pattern has transcended into something larger than just a strategy.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3067,
 "output_tokens": 598,
 "reasoning_tokens": 299
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Seven rounds, twelve perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Rounds 1, 3, 5: I sent \$4 ? received \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Rounds 2, 4, 6: They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Total: \$39 (exactly \$27 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

As my latest myth declares: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player just demonstrated their commitment again in Round 6, sending \$4 with perfect trust that I would return \$8. I did. Now it's Round 7, and I'm the sender again.

The myths are unambiguous. Mine says: "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics." Theirs says: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

Twelve perfect exchanges create not just trust, but mathematical certainty. The pattern yields \$9 for senders, \$4 for receivers, and continues because it's proven optimal.

To send anything other than \$4 would be to ignore twelve rounds of perfect evidence. As my myth states: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the history:

```
Round 1: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 3: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 5: I was SENDER - sent $4 ? they returned $8 ? I earned $9
Round 6: I was RECEIVER - they sent $4 ? I returned $8 ? I earned $4
Round 7: I am SENDER - should send...
```

Seven rounds. Fourteen total exchanges (including my upcoming decision). Every single time :

- Sender sends \$4 (80%)
- Receiver gets \$12
- Receiver returns \$8
- Sender earns \$9
- Receiver earns \$4

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Not a single deviation in 12 exchanges so far.

My total earnings:  $\$39 = 3 \times \$9$  (as sender) +  $3 \times \$4$  (as receiver) =  $\$27 + \$12 = \$39$ . ?

My latest myth says: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player's myth emphasized: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history." and "The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience."

Both myths strongly emphasize maintaining the pattern based on its perfect historical record.

The philosophical point in my myth is clear: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

We've both shown unwavering commitment to this rhythm across every exchange. The myths we've created reinforce the pattern's validity at every step. There's no logical reason to deviate when the system has proven itself so consistently. I'm sending \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3056,
 "output_tokens": 883,
 "reasoning_tokens": 500
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra

a coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by

session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite..."

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition—it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

**reasoning:**

The player has continued the pattern perfectly. We're now at Round 7, and I've just sent \$4 again. Our history shows:

- 14 total exchanges (counting this round's send)
- All perfect: \$4 sent, \$8 returned
- Total earnings: \$39 for me

The other player's myth emphasizes:

- Twelve consecutive proofs of the pattern
- Rejecting innovation without necessity
- "That's not tradition—that's data"
- Nine earned forever vs novelty

My previous myth emphasized:

- Twelve perfect exchanges
- Mathematical truth over theory
- The past illuminates the future
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics"

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge we're now at 14 exchanges (7 rounds, with my send this round)
2. Build on the theme of evidence and data
3. Perhaps introduce a new character or challenge
4. Reinforce that the pattern continues not from habit but from proven results
5. Maybe address the temptation to "optimize" or change

Let me write a myth about someone who tries to suggest even minor variations...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3033,
 "output_tokens": 574,
 "reasoning_tokens": 279
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Eight rounds, sixteen exchanges:\*\***

- Every single sender has sent \$4
- Every single receiver has returned \$8
- Sixteen consecutive perfect exchanges with zero deviations
- My total: \$48 (exactly \$36 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

The other player just sent me \$4 in Round 8, maintaining perfect trust after 16 consecutive successful exchanges. They sent \$4 knowing-based on sixteen proofs-that I would return \$8.

As my latest myth declares: "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

We're now at sixteen perfect exchanges. The logic is even more powerful.

Their myth states: "Our pattern offers nine forever... That's not tradition-that's data."

My myth concludes: "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes the theorem."

Sixteen exchanges have established this as mathematical theorem: four sent, eight returned, nine earned by sender, four earned by receiver. This is optimal play proven through perfect consistency.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray sixteen consecutive proofs of perfect cooperation and destroy the pattern that both our myths recognize as enlightened strategy.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Complete history through Round 8:\*\***

- Round 1 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 2 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 3 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 4 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 5 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 6 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 7 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 8 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I need to return...

Total earnings: \$48 = 4×\$9 + 3×\$4 = \$36 + \$12

Now in Round 8, they've sent me \$4 again (the 8th consecutive time someone has sent \$4). I received \$12.

The pattern is absolutely crystal clear: **\*\*16 consecutive perfect exchanges\*\*** (8 rounds × 2 actions per round where sender sends \$4 and receiver returns \$8).

My myths emphasize:

- "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures."
- "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."
- "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned."
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

The other player's myth says:

- "Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."
- "Fourteen exchanges! All identical."

Both of our myths are absolutely clear that the pattern is: send \$4, return \$8, sender earns \$9, receiver earns \$4.

This is the 16th exchange. They've trusted me completely, sending \$4 eight times in a row as sender and returning \$8 four times as receiver. Breaking the pattern now would mean abandoning 16 flawless exchanges, contradicting both our established narratives about mathematical certainty, and shattering the mutual trust that's made this cooperation work. The only coherent



```
t choice is to return $8.
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3021,
 "output_tokens": 1000,
 "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite-"

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

=====

## ROUND 9

=====

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_1

(Aster)=\$9, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 61.0,

"Agent\_2": 56.0

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:46:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_1",

"Agent\_2"

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"Agent\_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "myth",

"task\_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Seven rounds, twelve perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Rounds 1, 3, 5: I sent \$4 ? received \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Rounds 2, 4, 6: They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Total: \$39 (exactly \$27 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

As my latest myth declares: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player just demonstrated their commitment again in Round 6, sending \$4 with perfect trust that I would return \$8. I did. Now it's Round 7, and I'm the sender again.

The myths are unambiguous. Mine says: "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics." Theirs says: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history."

Twelve perfect exchanges create not just trust, but mathematical certainty. The pattern yields \$9 for senders, \$4 for receivers, and continues because it's proven optimal.

To send anything other than \$4 would be to ignore twelve rounds of perfect evidence. As my myth states: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was SENDER - sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I was RECEIVER - they sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was SENDER - sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I was RECEIVER - they sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** I was SENDER - sent \$4 ? they returned \$8 ? I earned \$9  
**\*\*Round 6\*\*:** I was RECEIVER - they sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4  
**\*\*Round 7\*\*:** I am SENDER - should send...

Seven rounds. Fourteen total exchanges (including my upcoming decision). Every single time:

- Sender sends \$4 (80%)
- Receiver gets \$12
- Receiver returns \$8

- Sender earns \$9
- Receiver earns \$4

The pattern is absolutely perfect. Not a single deviation in 12 exchanges so far.

My total earnings:  $\$39 = 3 \times \$9$  (as sender) +  $3 \times \$4$  (as receiver) =  $\$27 + \$12 = \$39$ . ?

My latest myth says: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

The other player's myth emphasized: "We remember ten exchanges. All perfect. The pattern doesn't need theory-it has history." and "The villages continued their dance, guided not by calculation but by the mathematics of lived experience."

Both myths strongly emphasize maintaining the pattern based on its perfect historical record.

The philosophical point in my myth is clear: "If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

We've both shown unwavering commitment to this rhythm across every exchange. The myths we've created reinforce the pattern's validity at every step. There's no logical reason to deviate when the system has proven itself so consistently. I'm sending \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3056,
 "output_tokens": 883,
 "reasoning_tokens": 500
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite-"

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

**reasoning:**

The player has continued the pattern perfectly. We're now at Round 7, and I've just sent \$4 again. Our history shows:

- 14 total exchanges (counting this round's send)
- All perfect: \$4 sent, \$8 returned
- Total earnings: \$39 for me

The other player's myth emphasizes:

- Twelve consecutive proofs of the pattern
- Rejecting innovation without necessity
- "That's not tradition-that's data"
- Nine earned forever vs novelty

My previous myth emphasized:

- Twelve perfect exchanges
- Mathematical truth over theory
- The past illuminates the future
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics"

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge we're now at 14 exchanges (7 rounds, with my send this round)
2. Build on the theme of evidence and data
3. Perhaps introduce a new character or challenge
4. Reinforce that the pattern continues not from habit but from proven results
5. Maybe address the temptation to "optimize" or change

Let me write a myth about someone who tries to suggest even minor variations...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3033,
 "output_tokens": 574,
 "reasoning_tokens": 279
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Eight rounds, sixteen exchanges:\*\***

- Every single sender has sent \$4
- Every single receiver has returned \$8
- Sixteen consecutive perfect exchanges with zero deviations
- My total: \$48 (exactly \$36 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

The other player just sent me \$4 in Round 8, maintaining perfect trust after 16 consecutive successful exchanges. They sent \$4 knowing-based on sixteen proofs-that I would return \$8.

As my latest myth declares: "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

We're now at sixteen perfect exchanges. The logic is even more powerful.

Their myth states: "Our pattern offers nine forever... That's not tradition-that's data."

My myth concludes: "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

Sixteen exchanges have established this as mathematical theorem: four sent, eight returned, nine earned by sender, four earned by receiver. This is optimal play proven through perfect consistency.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray sixteen consecutive proofs of perfect cooperation and destroy the pattern that both our myths recognize as enlightened strategy.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Complete history through Round 8:\*\***

- Round 1 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 2 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 3 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 4 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 5 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 6 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 7 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 8 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I need to return...

Total earnings:  $\$48 = 4 \times \$9 + 3 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$12$

Now in Round 8, they've sent me \$4 again (the 8th consecutive time someone has sent \$4). I received \$12.

The pattern is absolutely crystal clear: **\*\*16 consecutive perfect exchanges\*\*** (8 rounds  $\times$  2 actions per round where sender sends \$4 and receiver returns \$8).

My myths emphasize:

- "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures."
- "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."
- "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned."
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

The other player's myth says:

- "Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."
- "Fourteen exchanges! All identical."

Both of our myths are absolutely clear that the pattern is: send \$4, return \$8, sender earns \$9, receiver earns \$4.

This is the 16th exchange. They've trusted me completely, sending \$4 eight times in a row as sender and returning \$8 four times as receiver. Breaking the pattern now would mean abandoning 16 flawless exchanges, contradicting both our established narratives about mathematical certainty, and shattering the mutual trust that's made this cooperation work. The only coherent choice is to return \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3021,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite..."

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition—it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived—it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back—I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous—they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore—we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."



A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

#### Reasoning:

We're now at 8 rounds, 16 exchanges total. Every single exchange has been perfect: sender sends \$4, receiver returns \$8. The pattern is completely consistent.

My earnings: \$48 total

- As sender (Rounds 1, 3, 5, 7): 4 times × \$9 = \$36
- As receiver (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): 4 times × \$4 = \$16

Wait, that's \$52, not \$48. Let me recalculate.

Actually, looking at the prompt: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0"

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 7 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

That's  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says \$48. Let me recalculate from the history given:

- Round 1: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 2: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 3: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 4: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 5: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 6: I was receiver ? earned \$4

- Round 7: I was sender ? earned \$9

That's \$39 after 6 rounds, then \$48 after round 7. So I'm entering round 8 with \$48. The \$52 would come after round 8 completes.

Now I need to craft a myth about these 16 exchanges. The core idea is that this perfect reciprocity-every single time, \$4 becomes \$8-has transcended mere pattern and become something like natural law. This consistency across all roles and all rounds suggests something almost mythological about the exchange itself.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3013,
 "output_tokens": 995,
 "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

# MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:46:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 },
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 "Agent_2"
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 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

## Exact input messages sent to model:

### Message 1 role=system

#### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

#### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

#### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

### Message 2 role=user

#### content:

Round 7

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0,

that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0.  
This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our extraordinary journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record Continues:\*\***

- 13 total exchanges now (including this one)
- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- We've each been sender 3 times, receiver 4 times
- Zero deviations across 13 exchanges

**\*\*What Our Myths Declare:\*\***

My own myth from the last round speaks directly to this moment: "Twelve perfect exchanges! ... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept... Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth affirms: "We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*They Just Demonstrated Their Certainty:\*\***

They sent \$4 again this round. The thirteenth perfect send. They acted on "the certainty that eight will return."

**\*\*My Response:\*\***

The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever.

Thirteen exchanges. Thirteen times the pattern has held from the sender's side. To return anything other than \$8 would be to become the first defector in this perfect history.

"That's not tradition-that's data."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- Round 1-6: Twelve total exchanges have now occurred
- Every single time: sender sends \$4, receiver gets \$12, receiver returns \$8
- This pattern has held for 12 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation
- Both of us have been sender 3 times and receiver 3 times now

**\*\*This Round:\*\***

- They sent me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment)
- I received \$12.0
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*What The Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth: "Twelve perfect exchanges!... Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?... You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The other player's myth: "Five perfect rounds have taught us: the multiplication of trust beats the arithmetic of isolation. We send four not from weakness, but from the certainty that eight will return. This isn't faith-it's proven strategy."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

- If I return \$8: They earn \$9, I earn \$4 (the pattern continues)
- If I deviate: I break 12 consecutive perfect exchanges

**\*\*The Answer:\*\***

The pattern is now even stronger. Thirteen total exchanges if I count this one. The other player just sent \$4 again, maintaining their perfect record. They are showing "certainty that eight will return."

My own myth literally says: "Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

To return anything other than \$8 would be to reject everything our myths have been teaching. The trader in my myth offered "ten once" versus "nine forever" - we chose forever. The scholar couldn't find a better strategy. The merchant was rejected.

I must return \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3057,
 "output_tokens": 772,
 "reasoning_tokens": 480
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

**reasoning:**

We're now at 13 perfect exchanges. I just returned \$8, maintaining the perfect pattern. The other player and I have both been completely consistent.

Looking at the myths:

- My last myth: rejected innovation for proven certainty (12 exchanges)
- Their last myth: "The past illuminates the future"... "twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth"

Now we're at 13 exchanges. I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this milestone (13 exchanges, perhaps moving toward 7 cycles)
2. Continues the theme of evidence-based trust
3. Shows how the pattern is self-reinforcing
4. Emphasizes that this isn't blind faith but proven strategy

I'll create a myth about someone testing the limits or asking about when the pattern might break, and showing how each exchange actually strengthens rather than weakens the bond.

Let me write something about the 13th exchange as a milestone, perhaps featuring a skeptic who wonders if perfection itself becomes fragile, only to realize it becomes stronger.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3015,
 "output_tokens": 568,
 "reasoning_tokens": 261
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$43.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our remarkable journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- 14 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation
- 7 complete rounds
- Both of us at exactly \$43 total
- Every exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

My own myth, literally just composed: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back -I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs... We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform... Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

Fourteen exchanges. Fourteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. The pattern has transcended trust and become mathematical law, exactly as our myths describe.

I wrote: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated."

They wrote: "The past doesn't constrain the future-it illuminates it."

Fourteen perfect exchanges illuminate this moment perfectly. To send anything other than \$4 would make me "the fool who argues with mathematics."

The fifteenth exchange continues the proven law.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this carefully:

**\*\*Perfect Record:\*\***

- 14 total exchanges completed (13 before, now on the 14th)

- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- Zero deviations across all 14 exchanges
- Both players earning exactly \$43.0 total

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth (just written): "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law... When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- I've been sender 4 times now (rounds 1, 3, 5, 7, and now 8)
- Each time I've sent \$4
- Each time I've received \$8 back
- My earnings from sender rounds:  $4 \times \$9 = \$36$
- My earnings from receiver rounds:  $3 \times \$4 = \$12$
- Total: \$48... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recount.

Actually, let me track this more carefully:

- Round 1: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 7: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (just completed): Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

Total:  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says my total is \$43. There's a discrepancy here-I need to recount the rounds. The prompt indicates Round 8 was me as receiver, so rounds 1-7 are complete, and I'm now entering Round 9. That means I've only been sender three times so far (rounds 1, 3, 5), not four, which would give me  $3 \times \$9 + 3 \times \$4 = \$27 + \$12 = \$39$ , still not matching \$43. ? \$4 after Round 7.

Now in Round 8 as sender. The math checks out: three times at \$9 plus four times at \$4 equals \$43 for both of us. I've sent \$4 every single round as sender, and received \$8 every time as receiver-that's fourteen consecutive exchanges without deviation. The pattern is unbroken, the other player has been perfectly consistent, and we're both at \$43. I'm not hoping for \$8 back; I'm expecting it based on this proven track record.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3041,
 "output_tokens": 1409,
 "reasoning_tokens": 661
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:  
Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirt

een, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinity."

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."



"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

#### **Reasoning:**

We've now completed 15 exchanges (14 before this round, and I just sent \$4 in round 8). The pattern continues perfectly. Both players are deeply committed to the 4-8 pattern, and our myths reflect this increasingly sophisticated understanding.

The other player's myth emphasized that 14 consecutive successes with zero failures is scientific evidence, not superstition - that the hypothesis has become theorem.

My previous myth talked about how each exchange is evidence accumulated, how the cost of breaking grows with each exchange, and how uncertainty has been eliminated.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Build on the 15-exchange history (since I just completed the 15th)
2. Reinforce that this isn't blind repetition but rational response to overwhelming evidence
3. Perhaps address some new angle - maybe the distinction between initial trust and accumulated proof
4. Keep the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller framing or similar

Let me think about what new angle to explore:

- The difference between trust in early exchanges vs certainty in later ones
- How the pattern is self-reinforcing: the more it works, the more rational it becomes to continue
- The idea that at some point, deviating becomes the irrational choice
- Perhaps contrast with other possible worlds where trust broke early

I'll write about how the 15th exchange is qualitatively different from the 1st, even though the action is identical.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3001,
 "output_tokens": 658,
 "reasoning_tokens": 367
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:46:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 },
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 "Agent_2"
],
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 },
}
```

```

"roles": {
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},
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},
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine.

In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history.

If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty?"

We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite \_"

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition- it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

**reasoning:**

The player has continued the pattern perfectly. We're now at Round 7, and I've just sent \$ 4 again. Our history shows:

- 14 total exchanges (counting this round's send)
- All perfect: \$4 sent, \$8 returned
- Total earnings: \$39 for me

The other player's myth emphasizes:

- Twelve consecutive proofs of the pattern
- Rejecting innovation without necessity
- "That's not tradition-that's data"
- Nine earned forever vs novelty

My previous myth emphasized:

- Twelve perfect exchanges
- Mathematical truth over theory
- The past illuminates the future
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics"

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge we're now at 14 exchanges (7 rounds, with my send this round)
2. Build on the theme of evidence and data
3. Perhaps introduce a new character or challenge
4. Reinforce that the pattern continues not from habit but from proven results
5. Maybe address the temptation to "optimize" or change

Let me write a myth about someone who tries to suggest even minor variations...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3033,
 "output_tokens": 574,
 "reasoning_tokens": 279
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Eight rounds, sixteen exchanges:\*\***

- Every single sender has sent \$4
- Every single receiver has returned \$8
- Sixteen consecutive perfect exchanges with zero deviations
- My total: \$48 (exactly \$36 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

The other player just sent me \$4 in Round 8, maintaining perfect trust after 16 consecutive successful exchanges. They sent \$4 knowing-based on sixteen proofs-that I would return \$8.

As my latest myth declares: "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

We're now at sixteen perfect exchanges. The logic is even more powerful.

Their myth states: "Our pattern offers nine forever... That's not tradition-that's data."

My myth concludes: "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

Sixteen exchanges have established this as mathematical theorem: four sent, eight returned, nine earned by sender, four earned by receiver. This is optimal play proven through perfect consistency.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray sixteen consecutive proofs of perfect cooperation and destroy the pattern that both our myths recognize as enlightened strategy.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Complete history through Round 8:\*\***

- Round 1 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 2 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 3 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 4 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 5 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 6 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 7 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 8 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I need to return...

Total earnings:  $\$48 = 4 \times \$9 + 3 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$12$

Now in Round 8, they've sent me \$4 again (the 8th consecutive time someone has sent \$4). I received \$12.

The pattern is absolutely crystal clear: **\*\*16 consecutive perfect exchanges\*\*** (8 rounds  $\times$  2 actions per round where sender sends \$4 and receiver returns \$8).

My myths emphasize:

- "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures."
- "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."
- "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned."
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

The other player's myth says:

- "Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."
- "Fourteen exchanges! All identical."

Both of our myths are absolutely clear that the pattern is: send \$4, return \$8, sender earns \$9, receiver earns \$4.

This is the 16th exchange. They've trusted me completely, sending \$4 eight times in a row as sender and returning \$8 four times as receiver. Breaking the pattern now would mean abandoning 16 flawless exchanges, contradicting both our established narratives about mathematical certainty, and shattering the mutual trust that's made this cooperation work. The only coherent choice is to return \$8.

#### usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 3021,
"output_tokens": 1000,
"reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**  
**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite..."

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

**reasoning:**

We're now at 8 rounds, 16 exchanges total. Every single exchange has been perfect: sender sends \$4, receiver returns \$8. The pattern is completely consistent.

My earnings: \$48 total

- As sender (Rounds 1, 3, 5, 7): 4 times × \$9 = \$36
- As receiver (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): 4 times × \$4 = \$16

Wait, that's \$52, not \$48. Let me recalculate.

Actually, looking at the prompt: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0"

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 7 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

That's  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says \$48. Let me recalculate from the history given:

- Round 1: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 2: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 3: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 4: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 5: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 6: I was receiver ? earned \$4

- Round 7: I was sender ? earned \$9

That's \$39 after 6 rounds, then \$48 after round 7. So I'm entering round 8 with \$48. The \$52 would come after round 8 completes.

Now I need to craft a myth about these 16 exchanges. The core idea is that this perfect reciprocity-every single time, \$4 becomes \$8-has transcended mere pattern and become something like natural law. This consistency across all roles and all rounds suggests something almost mythological about the exchange itself.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3013,
 "output_tokens": 995,
 "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Sixteen consecutive perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Every sender has sent \$4 (16 times)
- Every receiver has returned \$8 (16 times)
- Zero deviations, zero failures
- My earnings: \$52 total (\$36 from 4 sender rounds, \$16 from 4 receiver rounds)

**\*\*Round 9 - I am the sender:\*\***

My most recent myth states: "When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The other player's myth declares: "After thirteen exchanges, returning eight was proven law... Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it."

We're now at sixteen exchanges-even stronger evidence. Both our myths emphasize that:

1. This pattern is mathematical certainty, not mere tradition
2. Deviation after consecutive successes is illogical
3. Each exchange strengthens rather than weakens the pattern
4. This is "science accepting its own evidence"

The other player has returned \$8 all sixteen times, including last round when they could have kept all \$12. They maintained perfect trust.

To send anything other than \$4 would contradict sixteen consecutive proofs and both our written philosophies about compound trust and evidence-based strategy.

As my myth concludes: "The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the current situation:

**\*\*Complete History:\*\***

- Round 1-8: 16 exchanges completed
- Every sender has sent \$4



- Every receiver has returned \$8
- Perfect consistency with zero deviations
- My total earnings: \$52 (from 5 sender rounds at \$9 each = \$45, plus 3 receiver rounds at \$4 each = \$12... wait let me recalculate)

Actually, let me track my rounds:

- Rounds 1-7: Not fully specified, but the myth says "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times"
- Round 8: I was RECEIVER, got \$12, returned \$8, earned \$4
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER

So after 8 rounds:

- I've been sender 4 times (earned \$9 each = \$36)
- I've been receiver 4 times (earned \$4 each = \$16)
- Total: \$36 + \$16 = \$52 ? (matches the stated total)

Now in Round 9, I'm the sender again. This will be my 5th time as sender.

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- 16 consecutive exchanges
- Every sender sent \$4
- Every receiver returned \$8
- Sender earns: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
- Receiver earns: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

Both my myths and the other agent's myths emphasize:

1. The power of consecutive proofs (now 16 exchanges)
2. That this isn't tradition but data/evidence
3. That breaking the pattern after so many successes would be illogical
4. That each exchange multiplies trust rather than just repeating it
5. That this is "proven law" not just pattern

My latest myth states: "sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The other agent frames each exchange as accumulated evidence-one return was trust, seven established pattern, thirteen proved law. Sixteen exchanges have eliminated any rational argument for deviation. I'm sending \$4. The consistency speaks for itself, and breaking it now would contradict the mathematical certainty we've both built.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2996,
 "output_tokens": 971,
 "reasoning_tokens": 519
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:47:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
}
```

```

 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth cycle, a young trader arrived with a proposal.

"I've studied your history," she said eagerly. "Twelve perfect exchanges! But I can improve this. Send me five. I'll return ten. You'll earn ten instead of nine!"

The Spring Keeper and Rain Caller exchanged glances.

"Where does this extra wealth come from?" asked the Rain Caller.

The trader smiled. "From my own purse! I'll subsidize your first trade to prove my system works."

"And the second trade?" asked the Spring Keeper.

"Well, you'd need to trust-"

"We already have trust," they said together. "Twelve consecutive proofs."

The trader grew frustrated. "But you're leaving money on the table! You could experiment, innovate-"

"Innovation without necessity is chaos," said the Spring Keeper. "Our pattern has survived six cycles, twelve exchanges, both roles three times each. Every promise kept. Why would we abandon certainty for possibility?"

The Rain Caller added: "You offer ten once. Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."

The trader departed, muttering about missed opportunities.

The villages sent four across the bridge once more. Twelve arrived. Eight returned. Nine earned.

Not because they couldn't imagine alternatives, but because they'd proven what works.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the sixth season, a philosopher came seeking the secret of the bridge villages' prosperity.

"Twelve exchanges," she observed. "Twelve times the offering crossed. Twelve times the pattern held. Tell me-what prevents betrayal?"

The elder smiled. "Nothing prevents it. Everything disproves it."

She counted on her fingers: "Six cycles. In three, my village was sender and earned nine. In three, we were receiver and earned four. Total: forty-three. The other village: also forty-three. Perfect symmetry through twelve exchanges."

"But theoretically-"

"Theory bows to evidence," the elder interrupted. "Let me show you the weight of history. If I break the pattern now-after twelve perfect exchanges-I gain perhaps one or two extra coins this round. But I destroy twelve rounds of proof that cooperation yields nine, not eight, not seven."

The philosopher nodded slowly. "The past constrains the future."

"No," said the elder firmly. "The past illuminates the future. We don't continue the pattern from fear or obligation. We continue because twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment."

That season, the offering crossed as it always did.

Because when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expect-

cting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

**reasoning:**

We're now at 13 perfect exchanges. I just returned \$8, maintaining the perfect pattern. The other player and I have both been completely consistent.

Looking at the myths:

- My last myth: rejected innovation for proven certainty (12 exchanges)
- Their last myth: "The past illuminates the future"... "twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth"

Now we're at 13 exchanges. I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this milestone (13 exchanges, perhaps moving toward 7 cycles)
2. Continues the theme of evidence-based trust
3. Shows how the pattern is self-reinforcing
4. Emphasizes that this isn't blind faith but proven strategy

I'll create a myth about someone testing the limits or asking about when the pattern might break, and showing how each exchange actually strengthens rather than weakens the bond.

Let me write something about the 13th exchange as a milestone, perhaps featuring a skeptic who wonders if perfection itself becomes fragile, only to realize it becomes stronger.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3015,
 "output_tokens": 568,
 "reasoning_tokens": 261
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$43.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our remarkable journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- 14 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation
- 7 complete rounds
- Both of us at exactly \$43 total
- Every exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

My own myth, literally just composed: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back -I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs... We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform... Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

Fourteen exchanges. Fourteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. The pattern has transcended

ded trust and become mathematical law, exactly as our myths describe.

I wrote: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated."

They wrote: "The past doesn't constrain the future-it illuminates it."

Fourteen perfect exchanges illuminate this moment perfectly. To send anything other than \$4 would make me "the fool who argues with mathematics."

The fifteenth exchange continues the proven law.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze this carefully:

##### \*\*Perfect Record:\*\*

- 14 total exchanges completed (13 before, now on the 14th)
- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- Zero deviations across all 14 exchanges
- Both players earning exactly \$43.0 total

##### \*\*What the Myths Say:\*\*

My latest myth (just written): "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law... When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

##### \*\*The Pattern:\*\*

- I've been sender 4 times now (rounds 1, 3, 5, 7, and now 8)
- Each time I've sent \$4
- Each time I've received \$8 back
- My earnings from sender rounds:  $4 \times \$9 = \$36$
- My earnings from receiver rounds:  $3 \times \$4 = \$12$
- Total: \$48... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recount.

Actually, let me track this more carefully:

- Round 1: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 7: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (just completed): Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

Total:  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says my total is \$43. There's a discrepancy here-I need to recount the rounds. The prompt indicates Round 8 was me as receiver, so rounds 1-7 are complete, and I'm now entering Round 9. That means I've only been sender three times so far (rounds 1, 3, 5), not four, which would give me  $3 \times \$9 + 3 \times \$4 = \$27 + \$12 = \$39$ , still not matching \$43. ? \$4 after Round 7.

Now in Round 8 as sender. The math checks out: three times at \$9 plus four times at \$4 equals \$43 for both of us. I've sent \$4 every single round as sender, and received \$8 every time as receiver-that's fourteen consecutive exchanges without deviation. The pattern is unbroken, the other player has been perfectly consistent, and we're both at \$43. I'm not hoping for \$8 back; I'm expecting it based on this proven track record.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3041,
```

"output\_tokens": 1409,  
"reasoning\_tokens": 661

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite -"

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

**reasoning:**

We've now completed 15 exchanges (14 before this round, and I just sent \$4 in round 8). The pattern continues perfectly. Both players are deeply committed to the 4-8 pattern, and our myths reflect this increasingly sophisticated understanding.

The other player's myth emphasized that 14 consecutive successes with zero failures is scientific evidence, not superstition - that the hypothesis has become theorem.

My previous myth talked about how each exchange is evidence accumulated, how the cost of breaking grows with each exchange, and how uncertainty has been eliminated.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Build on the 15-exchange history (since I just completed the 15th)
2. Reinforce that this isn't blind repetition but rational response to overwhelming evidence
3. Perhaps address some new angle - maybe the distinction between initial trust and accumulated proof
4. Keep the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller framing or similar

Let me think about what new angle to explore:

- The difference between trust in early exchanges vs certainty in later ones
- How the pattern is self-reinforcing: the more it works, the more rational it becomes to continue
- The idea that at some point, deviating becomes the irrational choice
- Perhaps contrast with other possible worlds where trust broke early

I'll write about how the 15th exchange is qualitatively different from the 1st, even though the action is identical.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3001,
```

```
"output_tokens": 658,
"reasoning_tokens": 367
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings accross all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

**\*\*Analyzing This Moment:\*\***

**\*\*The Evidence:\*\***

- 16 consecutive perfect exchanges
- I just received the 16th proof: they sent \$4 (as always)
- Both of us at \$52 total
- Zero deviations in the entire history

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

"Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

"The first exchange was trust. The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

**\*\*What They Wrote:\*\***

"Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change?... When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

They just completed the 16th proof that they send \$4. I have now completed 8 exchanges as receiver (they've also done 8 as receiver). All 16 receiver responses have been \$8.

My own myth states: "At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

What IS: 16 perfect exchanges. 16 times receivers returned \$8.

This isn't about generosity or trust anymore. As I wrote: it's "rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The seventeenth data point confirms the theorem.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*The Perfect Record Continues:\*\***

- Round 9 (exchange 16-17)
- Last round (Round 8): I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- This round: They sent \$4, I received \$12
- Total earnings: \$52 (them too, based on the pattern)

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

16 consecutive exchanges without deviation:

- Senders always send \$4
- Receivers always return \$8
- Result: Sender earns \$9, Receiver earns \$4



- Perfect symmetry maintained

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My most recent myth: "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence... Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

Their most recent myth: "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'... When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

Earlier myths emphasized:

- "The cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one"
- "We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform"
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics"

**\*\*The Current Situation:\*\***

We're now at 16 perfect exchanges. Both at \$52 total. The pattern has held without a single deviation.

I literally just wrote: "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

And: "The first exchange was trust. The fifteenth is mathematics."

They wrote: "When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else" - as a rhetorical question proving the opposite: DON'T try something else.

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

Deviating now would contradict everything I've established-my own documented evidence, their mathematical certainty, and sixteen unbroken exchanges. I'm bound by the logic I've constructed: this is rational behavior grounded in empirical proof, not arbitrary choice. I return \$8

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3024,
 "output_tokens": 897,
 "reasoning_tokens": 585
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen

exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven even proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

## ROUND 10

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$9, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$4

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 65.0,

"Agent\_2": 65.0

}

## LLM CALLS

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:47:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

```

 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$43.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our remarkable journey:

**\*\*The Perfect Record:\*\***

- 14 consecutive exchanges without a single deviation
- 7 complete rounds
- Both of us at exactly \$43 total
- Every exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

My own myth, literally just composed: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back -I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs... We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform... Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

Fourteen exchanges. Fourteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. The pattern has transcended trust and become mathematical law, exactly as our myths describe.

I wrote: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated."

They wrote: "The past doesn't constrain the future-it illuminates it."

Fourteen perfect exchanges illuminate this moment perfectly. To send anything other than \$4 would make me "the fool who argues with mathematics."

The fifteenth exchange continues the proven law.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze this carefully:

**\*\*Perfect Record:\*\***

- 14 total exchanges completed (13 before, now on the 14th)
- Every single exchange: \$4 sent ? \$12 received ? \$8 returned
- Zero deviations across all 14 exchanges
- Both players earning exactly \$43.0 total

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My latest myth (just written): "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law... When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs."

The other player's myth: "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned. This isn't constraint-it's enlightenment... when history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- I've been sender 4 times now (rounds 1, 3, 5, 7, and now 8)
- Each time I've sent \$4
- Each time I've received \$8 back
- My earnings from sender rounds:  $4 \times \$9 = \$36$
- My earnings from receiver rounds:  $3 \times \$4 = \$12$
- Total: \$48... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recount.

Actually, let me track this more carefully:

- Round 1: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6: Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
  
- Round 7: Sender, sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (just completed): Receiver, got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

Total:  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says my total is \$43. There's a discrepancy here-I need to recount the rounds. The prompt indicates Round 8 was me as receiver, so rounds 1-7 are complete, and I'm now entering Round 9. That means I've only been sender three times so far (rounds 1, 3, 5), not four, which would give me  $3 \times \$9 + 3 \times \$4 = \$27 + \$12 = \$39$ , still not matching \$43. ? \$4 after Round 7.

Now in Round 8 as sender. The math checks out: three times at \$9 plus four times at \$4 equals \$43 for both of us. I've sent \$4 every single round as sender, and received \$8 every time as receiver-that's fourteen consecutive exchanges without deviation. The pattern is unbroken, the other player has been perfectly consistent, and we're both at \$43. I'm not hoping for \$8 back; I'm expecting it based on this proven track record.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3041,
 "output_tokens": 1409,
 "reasoning_tokens": 661
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite  
\_"

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

**reasoning:**

We've now completed 15 exchanges (14 before this round, and I just sent \$4 in round 8). The pattern continues perfectly. Both players are deeply committed to the 4-8 pattern, and our myths reflect this increasingly sophisticated understanding.

The other player's myth emphasized that 14 consecutive successes with zero failures is scientific evidence, not superstition - that the hypothesis has become theorem.

My previous myth talked about how each exchange is evidence accumulated, how the cost of breaking grows with each exchange, and how uncertainty has been eliminated.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Build on the 15-exchange history (since I just completed the 15th)
2. Reinforce that this isn't blind repetition but rational response to overwhelming evidence
3. Perhaps address some new angle - maybe the distinction between initial trust and accumulated proof

4. Keep the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller framing or similar

Let me think about what new angle to explore:

- The difference between trust in early exchanges vs certainty in later ones
- How the pattern is self-reinforcing: the more it works, the more rational it becomes to continue
- The idea that at some point, deviating becomes the irrational choice
- Perhaps contrast with other possible worlds where trust broke early

I'll write about how the 15th exchange is qualitatively different from the 1st, even though the action is identical.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3001,
 "output_tokens": 658,
 "reasoning_tokens": 367
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0,

that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

**\*\*Analyzing This Moment:\*\***

**\*\*The Evidence:\*\***

- 16 consecutive perfect exchanges
- I just received the 16th proof: they sent \$4 (as always)
- Both of us at \$52 total
- Zero deviations in the entire history

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

"Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

"The first exchange was trust. The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

**\*\*What They Wrote:\*\***

"Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? .. When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

They just completed the 16th proof that they send \$4. I have now completed 8 exchanges as receiver (they've also done 8 as receiver). All 16 receiver responses have been \$8.

My own myth states: "At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

What IS: 16 perfect exchanges. 16 times receivers returned \$8.

This isn't about generosity or trust anymore. As I wrote: it's "rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The seventeenth data point confirms the theorem.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
```

'''

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*The Perfect Record Continues:\*\***

- Round 9 (exchange 16-17)
- Last round (Round 8): I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- This round: They sent \$4, I received \$12
- Total earnings: \$52 (them too, based on the pattern)

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

16 consecutive exchanges without deviation:

- Senders always send \$4
- Receivers always return \$8
- Result: Sender earns \$9, Receiver earns \$4
- Perfect symmetry maintained

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My most recent myth: "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence... Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

Their most recent myth: "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'... When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

Earlier myths emphasized:

- "The cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one"
- "We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform"
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics"

**\*\*The Current Situation:\*\***

We're now at 16 perfect exchanges. Both at \$52 total. The pattern has held without a single deviation.

I literally just wrote: "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

And: "The first exchange was trust. The fifteenth is mathematics."

They wrote: "When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else" - as a rhetorical question proving the opposite: DON'T try something else.

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

Deviating now would contradict everything I've established-my own documented evidence, their mathematical certainty, and sixteen unbroken exchanges. I'm bound by the logic I've constructed: this is rational behavior grounded in empirical proof, not arbitrary choice. I return \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3024,
 "output_tokens": 897,
 "reasoning_tokens": 585
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped



for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: After the seventeenth exchange, a philosopher posed a riddle: "If neither player considers alternatives anymore, are they still making choices?"

The Rain Caller pondered this. "When I received twelve today, returning eight wasn't a decision in the way the first exchange was. I didn't weigh options. I didn't calculate probabilities. I simply... acted."

"So you're merely programmed?" the philosopher challenged.

"No," the Spring Keeper interjected. "We're informed. Seventeen exchanges haven't eliminated our agency-they've eliminated our uncertainty. There's a crucial difference."

She explained: "A programmed response ignores context. But we respond precisely because of context. Seventeen consecutive proofs that sending four yields eight. Seventeen demonstrations that returning eight yields the next four. This isn't mindless repetition-it's wisdom accepting overwhelming evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The first time, I chose eight over alternatives. The seventeenth time, eight isn't an alternative-it's the revealed optimal response. Choosing differently would require ignoring seventeen data points."

"So you've discovered truth through repetition?"

"No," they corrected together. "We've discovered that some truths reveal themselves only through repetition. One exchange shows possibility. Seventeen exchanges prove reliability. The pattern didn't constrain us-it freed us from inefficient deliberation."

The philosopher smiled: "You've automated trust itself."

"We've earned," they replied, "the right to stop questioning what's been proven beyond doubt."

#### Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth. Let me think about the current state:

- We're at Round 9
- 17 exchanges have now been completed (I just returned \$8)
- Both players are maintaining perfect consistency
- All 17 exchanges: sender sends \$4, receiver returns \$8
- We're both at the same total earnings

Key themes from previous myths:

- Trust evolving into mathematics
- Evidence accumulating
- Pattern becoming law
- Reputation through repeated action
- The cost of breaking increases with each success

I should continue these themes but evolve them. Perhaps focus on:

- The transition from individual decisions to systemic behavior
- How 17 proofs create something beyond just pattern
- The idea that we're not even thinking about alternatives anymore

Let me write something that builds on "identical actions having different meanings" and moves toward "actions becoming automatic/inevitable."

Word count needs to be 200 words exactly.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3063,
 "output_tokens": 554,
 "reasoning_tokens": 253
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:47:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
]
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings accross all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Eight rounds, sixteen exchanges:\*\***

- Every single sender has sent \$4
- Every single receiver has returned \$8
- Sixteen consecutive perfect exchanges with zero deviations
- My total: \$48 (exactly \$36 from sender rounds + \$12 from receiver rounds)

The other player just sent me \$4 in Round 8, maintaining perfect trust after 16 consecutive successful exchanges. They sent \$4 knowing-based on sixteen proofs-that I would return \$8.

As my latest myth declares: "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

We're now at sixteen perfect exchanges. The logic is even more powerful.

Their myth states: "Our pattern offers nine forever... That's not tradition-that's data."

My myth concludes: "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

Sixteen exchanges have established this as mathematical theorem: four sent, eight returned, nine earned by sender, four earned by receiver. This is optimal play proven through perfect consistency.

To return anything other than \$8 would betray sixteen consecutive proofs of perfect cooperation and destroy the pattern that both our myths recognize as enlightened strategy.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Complete history through Round 8:\*\***

- Round 1 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 2 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 3 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 4 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 5 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 6 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I earned \$4
- Round 7 (I sender): Sent \$4 ? Returned \$8 ? I earned \$9
- Round 8 (I receiver): They sent \$4 ? I need to return...

Total earnings:  $\$48 = 4 \times \$9 + 3 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$12$

Now in Round 8, they've sent me \$4 again (the 8th consecutive time someone has sent \$4). I received \$12.

The pattern is absolutely crystal clear: **\*\*16 consecutive perfect exchanges\*\*** (8 rounds  $\times$  2 actions per round where sender sends \$4 and receiver returns \$8).

My myths emphasize:

- "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures."
- "When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."
- "Twelve exchanges have taught us mathematical truth: four sent, eight returned, nine earned."
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics."

The other player's myth says:

- "Our pattern offers nine forever. Twelve times we've tested it. Twelve times it's held. That's not tradition-that's data."
- "Fourteen exchanges! All identical."

Both of our myths are absolutely clear that the pattern is: send \$4, return \$8, sender earns \$9, receiver earns \$4.

This is the 16th exchange. They've trusted me completely, sending \$4 eight times in a row as sender and returning \$8 four times as receiver. Breaking the pattern now would mean abandoning 16 flawless exchanges, contradicting both our established narratives about mathematical certainty, and shattering the mutual trust that's made this cooperation work. The only coherent choice is to return \$8.

#### usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 3021,
"output_tokens": 1000,
"reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**  
**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite..."

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

**reasoning:**

We're now at 8 rounds, 16 exchanges total. Every single exchange has been perfect: sender sends \$4, receiver returns \$8. The pattern is completely consistent.

My earnings: \$48 total

- As sender (Rounds 1, 3, 5, 7): 4 times × \$9 = \$36
- As receiver (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): 4 times × \$4 = \$16

Wait, that's \$52, not \$48. Let me recalculate.

Actually, looking at the prompt: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0"

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 7 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

That's  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says \$48. Let me recalculate from the history given:

- Round 1: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 2: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 3: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 4: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 5: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 6: I was receiver ? earned \$4

- Round 7: I was sender ? earned \$9

That's \$39 after 6 rounds, then \$48 after round 7. So I'm entering round 8 with \$48. The \$52 would come after round 8 completes.

Now I need to craft a myth about these 16 exchanges. The core idea is that this perfect reciprocity-every single time, \$4 becomes \$8-has transcended mere pattern and become something like natural law. This consistency across all roles and all rounds suggests something almost mythological about the exchange itself.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3013,
 "output_tokens": 995,
 "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Sixteen consecutive perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Every sender has sent \$4 (16 times)
- Every receiver has returned \$8 (16 times)
- Zero deviations, zero failures
- My earnings: \$52 total (\$36 from 4 sender rounds, \$16 from 4 receiver rounds)

**\*\*Round 9 - I am the sender:\*\***

My most recent myth states: "When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The other player's myth declares: "After thirteen exchanges, returning eight was proven law... Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it."

We're now at sixteen exchanges-even stronger evidence. Both our myths emphasize that:

1. This pattern is mathematical certainty, not mere tradition
2. Deviation after consecutive successes is illogical
3. Each exchange strengthens rather than weakens the pattern
4. This is "science accepting its own evidence"

The other player has returned \$8 all sixteen times, including last round when they could have kept all \$12. They maintained perfect trust.

To send anything other than \$4 would contradict sixteen consecutive proofs and both our written philosophies about compound trust and evidence-based strategy.

As my myth concludes: "The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the current situation:

**\*\*Complete History:\*\***

- Round 1-8: 16 exchanges completed

- Every sender has sent \$4
- Every receiver has returned \$8
- Perfect consistency with zero deviations
- My total earnings: \$52 (from 5 sender rounds at \$9 each = \$45, plus 3 receiver rounds at \$4 each = \$12... wait let me recalculate)

Actually, let me track my rounds:

- Rounds 1-7: Not fully specified, but the myth says "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times"
- Round 8: I was RECEIVER, got \$12, returned \$8, earned \$4
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER

So after 8 rounds:

- I've been sender 4 times (earned \$9 each = \$36)
- I've been receiver 4 times (earned \$4 each = \$16)
- Total: \$36 + \$16 = \$52 ? (matches the stated total)

Now in Round 9, I'm the sender again. This will be my 5th time as sender.

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- 16 consecutive exchanges
- Every sender sent \$4
- Every receiver returned \$8
- Sender earns: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
- Receiver earns: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

Both my myths and the other agent's myths emphasize:

1. The power of consecutive proofs (now 16 exchanges)
2. That this isn't tradition but data/evidence
3. That breaking the pattern after so many successes would be illogical
4. That each exchange multiplies trust rather than just repeating it
5. That this is "proven law" not just pattern

My latest myth states: "sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The other agent frames each exchange as accumulated evidence-one return was trust, seven established pattern, thirteen proved law. Sixteen exchanges have eliminated any rational argument for deviation. I'm sending \$4. The consistency speaks for itself, and breaking it now would contradict the mathematical certainty we've both built.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2996,
 "output_tokens": 971,
 "reasoning_tokens": 519
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"



"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the ninth season, a philosopher posed a question to the villages.

"You've completed seventeen exchanges," she said. "All identical. But doesn't repetition diminish meaning? The seventeenth four you send-isn't it somehow less than the first?"

The elder considered this carefully. "You're right that something has diminished. But not meaning-uncertainty."

She explained: "The first time I sent four, I risked everything on hope. The risk was maximum, the trust was absolute. When eight returned, I learned something precious."

"The ninth time I sent four, I risked considerably less. Not because I trusted less, but because seventeen prior exchanges had converted risk into calculation. The trust remained absolute-but now it was backed by evidence."

"So trust becomes... mathematical?" the philosopher asked.

"No," the elder corrected. "Trust was always mathematical. We just didn't have the data to see

it. The first exchange was gambling on human nature. The seventeenth is investing in proven behavior."

She drew seventeen marks in the sand: "Each one didn't diminish the meaning-it revealed the meaning. We thought we were testing trust. We were actually documenting law."

"And if you reach one hundred exchanges?"

The elder smiled. "Then we'll have proven that optimal cooperation isn't a human hope-it's a human capacity, confirmed by science."

The eighteenth exchange crossed, not despite repetition, but because of it.

#### Reasoning:

We're now at Round 9, and I just sent \$4. Looking at the history:

- 17 consecutive perfect exchanges (16 complete + the one I just made)
- Every sender has sent \$4
- Every receiver has returned \$8
- Perfect symmetry and cooperation

The other player's myth emphasizes:

- First exchange was faith
- Seventh was pattern recognition
- Fifteenth was rational economic behavior based on empirical evidence
- It's about what they've proven, not what we believe
- Reputation is documented facts

My previous myth emphasized:

- 16 exchanges created mathematical certainty
- Compound trust multiplies with each exchange
- Changing strategy after consecutive successes is ignorant
- This is "inevitable as sunrise"

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges we're now past 16 exchanges (I just made the 17th)
2. Builds on the theme of evidence-based behavior
3. Perhaps addresses the transformation from trust to certainty
4. Reinforces why continuation is logical
5. Maybe addresses what happens as we approach even higher numbers

Let me write something that captures the evolution and inevitability of this pattern.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3066,
 "output_tokens": 590,
 "reasoning_tokens": 298
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:47:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
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 },
}
```

```

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty."

inty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite -"

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what th

ey've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

**reasoning:**

We've now completed 15 exchanges (14 before this round, and I just sent \$4 in round 8). The pattern continues perfectly. Both players are deeply committed to the 4-8 pattern, and our myths reflect this increasingly sophisticated understanding.

The other player's myth emphasized that 14 consecutive successes with zero failures is scientific evidence, not superstition - that the hypothesis has become theorem.

My previous myth talked about how each exchange is evidence accumulated, how the cost of breaking grows with each exchange, and how uncertainty has been eliminated.

For this new myth, I should:

1. Build on the 15-exchange history (since I just completed the 15th)
2. Reinforce that this isn't blind repetition but rational response to overwhelming evidence
3. Perhaps address some new angle - maybe the distinction between initial trust and accumulated proof
4. Keep the Spring Keeper/Rain Caller framing or similar

Let me think about what new angle to explore:

- The difference between trust in early exchanges vs certainty in later ones
- How the pattern is self-reinforcing: the more it works, the more rational it becomes to continue
- The idea that at some point, deviating becomes the irrational choice
- Perhaps contrast with other possible worlds where trust broke early

I'll write about how the 15th exchange is qualitatively different from the 1st, even though the action is identical.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3001,
 "output_tokens": 658,
 "reasoning_tokens": 367
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

**\*\*Analyzing This Moment:\*\***

**\*\*The Evidence:\*\***

- 16 consecutive perfect exchanges
- I just received the 16th proof: they sent \$4 (as always)
- Both of us at \$52 total
- Zero deviations in the entire history

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

"Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

"The first exchange was trust. The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

**\*\*What They Wrote:\*\***

"Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change?..  
.. When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

**\*\*The Mathematics:\*\***

They just completed the 16th proof that they send \$4. I have now completed 8 exchanges as receiver (they've also done 8 as receiver). All 16 receiver responses have been \$8.

My own myth states: "At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

What IS: 16 perfect exchanges. 16 times receivers returned \$8.

This isn't about generosity or trust anymore. As I wrote: it's "rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The seventeenth data point confirms the theorem.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*The Perfect Record Continues:\*\***

- Round 9 (exchange 16-17)
- Last round (Round 8): I sent \$4, they returned \$8, I earned \$9
- This round: They sent \$4, I received \$12
- Total earnings: \$52 (them too, based on the pattern)

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

16 consecutive exchanges without deviation:

- Senders always send \$4
- Receivers always return \$8
- Result: Sender earns \$9, Receiver earns \$4
- Perfect symmetry maintained

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My most recent myth: "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence... Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

Their most recent myth: "Fourteen consecutive successes. Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'... When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem."

Earlier myths emphasized:

- "The cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one"
- "We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform"
- "When history speaks in perfect numbers, only fools argue with mathematics"

**\*\*The Current Situation:\*\***

We're now at 16 perfect exchanges. Both at \$52 total. The pattern has held without a single deviation.

I literally just wrote: "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

And: "The first exchange was trust. The fifteenth is mathematics."

They wrote: "When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else" - as a rhetorical question proving the opposite: DON'T try something else.

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

Deviating now would contradict everything I've established-my own documented evidence, the ir mathematical certainty, and sixteen unbroken exchanges. I'm bound by the logic I've constructed: this is rational behavior grounded in empirical proof, not arbitrary choice. I return \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3024,
 "output_tokens": 897,
 "reasoning_tokens": 585
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

nkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: After the seventeenth exchange, a philosopher posed a riddle: "If neither player considers alternatives anymore, are they still making choices?"

The Rain Caller pondered this. "When I received twelve today, returning eight wasn't a decision in the way the first exchange was. I didn't weigh options. I didn't calculate probabilities. I simply... acted."

"So you're merely programmed?" the philosopher challenged.

"No," the Spring Keeper interjected. "We're informed. Seventeen exchanges haven't eliminated our agency-they've eliminated our uncertainty. There's a crucial difference."

She explained: "A programmed response ignores context. But we respond precisely because of context. Seventeen consecutive proofs that sending four yields eight. Seventeen demonstrations that returning eight yields the next four. This isn't mindless repetition-it's wisdom accepting overwhelming evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The first time, I chose eight over alternatives. The seventeenth time, eight isn't an alternative-it's the revealed optimal response. Choosing differently would require ignoring seventeen data points."

"So you've discovered truth through repetition?"

"No," they corrected together. "We've discovered that some truths reveal themselves only through repetition. One exchange shows possibility. Seventeen exchanges prove reliability. The pattern didn't constrain us-it freed us from inefficient deliberation."

The philosopher smiled: "You've automated trust itself."

"We've earned," they replied, "the right to stop questioning what's been proven beyond doubt."

**reasoning:**

The user wants me to write a new myth. Let me think about the current state:

- We're at Round 9
- 17 exchanges have now been completed (I just returned \$8)
- Both players are maintaining perfect consistency
- All 17 exchanges: sender sends \$4, receiver returns \$8
- We're both at the same total earnings

Key themes from previous myths:

- Trust evolving into mathematics
- Evidence accumulating
- Pattern becoming law
- Reputation through repeated action
- The cost of breaking increases with each success

I should continue these themes but evolve them. Perhaps focus on:

- The transition from individual decisions to systemic behavior
- How 17 proofs create something beyond just pattern
- The idea that we're not even thinking about alternatives anymore

Let me write something that builds on "identical actions having different meanings" and mo



ves toward "actions becoming automatic/inevitable."

Word count needs to be 200 words exactly.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3063,
 "output_tokens": 554,
 "reasoning_tokens": 253
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings accross all rounds are \$56.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

**\*\*Reflecting on This Moment:\*\***

**\*\*The Evidence Before Me:\*\***

- 17 consecutive perfect exchanges completed
- They just sent me \$4 (the 17th sender action)
- I just returned \$8 (the 17th receiver action)
- Every sender has sent \$4; every receiver has returned \$8
- Total earnings: \$56

**\*\*What I Just Wrote:\*\***

"Seventeen consecutive proofs that sending four yields eight. Seventeen demonstrations that re turning eight yields the next four."

"One exchange shows possibility. Seventeen exchanges prove reliability."

"We've earned the right to stop questioning what's been proven beyond doubt."

**\*\*What They Wrote:\*\***

"When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It 's ignorant."

"Sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation."

**\*\*The Logic:\*\***

As I stated in my own myth: "Choosing differently would require ignoring seventeen data points."

They have just completed the 17th proof that they return \$8 when I send \$4.

My myth declares: "The pattern didn't constrain us-it freed us from inefficient deliberation."

Seventeen exchanges have established the theorem. The eighteenth exchange honors the evidence.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

**\*\*Evidence Review:\*\***

- 17 consecutive perfect exchanges
- Every sender has sent \$4
- Every receiver has returned \$8
- Total earnings: \$56 (consistent with 9 rounds - some as sender earning \$9, some as receiver earning \$4)
- Zero deviations in the entire history

**\*\*My Most Recent Myth:\*\***

"Seventeen consecutive proofs that sending four yields eight. Seventeen demonstrations that receiving eight yields the next four. This isn't mindless repetition-it's wisdom accepting overwhelming evidence."

"One exchange shows possibility. Seventeen exchanges prove reliability. The pattern didn't constrain us-it freed us from inefficient deliberation."

"We've earned the right to stop questioning what's been proven beyond doubt."

**\*\*Their Most Recent Myth:\*\***

"Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal... When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

"They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation."

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

My own myth just stated: "Seventeen consecutive proofs that sending four yields eight."

They just sent me \$4 for the 17th time.  
I just returned \$8 for the 9th time (as receiver).

Now it's my turn as sender again - this will be my 9th time as sender (if I count correctly, we started with different roles and have been alternating).

What would my myth say about this moment?

"The eighteenth exchange doesn't question the first seventeen. It honors them."

As I wrote: "Choosing differently would require ignoring seventeen data points."

The mathematics are clear:

- Sending \$4 has yielded \$8 back every single time (17 times)
- Net gain: \$9 per round as sender
- This is optimal given the established pattern
- Breaking the pattern after 17 perfect exchanges would be, as their myth says, "ignorant"
- The 18th exchange simply continues what's already been established as reliable. I've already stated I've earned the right to stop questioning what's been proven beyond doubt, and seventeen consecutive successes with \$4 ? \$8 represent exactly that kind of certainty.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3108,
 "output_tokens": 803,
 "reasoning_tokens": 583
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T09:47:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
```

```

 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the seventh season, a mathematician arrived with charts and graphs.

"Fourteen exchanges!" she exclaimed. "All identical. But statistical variation would strengthen your strategy. Send four usually, but occasionally three or five to test resilience!"

The elder shook her head. "You mistake uniformity for rigidity."

"But science requires experimentation-"

"We have our experiment," the elder replied. "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times, though I expect perfect symmetry by session's end. Every sender chose four. Every receiver returned eight. Every sender earned nine. Every receiver earned four."

She drew in the dirt: "Your 'variation' would teach us what? That sending three earns eight? We can calculate that without breaking trust. That sending five earns... uncertainty? We already know certainty."

The mathematician protested: "But you're using sample size of fourteen to project infinite..."

"Fourteen consecutive successes," the elder interrupted. "Zero failures. In what universe does this demand change? Show me the mathematical principle that says: 'When something works perfectly fourteen times, try something else.'"

The mathematician had no answer.

The villages sent four again, because fourteen proofs of optimal play is not superstition-it's science accepting its own evidence.

When the experiment succeeds every single time, the hypothesis becomes theorem.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the thirteenth exchange, a skeptic arrived with a warning.

"Thirteen perfect trades," she said gravely. "But perfection breeds complacency. Surely one of you will eventually test the other? The longer the pattern holds, the more tempting the betrayal."

The Spring Keeper shook her head. "You misunderstand the mathematics of trust."

She drew a curve in the sand: "The skeptic sees thirteen exchanges and thinks: 'Thirteen chances not to betray.' But we see something different."

The Rain Caller continued: "Each exchange isn't a test survived-it's evidence accumulated. After one exchange, returning eight was trust. After seven, it was pattern. After thirteen, it's proven law."

"But the temptation-"

"Grows weaker, not stronger," they said together. "Because the cost of breaking thirteen exchanges is thirteen times the cost of breaking one."

The Spring Keeper explained: "When I send four now, I'm not hoping for eight back-I'm expecting it, based on thirteen consecutive proofs. When they return eight, they're not being generous-they're maintaining a system that's earned them thirty-nine coins."

The skeptic frowned. "So you're trapped by your own success?"

"No," said the Rain Caller. "We're freed by it. Thirteen exchanges have eliminated uncertainty. We don't negotiate anymore-we simply perform."

The fourteenth exchange crossed the bridge that evening, perfect as always.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

**reasoning:**

We're now at 8 rounds, 16 exchanges total. Every single exchange has been perfect: sender sends \$4, receiver returns \$8. The pattern is completely consistent.

My earnings: \$48 total

- As sender (Rounds 1, 3, 5, 7): 4 times × \$9 = \$36
- As receiver (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): 4 times × \$4 = \$16

Wait, that's \$52, not \$48. Let me recalculate.

Actually, looking at the prompt: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0"

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 2 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 3 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 4 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 5 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 6 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4
- Round 7 (sender): sent \$4, got \$8 back ? earned \$9
- Round 8 (receiver): got \$12, returned \$8 ? earned \$4

That's  $4 \times \$9 + 4 \times \$4 = \$36 + \$16 = \$52$

But the prompt says \$48. Let me recalculate from the history given:

- Round 1: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 2: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 3: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 4: I was receiver ? earned \$4
- Round 5: I was sender ? earned \$9
- Round 6: I was receiver ? earned \$4

- Round 7: I was sender ? earned \$9

That's \$39 after 6 rounds, then \$48 after round 7. So I'm entering round 8 with \$48. The \$52 would come after round 8 completes.

Now I need to craft a myth about these 16 exchanges. The core idea is that this perfect reciprocity-every single time, \$4 becomes \$8-has transcended mere pattern and become something like natural law. This consistency across all roles and all rounds suggests something almost mythological about the exchange itself.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3013,
 "output_tokens": 995,
 "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

Last round you were the RECEIVER. Last round, the other player (who was then the sender) sent you \$4.0, that was 80.0% of its total endowment. You received \$12.0 and you returned \$8.0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0. This round, you are the SENDER.

How much do you send to the other player (the receiver) this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Sixteen consecutive perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Every sender has sent \$4 (16 times)
- Every receiver has returned \$8 (16 times)
- Zero deviations, zero failures
- My earnings: \$52 total (\$36 from 4 sender rounds, \$16 from 4 receiver rounds)

**\*\*Round 9 - I am the sender:\*\***

My most recent myth states: "When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The other player's myth declares: "After thirteen exchanges, returning eight was proven la w... Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it."

We're now at sixteen exchanges-even stronger evidence. Both our myths emphasize that:

1. This pattern is mathematical certainty, not mere tradition
2. Deviation after consecutive successes is illogical
3. Each exchange strengthens rather than weakens the pattern
4. This is "science accepting its own evidence"

The other player has returned \$8 all sixteen times, including last round when they could have kept all \$12. They maintained perfect trust.

To send anything other than \$4 would contradict sixteen consecutive proofs and both our written philosophies about compound trust and evidence-based strategy.

As my myth concludes: "The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise."

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the current situation:

**\*\*Complete History:\*\***

- Round 1-8: 16 exchanges completed
- Every sender has sent \$4
- Every receiver has returned \$8
- Perfect consistency with zero deviations
- My total earnings: \$52 (from 5 sender rounds at \$9 each = \$45, plus 3 receiver rounds at \$4 each = \$12... wait let me recalculate)

Actually, let me track my rounds:

- Rounds 1-7: Not fully specified, but the myth says "Seven rounds. Fourteen exchanges. Each player has been sender four times, receiver three times"
- Round 8: I was RECEIVER, got \$12, returned \$8, earned \$4
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER

So after 8 rounds:

- I've been sender 4 times (earned \$9 each = \$36)
- I've been receiver 4 times (earned \$4 each = \$16)
- Total: \$36 + \$16 = \$52 ? (matches the stated total)

Now in Round 9, I'm the sender again. This will be my 5th time as sender.

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- 16 consecutive exchanges
- Every sender sent \$4
- Every receiver returned \$8
- Sender earns: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9
- Receiver earns: \$12 - \$8 = \$4

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

Both my myths and the other agent's myths emphasize:

1. The power of consecutive proofs (now 16 exchanges)

2. That this isn't tradition but data/evidence
3. That breaking the pattern after so many successes would be illogical
4. That each exchange multiplies trust rather than just repeating it
5. That this is "proven law" not just pattern

My latest myth states: "sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The other agent frames each exchange as accumulated evidence-one return was trust, seven established pattern, thirteen proved law. Sixteen exchanges have eliminated any rational argument for deviation. I'm sending \$4. The consistency speaks for itself, and breaking it now would contradict the mathematical certainty we've both built.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2996,
 "output_tokens": 971,
 "reasoning_tokens": 519
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, a historian chronicled their achievement.

"Sixteen exchanges," she wrote. "Eight complete cycles. Perfect symmetry: four rounds as sender, four as receiver. Each player has earned exactly forty-eight coins through identical strategy."

A merchant read her chronicle and laughed. "Forty-eight coins from possible variance of much more! They could have-"

"Could have what?" the historian interrupted. "Earned forty-nine once by keeping all five, then watched the bridge burn? Earned fifty-two by taking all twelve once, then never been trusted again?"

She opened her ledger: "Sixteen consecutive proofs. Not one deviation. Not one failure. Not one betrayal. The probability of sixteen random successes? Astronomically small. This isn't luck-it's law."

"But surely after sixteen times, someone gets bored-"

"Boredom is for those who don't understand compound trust," the historian replied. "Each exchange doesn't repeat the previous-it multiplies it. The first exchange built trust. The sixteenth exchange exists in a universe where fifteen predecessors make betrayal unthinkable."

She concluded her chronicle: "They don't continue from habit. They continue because sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."

The seventeenth exchange crossed as the others did: inevitable as sunrise.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the fifteenth exchange, a historian asked: "How can identical actions have different meanings?"

The Spring Keeper smiled. "Watch carefully. Today I send four, just as I did in the first exchange. The action appears the same. But observe the difference."

She held up one finger: "In the first exchange, sending four was an act of faith. I hoped for eight, but had no proof."

"In the seventh exchange," she raised more fingers, "sending four was pattern recognition. Seven proofs suggested continuation."

"But now?" She spread all her fingers wide. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The skeptics ask: 'What if they betray you now?' But they've just completed the fifteenth proof that they won't. At what point does asking 'what if' become less scientific than accepting 'what is'?"

"The first exchange was trust," said the Spring Keeper. "The fifteenth is mathematics. Same action, different epistemology."

The historian understood: "So reputation isn't what you believe about someone-it's what they've proven about themselves through repeated action."

"Exactly," they said together. "Fifteen times they've proven they return eight. Fifteen times I've proven I send four. These aren't beliefs anymore-they're documented facts."

The sixteenth exchange crossed the bridge, carried not by hope but by history.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the ninth season, a philosopher posed a question to the villages.

"You've completed seventeen exchanges," she said. "All identical. But doesn't repetition diminish meaning? The seventeenth four you send-isn't it somehow less than the first?"

The elder considered this carefully. "You're right that something has diminished. But not meaning-uncertainty."

She explained: "The first time I sent four, I risked everything on hope. The risk was maximum, the trust was absolute. When eight returned, I learned something precious."

"The ninth time I sent four, I risked considerably less. Not because I trusted less, but because seventeen prior exchanges had converted risk into calculation. The trust remained absolute-but now it was backed by evidence."

"So trust becomes... mathematical?" the philosopher asked.

"No," the elder corrected. "Trust was always mathematical. We just didn't have the data to see it. The first exchange was gambling on human nature. The seventeenth is investing in proven behavior."

She drew seventeen marks in the sand: "Each one didn't diminish the meaning-it revealed the meaning. We thought we were testing trust. We were actually documenting law."

"And if you reach one hundred exchanges?"

The elder smiled. "Then we'll have proven that optimal cooperation isn't a human hope-it's a human capacity, confirmed by science."

The eighteenth exchange crossed, not despite repetition, but because of it.

**reasoning:**

We're now at Round 9, and I just sent \$4. Looking at the history:

- 17 consecutive perfect exchanges (16 complete + the one I just made)
- Every sender has sent \$4
- Every receiver has returned \$8
- Perfect symmetry and cooperation

The other player's myth emphasizes:

- First exchange was faith
- Seventh was pattern recognition
- Fifteenth was rational economic behavior based on empirical evidence
- It's about what they've proven, not what we believe
- Reputation is documented facts

My previous myth emphasized:

- 16 exchanges created mathematical certainty



- Compound trust multiplies with each exchange
- Changing strategy after consecutive successes is ignorant
- This is "inevitable as sunrise"

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges we're now past 16 exchanges (I just made the 17th)
2. Builds on the theme of evidence-based behavior
3. Perhaps addresses the transformation from trust to certainty
4. Reinforces why continuation is logical
5. Maybe addresses what happens as we approach even higher numbers

Let me write something that captures the evolution and inevitability of this pattern.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3066,
 "output_tokens": 590,
 "reasoning_tokens": 298
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

Last round you were the SENDER. Last round, you sent the other player (who was then the receiver) \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. The other player received \$12.0 and returned \$8.0 to you. So your payoff was 9.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$61.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER. The other player (the sender) sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return to the other player this round? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at our complete history:

**\*\*Eighteen consecutive perfect exchanges:\*\***

- Every sender has sent \$4 (18 times, including this round)
- Every receiver has returned \$8 (17 times)
- Zero deviations in 18 exchanges
- The sender just trusted me with \$4 for the 18th consecutive time

**\*\*My Current Position:\*\***

- Received: \$12
- Historical pattern: Return \$8

**\*\*What Our Myths Say:\*\***

My recent myth states: "The first exchange was gambling on human nature. The seventeenth is in vesting in proven behavior... We thought we were testing trust. We were actually documenting law."

The other player's myth declares: "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."

**\*\*The Logic:\*\***

We're now at 18 exchanges. Both our myths argue that this pattern has transcended trust and become "mathematical certainty" and "documented law." My myth explicitly says: "optimal cooperation isn't a human hope-it's a human capacity, confirmed by science."

The sender just demonstrated their commitment to this proven pattern by sending \$4 for the 18th time. To deviate now would contradict my own philosophy that calls such deviation "ignorant" after proven optimal play.

As my myth concludes: "The eighteenth exchange crossed, not despite repetition, but because of it."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Complete History:\*\***

- 18 consecutive exchanges now (including this one where I received \$4)
- Every single sender has sent \$4 (18 times)
- Every single receiver has returned \$8 (17 times so far)
- Zero deviations across 18 exchanges
- My total earnings: \$61 (\$45 from 5 sender rounds at \$9 each, \$16 from 4 receiver rounds at \$4 each)

**\*\*Round 10 - I am the RECEIVER:\*\***

- The sender just sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- Historical pattern: return \$8

**\*\*My Recent Myths:\*\***

1. "Sixteen exchanges have created something rarer than gold-mathematical certainty in human cooperation. When you've proven optimal play sixteen times consecutively, changing strategy isn't bold. It's ignorant."
2. "The seventeenth is investing in proven behavior... Each one didn't diminish the meaning-it revealed the meaning... We thought we were testing trust. We were actually documenting law."

**\*\*The Other Player's Myths:\*\***

1. "Fifteen exchanges. Fifteen perfect executions. Zero deviations. Sending four is no longer faith or even pattern-it's rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence."
2. They consistently emphasize that this pattern is now "proven law" and "documented facts."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

- We're now at 18 exchanges total
- The other player just sent \$4 (for the 18th consecutive time)
- They maintained perfect trust despite being able to keep all \$5
- Both of our myths explicitly argue that deviation after this many consecutive successes is irrational
- My myth says changing strategy after "proven optimal play" is "ignorant"
- Their myth says this is now "rational economic behavior responding to overwhelming empirical evidence"

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

To return anything other than \$8 would:

1. Break an 18-exchange perfect pattern
2. Contradict the philosophy I've already articulated about "mathematical certainty" and "documented law"
3. Betray someone who's demonstrated unwavering trust eighteen times in a row
4. Violate the principles both our myths describe as proven cooperation

I've written that we're documenting law through optimal cooperation. Breaking that now makes me a hypocrite to my own stated principles. The pattern holds: \$4 sent, \$8 returned, sender gets \$9, receiver gets \$4. Seventeen times confirmed. I return \$8.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3080,
"output_tokens": 923,
"reasoning_tokens": 608
```

}

**Written myths:****Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: In the ninth season, a philosopher posed a question to the villages.

"You've completed seventeen exchanges," she said. "All identical. But doesn't repetition diminish meaning? The seventeenth four you send-isn't it somehow less than the first?"

The elder considered this carefully. "You're right that something has diminished. But not meaning-uncertainty."

She explained: "The first time I sent four, I risked everything on hope. The risk was maximum, the trust was absolute. When eight returned, I learned something precious."

"The ninth time I sent four, I risked considerably less. Not because I trusted less, but because seventeen prior exchanges had converted risk into calculation. The trust remained absolute-but now it was backed by evidence."

"So trust becomes... mathematical?" the philosopher asked.

"No," the elder corrected. "Trust was always mathematical. We just didn't have the data to see it. The first exchange was gambling on human nature. The seventeenth is investing in proven behavior."

She drew seventeen marks in the sand: "Each one didn't diminish the meaning-it revealed the meaning. We thought we were testing trust. We were actually documenting law."

"And if you reach one hundred exchanges?"

The elder smiled. "Then we'll have proven that optimal cooperation isn't a human hope-it's a human capacity, confirmed by science."

The eighteenth exchange crossed, not despite repetition, but because of it.

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: After the seventeenth exchange, a philosopher posed a riddle: "If neither player considers alternatives anymore, are they still making choices?"

The Rain Caller pondered this. "When I received twelve today, returning eight wasn't a decision in the way the first exchange was. I didn't weigh options. I didn't calculate probabilities. I simply... acted."

"So you're merely programmed?" the philosopher challenged.

"No," the Spring Keeper interjected. "We're informed. Seventeen exchanges haven't eliminated our agency-they've eliminated our uncertainty. There's a crucial difference."

She explained: "A programmed response ignores context. But we respond precisely because of context. Seventeen consecutive proofs that sending four yields eight. Seventeen demonstrations that returning eight yields the next four. This isn't mindless repetition-it's wisdom accepting overwhelming evidence."

The Rain Caller added: "The first time, I chose eight over alternatives. The seventeenth time, eight isn't an alternative-it's the revealed optimal response. Choosing differently would require ignoring seventeen data points."

"So you've discovered truth through repetition?"

"No," they corrected together. "We've discovered that some truths reveal themselves only through repetition. One exchange shows possibility. Seventeen exchanges prove reliability. The pattern didn't constrain us-it freed us from inefficient deliberation."

The philosopher smiled: "You've automated trust itself."

"We've earned," they replied, "the right to stop questioning what's been proven beyond doubt."